TABLE OF CONTENTS

TABLE OF CONTENTS

SEARCH STRATEGY

| Set No. | Searched for | Databases | Results |
|---|---|---|---|
| S5 | ((US news) AND (publication.exact("Wall Street Journal") AND bdl(1006968) AND at.exact("News") AND stype.exact("Newspapers") AND pd(20210101-20211231)) AND bdl(1006968)) AND bdl(1006968) | Arts Premium Collection, British Periodicals, Coronavirus Research Database, Coronavirus Research Database, Early Modern Collection, Ebook Central, Education Research Index, ERIC, GeoRef, Periodicals Archive Online, Periodicals Index Online, ProQuest Central, ProQuest Dissertations & Theses Global, ProQuest Historical Newspapers: The Guardian and The Observer, ProQuest Historical Newspapers: The New York Times, ProQuest Historical Newspapers: The Scotsman, ProQuest One Literature, Publicly Available Content Database, SciTech Premium Collection, Social Science Premium Collection | 6575 |
| S4 | (US news) AND (publication.exact("Wall Street Journal") AND bdl(1006968) AND at.exact("News") AND stype.exact("Newspapers") AND pd(20210101-20211231)) AND bdl(1006968) | Arts Premium Collection, British Periodicals, Coronavirus Research Database, Coronavirus Research Database, Early Modern Collection, Ebook Central, Education Research Index, ERIC, GeoRef, Periodicals Archive Online, Periodicals Index Online, ProQuest Central, ProQuest Dissertations & Theses Global, ProQuest Historical Newspapers: The Guardian and The Observer, ProQuest Historical Newspapers: The New York Times, ProQuest Historical Newspapers: The Scotsman, ProQuest One Literature, Publicly Available Content Database, SciTech Premium Collection, Social Science Premium Collection | 6575 |
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| S2 | (us fiscal policy) AND (publication.exact("Wall Street Journal (Online)" OR "Wall Street Journal") AND at.exact("News") AND pd(20210101-20211231)) | Arts Premium Collection, British Periodicals, Coronavirus Research Database, Coronavirus Research Database, Early Modern Collection, Ebook Central, Education Research Index, ERIC, GeoRef, Periodicals Archive Online, Periodicals Index Online, ProQuest Central, ProQuest Dissertations & Theses Global, ProQuest Historical Newspapers: The Guardian and The Observer, ProQuest Historical Newspapers: The New York Times, ProQuest Historical Newspapers: The Scotsman, ProQuest One Literature, Publicly Available Content Database, SciTech Premium Collection, Social Science Premium Collection | 696 |
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# Business & Finance

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

Saudi Arabia said it would unilaterally cut 1 million barrels a day of crude production starting next month, signaling the kingdom's worry that a resurgent coronavirus is threatening global economic recovery.

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The NYSE is in the hot seat after a flip-flop in which it first said it would delist three Chinese firms to comply with a Trump order, only to reverse itself four days later.

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China's regulators are trying to get Jack Ma to share the troves of consumer-credit data collected by his fintech giant, Ant, something he has long resisted.

Trump signed an order banning transactions with eight Chinese-connected apps, including the Alipay platform owned by Ant.

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Several auto makers reported relatively brisk U.S. sales to finish 2020, stoking optimism the business can continue its climb.

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U.S. stocks rose, with the Nasdaq jumping 1%, while the S&P 500 and Dow advanced 0.7% and 0.6%, respectively.

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GE's board won't claw back compensation from ex-CEO Immelt and other executives over the company's accounting issues or Mr. Immelt's use of a corporate jet.

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The World Bank lowered its projection for potential global growth between 2020 and 2029.

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IBM appointed Gary D. Cohn, an ex-Goldman executive and Trump adviser, as vice chairman and member of its executive leadership team.

## DETAILS

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## LINKS



# Russia's Neighbors Rebuild Defenses --- Alarmed by Moscow, Sweden rearms

Phillips, Michael M . Phillips, Michael M.



## FULL TEXT

Wooden targets hide among the pine trees at the Gotland island army firing range, silhouettes depicting foreign invaders, their faces twisted with malice.

They bear no unit insignia, no flag patches. But the Swedish army recruits peppering the targets with machine-gun fire this fall knew exactly who the enemy was: Russia's 76th Guards Air Assault Division.

With Russia's foreign policy growing more assertive over the past decade under President Vladimir Putin, the Swedes are bulking up defenses on Gotland. Its army expects that in the opening moments of a Russian invasion, airborne soldiers from the 76th Guards, based across the Baltic Sea, would likely parachute onto Gotland. Both sides know that whoever controls the island controls naval traffic through the southern Baltic.

"We will never surrender," said Daniel Martell, sergeant major of Sweden's Gotland Regiment. "That's the message we're sending."

The Cold War is back on in the frigid North.

Russia's expansive military and political appetites are alarming countries along the former frontiers of the Soviet Union, from Finland to Romania. The North Atlantic Treaty Organization has deployed four battle groups -- nearly 5,000 troops -- to Poland and the Baltic states of Estonia, Latvia and Lithuania. In 2018, Norway hosted NATO's largest military exercise since the collapse of the Soviet Union.

Sweden's response is especially dramatic, overturning decades of its own defense and foreign policy. While the country maintained a careful neutrality during the Cold War, this time around Stockholm is tightening ties with Washington. This fall, the Swedes rubbed that partnership in Moscow's face by spotlighting joint U.S.-Swedish commando exercises previously kept secret.

"We no longer can rule out a military attack on Sweden," said Karin Olofsdotter, Sweden's ambassador in Washington. "It's not likely in any way, but it can't be ruled out."

Last month, Sweden's parliament authorized the biggest increase in military spending in 70 years, including a 50% expansion of the country's armed forces, to 90,000 troops in 2025 from 60,000 today. In 2018, the army resurrected its Cold War-era Gotland Regiment, which had been deactivated in 2005, and the troops regularly train to repel Russian invaders. The army plans to add another battalion, artillery units and logistical capabilities to its forces on the island.

A U.S. Army Green Beret team is stationed full-time in Sweden to help the country's 22,000-strong Home Guard -- part-time citizen-soldiers -- plan sabotage, ambush and other operations to disrupt any attempted occupation.

During the Cold War, Sweden kept upward of 700,000 men and women under arms. After the implosion of the Soviet Union, Sweden dismantled much of its military and turned the attention of what remained to peacekeeping, expeditionary ventures and counterterror operations in Afghanistan, Iraq, Mali and elsewhere. The Swedes even conducted small joint military exercises with Russians in the far north.

Then came a series of moves that appeared to signal Russia's intention to retain a buffer of friendly states along its borders. First there was the military intervention in Georgia in 2008. In 2014 Russia seized Crimea from Ukraine and flooded the country's east with covert operatives and mysterious soldiers whose uniforms bore no insignia. Now Moscow is propping up the authoritarian leader of Belarus.

"You get the impression they could be pushing one or two countries at a time," said Johan Lagerlof, head of strategy and security policy at the Swedish Ministry of Defense.

As a younger man, Mr. Lagerlof was an artillery officer assigned to the Finnish border, with orders to cut Soviet supply lines if the time came.

Now he's seeing Russian warplanes infringe on Swedish airspace and Russian warships venture into Swedish waters. Two Russian vessels entered Swedish seas near Gothenburg in September, according to the Swedish military.

"They're more and more provocative in the air and elsewhere," said Brig. Gen. Anders Lofberg, commander of Swedish Special Operations Command.

The Russians deny any aggressive intent. "These invented anti-Russia phobias are due in no small measure to deliberate external pressure on Stockholm, primarily from the North Atlantic alliance," a Russian Ministry of Foreign Affairs spokeswoman, Maria Zakharova, said this fall.

The ministry said in a written statement, "The degradation of the military-political situation in the North Baltic region, until recently one of the most stable in this respect in Europe, is taking place against the backdrop of NATO's increasing military presence in the immediate vicinity of Russia's borders."

From Moscow's perspective, the statement said, "there are currently no problems in the North Baltic region requiring a military solution."

Russia has advanced ground-to-air missiles in Kaliningrad, a Russian territory wedged between Lithuania and Poland.

Should war come, the Swedes expect Russian marines from Kaliningrad to assault Gotland after the airborne attack.

Russian troops rehearsed amphibious landings in August, prompting the Swedes to rush fresh troops to Gotland. The Russian show of force followed a series of joint naval exercises this summer between Sweden and NATO.

Russia briefly occupied Gotland in 1808 during the Finnish War with Sweden. A Russian detachment of some 2,000 men soon fled before a larger Swedish force. Still, at war's end, Russia had cleaved Finland from eastern Sweden and added the Grand Duchy of Finland to its empire.

Now, with climate change shrinking the ice cap in the Arctic, Russia is laying claim to key shipping routes along its northern coast.

In response to Russia's resurgence in the area, the Swedes dusted off old Cold War military plans and reinstituted the draft. Sweden is a member of the European Union, but not of U.S.-led NATO. Norway, Estonia, Latvia and Lithuania belong to the alliance, in which an attack on one member is considered an attack on all. Finland isn't part of the alliance.

NATO membership isn't on the table for Sweden, partly because Stockholm knows the Russians would see the move as deeply threatening.

Stockholm, however, has signed a series of defense understandings with the U.S., Norway and Finland in recent years.

The Swedes and Finns have joint war plans on the shelf just in case.

The Gotland Regiment, local Home Guard soldiers and Sweden's small commando force expect to resort to guerrilla tactics against any occupiers.

Many Home Guard soldiers keep working dogs and weapons at home. One day a year, members wear their uniforms to their civilian jobs to remind the public of their role responding to security threats.

In 2018, the Swedish Civil Contingencies Agency sent every household in the country a 20-page brochure titled, "If crisis or war comes." All of Swedish society, from individuals to companies to the central bank, participate in defense exercises.

Even Crown Princess Victoria, the heir to the throne, completed basic military training in 2003. She is often pictured wearing camouflage on visits to army units, clutching a rifle on a marine shooting range or helping commandos blast their way into a building.

"We want to send the message that if anyone has the bad idea of trying to attack Sweden in any way, they must be aware that Swedish special forces will do their utmost to resist and make their lives miserable," said Gen. Lofberg.

For several weeks this fall, an American Green Beret team worked with Gotland's Home Guard detachment to practice resistance operations, a plan that leans heavily on the part-time soldiers' intimate knowledge of the area. In one training scenario, a Home Guard soldier tapped his network of friends and family to find a mock enemy infiltrator; the soldier's brother reported by cellphone that the man was hiding in the backyard.

"At least we'll have a defense," said Col. Mattias Ardin, commander of the Gotland Regiment. "It won't be a new Crimea."

Moscow periodically warns Sweden not to get too cozy with the West.

"The threats and risks are mounting," Russian Foreign Minister Sergei Lavrov said at a news conference after meeting his Swedish counterpart in Moscow last year. He cited "NATO's unprecedented plans to move towards our borders and involve neutral countries -- like Sweden and Finland -- in its military exercises."

Along with the increase in troops, Sweden's latest defense plan boosts annual military spending by more than $3 billion, a 40% hike, in the next five years.

"Their stated strategy," said Kenneth Howery, the U.S. ambassador in Stockholm, "is hold out as long as possible and hope help arrives."

In a break from past secrecy, this fall the Swedish Armed Forces allowed The Wall Street Journal to observe aspects of two-week joint exercises between Swedish special forces and commandos from Stuttgart-based U.S. Special Operations Command-Europe.
The first such commando exercises took place in 2018, with one 12-man Green Beret team representing the U.S. Last year the U.S. brought Green Berets, a Navy guided-missile destroyer, fighter jets, advanced helicopters, an aerial refueling plane, transport aircraft, Navy SEALs, high-speed coastal attack boats and Air Force commandos trained to call in airstrikes.
U.S. helicopters and American and Swedish fighter jets flew in close formation across the Baltic to Estonia, where German planes replaced the Swedish escorts. The U.S. warplanes planned to drop bombs on a military firing range in Estonia -- the former Soviet republic turned NATO member -- but weather forced cancellation of the display.
The Swedes "have come to the realization that being quiet and not advertising capabilities has no deterrent value," said one U.S. officer involved in the training.
During one exercise, a U.S. Special Forces team flew from Estonia to a Swedish naval base for a rendezvous with Swedish commandos and Home Guard soldiers.
Over several days, they traveled back roads in civilian vehicles and cruised the Stockholm archipelago in high-speed patrol boats hunting for an enemy command-and-control vessel. They dodged enemy maritime patrols, evaded enemy search dogs and sidestepped civilian deer hunters stalking through the mock combat zone.
The Swedish and American commandos spotted the enemy ship docked at a civilian harbor and called in a simulated Tomahawk missile strike from the USS Ross, a destroyer. Swedish Home Guard soldiers extracted the Americans by boat and hid them in a cabin until a U.S. helicopter picked them up.
"It's not just another exercise -- we're worried," Gen. Lofberg, the Swedish special-forces commander, said he told Gen. Richard Clarke, commander of U.S. Special Operations Command, during a closed-door meeting.
On Gotland, Swedish military commanders are putting clerks, drivers, radio operators and other back-office troops through live-fire combat exercises in which they move through the woodlands to destroy enemy armored vehicles and kill enemy paratroopers.
Said Lt. Col. Ulf Hamberg, commander of the regiment's 1st Battalion: "Everybody fights."
---
Thomas Grove and Nonna Fomenko contributed to this article.
Credit: By Michael M. Phillips in Gotland, Sweden, and James Marson in Brussels

## DETAILS

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## LINKS

Document 3 of 75

# U.S. News: U.S. Watch

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

INTERIOR DEPARTMENT
Penalties Ended for
Accidental Bird Kills
The Trump administration is removing criminal penalties for accidentally killing migratory birds, reversing longstanding federal policy in a move officials say will help landowners and businesses.
The final rule change, announced by the Interior Department on Tuesday, completes changes proposed a year ago and in the works since 2017 to limit the Migratory Bird Treaty Act, a 102-year-old law meant to protect the hundreds of bird species that are native to the U.S.
Business groups and local government officials have pushed for the change, saying criminal penalties are too harsh for accidental deaths.
But it comes at a time when bird populations are plummeting, facing threats from climate change and habitat loss. Since 1970, North America has lost more than a quarter of its bird population, nearly three billion birds, according to research published in the journal Science in October 2019.
The threat of criminal penalties encouraged farmers, miners, power companies, developers and others to take greater precautions to protect migratory birds, and conservation groups have opposed the changes to keep that incentive in place.
-- Timothy Puko
---
OREGON
Grazing Rights
Decision Criticized
The federal government proposed awarding grazing allotments to an Oregon ranching family whose members were convicted of arson in a court battle that triggered the takeover of a federal wildlife refuge by right-wing extremists.
The Dec. 31 action by the Bureau of Land Management in favor of Hammond Ranches angered environmental groups.
"Giving the permit to the Hammonds shows a flagrant disregard for the rule of law . . . and is clearly a political move rather than a responsible allocation of public lands," said Erik Molvar, executive director of Western Watersheds Project.
Steven Hammond, co-owner of the ranch, and his father, Dwight, were both convicted of arson for setting fire to range land and sent to prison for mandatory five-year sentences.
That led to the armed occupation of Malheur National Wildlife Refuge in Oregon for 41 days in 2016. One occupier was shot dead by Oregon State Police. They say he reached for a pistol at a roadblock.
President Trump pardoned the Hammonds in 2018, allowing them to be freed from federal prison.
In a proposed decision made on Dec. 31, the BLM said Hammond Ranches should be apportioned all available forage in the Bridge Creek area grazing allotments in the high desert of eastern Oregon, covering about 26,000 acres.
-- Associated Press
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MISSOURI
Man Fires Shots at
Patrol Headquarters
A man fired several shots with an assault-style rifle at a suburban Kansas City headquarters for the Missouri State Highway Patrol before he was shot and wounded by troopers, the patrol said Tuesday.
The man, identified as Tayland Rahim, 27, of Kansas City, Mo., was shot Monday night at Troop A headquarters in Lee's Summit. Investigators are trying to determine his motive, but he was there "to do some harm, no doubt about it," spokesman Sgt. Bill Lowe said.
Mr. Rahim, who didn't have a criminal record in Missouri, was in stable condition Tuesday at a hospital. Sgt. Lowe didn't release where on his body he was struck. No troopers or civilian employees inside the headquarters were

injured.
Sgt. Lowe said Mr. Rahim hadn't yet been questioned and that the investigation had not yet been turned over to prosecutors for an arrest warrant but "suffice to say it will be."
The patrol said employees inside the building heard gunshots and troopers who went to an exterior door saw a man with the rifle. The man approached the main entrance and filed several shots.
He was shot after he did not comply with several orders from the troopers, Sgt. Andy Bell said.
Earlier Tuesday, Sgt. Lowe also credited a trooper who was outside the building when the man arrived with helping to alert those inside.
A police bomb squad secured a suspicious package inside the suspect's vehicle, but it didn't contain anything that would have harmed anyone, Sgt. Bell said.
Sgt. Lowe said law enforcement was trying to determine whether he had a "secondary motive."
-- Associated Press

## DETAILS


| | |
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## LINKS

Document 4 of 75

# U.S. News: World Bank Warns of a 'Lost Decade'

Hayashi, Yuka . Hayashi, Yuka.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

WASHINGTON -- Even before Covid-19, the World Bank had lowered its projections for global growth in the 10 years that began in 2020. The pandemic is exacerbating that trend, raising the prospect of a "lost decade" ahead, the World Bank said Tuesday, as it also cut its forecasts for the coming year.

The bank's semiannual Global Economic Prospects report attributes the long-term downgrade to lower trade and investment caused by uncertainty over the pandemic, along with disruptions in education that will hamper gains in labor productivity.

"If history is any guide, unless there is substantial reform, we think the global economy is headed for a decade of disappointing growth outcomes," Ayhan Kose, the bank's acting vice president for equitable growth and financial institutions, said in an interview.

Before the pandemic, the bank projected that potential global growth between 2020 and 2029 would slow to a yearly average of 2.1%, from 2.5% in the previous decade, as a result of aging populations and lower productivity growth. On Tuesday the bank lowered its projection to 1.9%. Potential output assumes the world economy is operating at full employment and capacity.

The World Bank said the global economy is expected to grow 4% this year after contracting 4.3% in 2020. That 2021 projection is 0.2 percentage point lower than it forecast this past June, reflecting the resurgence of the coronavirus and renewed restrictions on economic activity.

For emerging-market and developing nations, the World Bank now sees growth averaging 3.3% a year from 2020 to 2029, down from its 4.0% forecast before the pandemic and 5.0% during the previous decade. The World Bank's mission is to reduce poverty through lending and advice to developing countries.

"The world can't wait for everyone to be vaccinated to inoculate the global economy against another lost decade for growth," Mr. Kose said. "That means policy makers need to act and act aggressively to get ahead of the pandemic."
He called for investments to improve technology, health care, education and the environment, as well as improvements in governance and debt transparency, particularly in emerging and developing economies.
Years of disappointing growth also followed the 2008 financial crisis. Global forecasts were repeatedly downgraded, falling to an average 2.4% annually for a 10-year look ahead in 2019 from 3.3% seen before the crisis.
The downward revision for 2021 mostly reflects slower growth in advanced economies, with the U.S. now projected to expand 3.5%, down from 4% in the bank's June forecast. The euro area is expected to grow 3.6%, down from 4.5%.
Emerging-market economies are forecast to grow 5% in 2021, up from 4.6% projected earlier, helped by China. The bank projects China, the world's second-largest economy, will grow 7.9% this year after expanding 2% last year, when it was the only major economy to avoid a contraction.
The 4.3% collapse in the global economy last year was slightly less severe than previously projected, mainly due to shallower contractions in advanced economies supported by aggressive government stimulus. China's recovery also helped, the World Bank said.
While advanced economies have been able to take advantage of low interest rates to finance stimulus measures cheaply, debt risks are growing in emerging-market and developing economies, many of which were already struggling with heavy debt burdens before the pandemic.
Solvency risks currently concealed by low interest rates could "surface in the next episode of financial stress or capital outflow," the World Bank said.
Credit: By Yuka Hayashi

## DETAILS


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## LINKS



# NYSE China Shift Sparks Backlash

Osipovich, Alexander . Osipovich, Alexander.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

The New York Stock Exchange is in the hot seat after a baffling flip-flop in which it first said it would delist three Chinese companies to comply with an executive order from President Trump, only to reverse itself four days later.

The NYSE's U-turn drew criticism from Mr. Trump's administration. The GOP president signed the order in November mandating a ban on the trading of securities of companies U.S. officials say have links to the Chinese military.

The order was one of the last salvos by Mr. Trump, who lost his bid for re-election, to get tough on Beijing and put the NYSE in a difficult situation since the exchange has long welcomed initial public offerings of companies from China.

While on a trip to Egypt, Treasury Secretary Steven Mnuchin called NYSE President Stacey Cunningham to object to the exchange operator's reversal, a Trump administration official said. Mr. Mnuchin supports the NYSE's original plan to delist the companies, the official said.

News of his call to Ms. Cunningham was reported by Bloomberg News. A spokesman for the NYSE, which is owned by Intercontinental Exchange Inc., declined to comment on the call from Mr. Mnuchin.

The NYSE's moves have also provoked consternation among investors about the ultimate impact on the companies

in question, all of which are in telecommunications: China Mobile Ltd., China Telecom Corp. and China Unicom (Hong Kong) Ltd. The three stocks have gone on a wild ride, first falling and then rebounding after the NYSE's about-face.
The Big Board said Thursday that it would move to delist the three companies' American depositary receipts to comply with Mr. Trump's order. Then, late Monday, the NYSE said in a notice that it was putting the delisting process on hold, citing "further consultation with relevant regulatory authorities." The Monday notice linked to a guidance document recently issued by the Treasury Department clarifying which firms are affected by the executive order; the NYSE provided no other explanation.
A person familiar with the matter said Tuesday that the NYSE reversed its decision because of ambiguities in whether the three telecom companies are covered by Mr. Trump's order. If and when there is formal confirmation that the three companies are covered by the order, the NYSE would delist them, this person said.
Lawyers not affiliated with the NYSE said there might have been some confusion about which companies are covered by the order and when the trading ban takes effect.
"Clearly there was some sort of new information or miscommunication that caused them to change direction within a couple of days," said Alan Seem, a partner at law firm Jones Day.
"The last thing the NYSE wants to do is have to delist these Chinese companies," said Mr. Seem, who worked on the IPOs of China Mobile, China Telecom and other Chinese companies in a previous job.
Mr. Trump's November order identified 31 "Communist Chinese Military Companies" and banned trading in their shares starting Jan. 11. But it didn't spell out in detail which of the companies' subsidiaries and affiliates might also be covered by the trading ban. That ambiguity prompted a behind-the-scenes fight between various agencies over how broad the ban should be, The Wall Street Journal reported in December.
The Treasury Department released guidance on Dec. 28 saying the ban would apply to subsidiaries that were 50% or more owned by the blacklisted Chinese companies. That would capture the three NYSE-listed telecom firms, which are majority-owned by companies on the blacklist.
But the guidance document also said the ban on subsidiaries would only take effect 60 days after the Treasury Department formally named which subsidiaries are covered by the order. The department hasn't taken that step yet. Potentially, that could spare the three NYSE-listed telecoms companies because the incoming administration of President-elect Joe Biden, a Democrat, could reverse the ban before it takes effect.
The NYSE cited the Dec. 28 guidance when reversing the delisting decision. It is unclear why the exchange moved ahead with its New Year's Eve delisting announcement, even though the Treasury Department hadn't formally named the subsidiaries to be covered by Mr. Trump's order. Stock exchanges are tightly regulated and normally work closely with their oversight agencies in Washington.
Some supporters of Mr. Trump's tough stance on China blasted the NYSE for its about-face.
"Once again Wall Street has chosen the Chinese Communist Party over the economic and national security interests of the United States," Christopher Iacovella, head of the American Securities Association, a brokerage group, said in a statement.
"The American people deserve an explanation for this unthinkable reversal," said Mr. Iacovella, whose group has backed tighter restrictions on Chinese stocks listed on U.S. exchanges.
The NYSE's intent is to comply with Mr. Trump's order, the person familiar with the matter said.
Some investors were feeling whiplash from the NYSE's moves. One individual investor said he had taken a major loss on shares in China Mobile because of the NYSE's original decision to delist the company.
He was holding the shares in hopes that Mr. Biden would ultimately reverse Mr. Trump's order but decided to sell after his brokerage notified him that investors could have trouble liquidating the shares, the investor said. That notification prompted him to sell the shares at a loss just before the NYSE reversed its decision.
China Mobile's NYSE-listed shares fell 5.9% Monday before the reversal was announced, then soared 9.3% Tuesday.
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Paul Kiernan contributed to this article.
Credit: By Alexander Osipovich

## DETAILS

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| Subject: | Stock exchanges; Presidents; Stock market delistings; Investments; Executive orders; Treasuries; New stock market listings; Bans |
| Business indexing term: | Subject: Stock exchanges Stock market delistings Treasuries New stock market listings; Corporation: China Mobile Ltd; Industry: 92111 : Executive Offices 52321 : Securities and Commodity Exchanges |
| Location: | China; United States--US |
| Company / organization: | Name: China Mobile Ltd; NAICS: 517112; Name: New York Stock Exchange--NYSE; NAICS: 523210 |
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## LINKS

Document 6 of 75

# U.S. News: Moderna Raises Its Production Estimate

Rockoff, Jonathan D . Rockoff, Jonathan D.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

Moderna Inc. said it would be able to make at least 600 million doses of its Covid-19 vaccine this year, 100 million more than it had been projecting.

The Cambridge, Mass., company also said it is making investments and adding staff to make as much as a billion doses in 2021.

Last month, Moderna's Covid-19 vaccine became the second to be authorized for use in the U.S. by the Food and Drug Administration, after a shot from Pfizer Inc. and partner BioNTech SE was cleared.

Both vaccines use a new, gene-based technology requiring special manufacturing equipment and expertise.

The companies have been racing to build capacity, often with the help of partners like Lonza Ltd., to meet heavy demand.

"Our effectiveness in providing early supply to the U.S. and Canadian governments and our ability to increase baseline production estimates for 2021 are both signals that our scale up of mRNA vaccine production is a success," said Juan Andres, Moderna's head of technical operations.

Moderna has agreed to supply 517 million doses world-wide with options to make 376 million more, according to Jefferies & Co., which projects the shots will generate at least $11 billion in sales this year.

Moderna says it has supplied about 18 million doses of its vaccine to the U.S. government so far.

It expects about 100 million doses to be available for use in the U.S. by the end of March and a total of 200 million doses.

The U.S. government has bought 200 million doses, with options to purchase 300 million more, and has been overseeing their distribution.

Canada, which also cleared Moderna's vaccine last month, has bought 40 million doses.

Israel on Monday became the third country to authorize Moderna's vaccine. Moderna said Israel has secured six million doses and that it would begin deliveries shortly.

Credit: By Jonathan D. Rockoff

## DETAILS

| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Vaccines; Coronaviruses; COVID-19; COVID-19 vaccines; Immunization |
| Business indexing term: | Corporation: Moderna Inc |
| Location: | United States--US; Israel |
| Company / organization: | Name: Moderna Inc; NAICS: 325414, 541714 |
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## LINKS

# U.S. News: Administration Now Ties Russia to Hack

Volz, Dustin . Volz, Dustin.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

WASHINGTON -- Russia is likely behind a massive, continuing hack discovered last month that has ripped through various federal government agencies and an unknown number of private organizations, the Trump administration formally said Tuesday.

In a joint statement, four agencies in charge of intelligence and cybersecurity said that the administration has so far identified fewer than 10 federal agencies whose internal computer systems were infiltrated in the hack. While the statement didn't identify any of the agencies, those affected include the departments of State, Treasury, Commerce and Energy, according to officials and others familiar with the investigation.

An advanced, government hacking group "likely Russian in origin is responsible for most or all of the recently discovered, ongoing cyber compromises of both government and non-governmental networks," said the statement, released by the Federal Bureau of Investigation, National Security Agency, Office of the Director of National Intelligence and Cybersecurity and Infrastructure Security Agency.

The statement was the first from the administration to link what is called the SolarWinds hack to Russia since the attack was first discovered nearly a month ago. Senior officials, including Secretary of State Mike Pompeo, have previously said in media interviews that Russia is believed to be responsible. Moscow has denied involvement.

President Trump has largely avoided speaking publicly about the attack, though on Twitter last month he said that China might be responsible. Officials have said there is no evidence linking the breaches to Beijing.

Current and former officials and cybersecurity experts have said the hack amounts to one of the worst intelligence failures on record.

"At this time, we believe this was, and continues to be, an intelligence gathering effort," the statement said.

Investigators have said the hackers used a malicious update to widely used software provided by a Texas-based network-management company called SolarWinds Corp. to compromise U.S. government agencies and scores of private businesses across the globe.

As it grapples with the hack, the Cybersecurity and Infrastructure Security Agency has been hit by a raft of dismissals originating at the White House.

Sara Sendek, the spokeswoman and director of public affairs at CISA, said the White House's personnel office informed her Monday evening that her services were no longer needed. The White House and CISA declined to comment.

Credit: By Dustin Volz

## DETAILS

| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Government agencies; Intelligence gathering; Cybersecurity |
| Location: | Russia; United States--US |

| | |
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| Company / organization: | Name: Cybersecurity & Infrastructure Security Agency; NAICS: 922120 |
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## LINKS

Document 8 of 75

# Saudis to Cut Output In Bid to Lift Oil Price

Said, Summer; Faucon, Benoit . Said, Summer; Faucon, Benoit.

## FULL TEXT

Saudi Arabia said it would unilaterally cut one million barrels a day of crude production starting next month, a surprise move signaling the kingdom's worry that a resurgent coronavirus is threatening global economic recovery.

The announcement Tuesday came after Riyadh agreed earlier in the day with other big producers to keep the group's collective output flat, after a now-monthly assessment by the Saudi-led OPEC cartel and a group of big producers led by Russia. In that deal, the two groups, collectively called OPEC-plus, agreed to a complex deal to hold production broadly unchanged from current levels.

Oil prices, which had already risen sharply on news of the OPEC-plus deal, soared on the Saudi announcement. In early-afternoon trading Tuesday, West Texas Intermediate futures, the U.S. benchmark, were up 5.2% a barrel, passing through the $50 mark for the first time since last February, though it settled up 4.6% at $49.93. Brent crude rose 4.9% to $53.60 a barrel.

Saudi Energy Minister Abdulaziz bin Salman said the unilateral move was made "with the purpose of supporting our economy, the economies of our friends and colleagues, the OPEC-plus countries, for the betterment of the industry."

It is far from clear whether the steep cut will continue to stabilize prices as virus cases climb sharply in many parts of the world, triggering new economic restrictions. For now, though, the move sent a stronger-than-expected message from the world's most flexible producer that it was committed to keeping prices buoyant.

While a boon to oil-dependent countries such as Saudi Arabia, the price rebound also is good news for an energy industry laid low by the demand-sucking pandemic. Oil companies including Exxon Mobil Corp. and Royal Dutch Shell PLC have taken large write-offs, cut jobs and slashed spending plans to adjust for what looked like a long period of low oil prices. Shell and BP PLC cut their dividends for the first time in years.

In recent months, though, prices started bouncing back more strongly than expected. Many economies in Asia, particularly China, seemed to have put the pandemic behind them. Several Western vaccines have been approved for use, raising hopes that governments there could help curb the spread of the virus, too, and get economies humming again.

Companies most likely to benefit from any sustained higher prices are the nimble U.S. shale producers that can more quickly ramp production up and down. If oil prices stay firmly above $50 per barrel, shale companies would spend about $62 billion this year on oil-and-gas production, about 11% more than they would have spent if prices were in the mid-$40 range, according to consulting firm Rystad Energy.

More recently, though, producers big and small have watched warily as virus cases soared in the U.S. and Europe and vaccine efforts, at least in the West, moved slower than many expected.

Saudi Arabia's move comes after it has ceded in recent years some of its oil-market clout to Russia. The two have long had a hot-cold relationship working to stabilize prices.

Christyan Malek, head of oil-and-gas research at JP Morgan, said the Saudi cut could hurt the kingdom's market share in the short term, but that it also underscored its unrivaled ability to quickly turn on and off the spigot to move prices.

Earlier Tuesday, an informal group of some of the world's biggest oil producers effectively agreed to maintain their collective oil output at current levels through February, warning of heightened risks to the global economy -- and to oil demand -- from a resurgent coronavirus.

In a statement confirming the deal, the consortium, which includes the 13-member Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries and a Russia-led group of 10 producers, said "rising infections, the return of stricter lockdown measures and growing uncertainties have resulted in a more fragile economic recovery."

The group has said it is committed to eventually restoring almost 10 million barrels a day -- or about 10% of pre-Covid-19 global demand -- of production that it cut at the beginning of the pandemic to steady prices. So far it has restored 2.5 million of those cuts. In recent months, it has signaled that restoring further production would take much

more time than anticipated.
The OPEC-plus deal wasn't straightforward. It publicly accommodated Russia's insistence that it be allowed to open its own taps to protect market share. OPEC-plus said Russia and Kazakhstan, which had both opposed keeping overall group production flat, would be allowed to increase output by a combined 75,000 barrels a day in both February and March.
The monthly allowance -- accounting for just 0.075% of 2019 global demand -- was interpreted by markets as a face-saving concession to Russia. Saudi Arabia, meanwhile, told delegates it would agree to compensate for the small boost by deepening its own cuts, meaning the group as a whole wouldn't lift production, according to delegates. But the kingdom didn't signal to fellow OPEC members or Russia the scale of its compensating cut.
At the height of last year's coronavirus outbreak, OPEC-plus agreed to cut output by a record 9.7 million barrels a day and envisioned restoring it in increments of two million barrels a day assuming rising demand. In the summer, the group moved to return the initial two million barrels, and last month agreed to add 500,000 barrels a day in January.
Russia initially was opposed to keeping current production levels and had pushed for an increase of another 500,000 barrels a day for February, delegates familiar with the discussion said. Moscow argued that demand would return as vaccinations make a dent in the pandemic, delegates said.
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Collin Eaton in Houston contributed to this article.
Credit: By Summer Said and Benoit Faucon

## DETAILS


| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Economic recovery; Energy economics; Energy industry; Coronaviruses; Pandemics; Market shares; COVID-19; Petroleum production; Global economy; Crude oil prices |
| Business indexing term: | Subject: Economic recovery Energy economics Energy industry Market shares Petroleum production Global economy Crude oil prices |
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| Company / organization: | Name: Organization of Petroleum Exporting Countries--OPEC; NAICS: 813910 |
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## LINKS

Document 9 of 75

# U.S. News: Most Stimulus Payments Made

Rubin, Richard; Saunders, Laura . Rubin, Richard; Saunders, Laura.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

WASHINGTON -- The U.S. Treasury Department has sent out more than $112 billion in stimulus payments electronically, meaning that about two-thirds of the second round of payments approved by Congress is already in households' bank accounts, according to data released Tuesday.

The payments -- $600 per adult and $600 per child -- were estimated to cost about $164 billion in all. They are part of a broader relief law last month that also includes unemployment insurance and money for small businesses.

The pace of payments is faster than in the spring, when the government made the first round of payments of $1,200 per adult and $500 per child. Then, about half the payments reached bank accounts within two weeks. Now, more than two-thirds of the money has gone out within about one week after President Trump signed the law passed by Congress.

In addition to the $112 billion in electronic payments, the government is also mailing checks and prepaid debit cards. It hasn't said how many payments have been made.

The speed stems in part from the work the government did to get bank account information from several groups of people in 2020: those who don't typically file tax returns, Social Security recipients and beneficiaries of other federal programs. That gave the government a longer list of up-to-date bank account information than it had in March and

April.

Credit: By Richard Rubin and Laura Saunders

## DETAILS



| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Bank accounts |
| Business indexing term: | Subject: Bank accounts |
| Location: | United States--US |
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## LINKS

Document 10 of 75

# World-Wide

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

The final day of voting in a pair of U.S. Senate runoff elections in Georgia capped a high-profile and costly fight that will determine which party will control the chamber as well as the scope of Biden's legislative agenda.
A group of GOP senators is zeroing in on three states as they hone plans to object to the Electoral College vote count, pushed by Trump to challenge a contest Biden won.

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Hong Kong police arrested dozens of pro-democracy politicians in a series of raids for alleged subversion under a national security law.

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The county prosecutor said he won't bring charges against the police officer who shot Jacob Blake, sparking weeks of violent unrest in Kenosha, Wis.

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Russia is likely behind a massive, continuing hack of government agencies and private organizations discovered last month, the Trump administration formally said.

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Venezuela's regime installed a rubber-stamp congress, challenging an opposition legislature run by lawmaker Juan Guaido that says it remains the nation's sole democratic institution.

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China sentenced the former chairman of one of the country's biggest state-owned asset-management companies to death on bribery and corruption charges.

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The Afghan government and the Taliban resumed peace talks, with recent killings and attacks underscoring the stakes as U.S. troops are withdrawn.

## DETAILS


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## LINKS

Document 11 of 75

# Georgia Senate Runoff Elections Are Close --- Tally shows leads going back and forth in races that will determine control of chamber

Jamerson, Joshua; McWhirter, Cameron; Bauerlein, Valerie . Jamerson, Joshua; McWhirter, Cameron; Bauerlein, Valerie.

## FULL TEXT

ATLANTA -- The final day of voting in a pair of U.S. Senate runoff elections in Georgia capped a high-profile and costly fight that left hanging the question of which party will control the chamber as well as the scope of President-elect Joe Biden's legislative agenda.

As Election Day drew to a close, both races were too close to call. The leads between the Democrats and Republicans seesawed throughout much of the night. One state election official said the race could be called by Wednesday morning, and another suggested it could take days for winners to become apparent.

The runoffs, held because none of the candidates won 50% of the vote in November, drew hundreds of millions of dollars in campaign spending as well as the nation's political attention for the past two months. The elections came as President Trump has alleged widespread voting irregularities in the state, which he lost to Mr. Biden in November by about 12,000 votes, but no evidence of significant fraud has been found after two recounts.

The vote also came a day before a group of Republican lawmakers are planning to object to the Electoral College vote count during a joint session of Congress, an effort pushed by Mr. Trump as part of his last-ditch bid to overturn the vote result.

In one race, Republican David Perdue, 71 years old, faced 33-year-old Democrat Jon Ossoff. Mr. Perdue spent the past six years as a Georgia senator and is up for re-election after his term ended on Sunday. Mr. Ossoff, a documentary filmmaker, is seeking to win his first elected office.

In the other race, Republican Sen. Kelly Loeffler, 50, ran against Democrat Raphael Warnock, pastor of the Rev. Martin Luther King Jr.'s former church in Atlanta. Ms. Loeffler was appointed to her post last year and was vying to be the first woman elected senator from Georgia. Mr. Warnock, 51, would be the state's first Black elected senator.

With Republicans holding a 51-48 Senate majority, Democrats had a chance to gain control of the chamber with both wins because Vice President-elect Kamala Harris would cast tie-breaking votes.

More than three million votes were cast before Tuesday in early in-person voting and mail-in ballots, underscoring the high interest in the two races. In a state where lines at polling stations during high-interest elections have been common, Georgia Secretary of State Brad Raffensperger said Tuesday that voting was going smoothly. Election officials said they had gotten better at processing Election Day voters, potentially leading to shorter lines across the state.

Democrats were encouraged by the results. DeKalb County -- home to a large chunk of Atlanta, a Democratic stronghold -- saw Election Day voting surpass the turnout on Nov. 3, county officials said.

In the afternoon, voting also picked up in several Republican strongholds, including Cherokee County. In a briefing to donors Tuesday, GOP operative Karl Rove said he was confident of the turnout, a person familiar with his remarks said. With the results largely counted, the exurbs on the outer ring of the Atlanta area didn't appear to be delivering margins as large as they have in the past for the Republican candidates.

President Trump, a Republican, weighed in at night, pre-emptively rebuking the specter of late-reporting counties in Democratic areas overcoming GOP leads. "Looks like they are setting up a big 'voter dump' against the Republican candidates. Waiting to see how many votes they need?" Mr. Trump tweeted, without providing any evidence of election fraud.

Top Georgia election officials, who are Republicans, have repeatedly said they run free and fair elections. On Tuesday, they urged Georgians -- and all Americans -- to have confidence in the outcome. "I can assure you that it'll be a fair and honest election," Mr. Raffensperger said on Fox News.

Both parties believed Democrats likely had an advantage in the early vote, making the Tuesday turnout important for Republicans. Mr. Ossoff said he felt confident about Democrats' chances of winning because of party infrastructure that has allowed them to run competitive races, especially after the close but unsuccessful race of the 2018

Democratic nominee for governor, Stacey Abrams.
"This is the culmination of many years of work and struggle," Mr. Ossoff said.
The campaigns of Ms. Loeffler and Mr. Perdue said in a joint statement that they were encouraged by turnout but urged more of their supporters to get out and vote.
"Make no mistake about it: this is going to a very close election and could come down to the difference of just a few votes in a few precincts across the state," the pair said.
Election workers in Georgia's 159 counties were processing the day's votes as well as absentee and early-voting ballots after the polls closed Tuesday evening. In November, final results took weeks to be certified. With spending exceeding $500 million, the races are among the most expensive Senate contests in history.
The races were overshadowed by Mr. Trump's claims since November that the results of the presidential election -- which showed him narrowly losing in Georgia -- were false.
Mr. Trump has directed much of his ire at Republican state officials, including Gov. Brian Kemp and Mr. Raffensperger, who launched a statewide hand recount of all five million ballots cast, a process observed by representatives from both parties. That recount found Mr. Biden, a Democrat, won. A second recount, requested by the Trump campaign and this time a scan of the paper ballots, also found Mr. Biden won.
As voting was under way Tuesday, Mr. Trump called attention in a tweet to a reported problem with voting machines in Columbia County, near Augusta. The Georgia secretary of state's office said a few pieces of equipment, known as poll-worker cards and keys, were programmed incorrectly but that the issues were resolved and voting wasn't stopped.
On Sunday, media outlets obtained a recording of a roughly hourlong conversation the president and advisers held Saturday with Mr. Raffensperger in which the president told the state official that he could face legal action and said he wanted him to find nearly 12,000 votes so he could reverse Mr. Biden's victory.
Democratic voters in Atlanta said they were hopeful Messrs. Warnock and Ossoff could win following Mr. Biden's November victory, but some were still skeptical it would mean Democrats could enact whatever legislation they want.
Lamar Person of Atlanta, who is Black, wants Democrats to be able to put forth legislation addressing the use of force by police officers and getting better control over the Covid-19 pandemic, which has particularly hit communities of color. "That'll all at least be on the forefront . . . more so than with the Republicans," Mr. Person said.
In rural Guyton, Ashley Pearson waited to vote Tuesday at a school so she could fill out, print and check her ballot, and insert it into the counting machine with her own hands.
The hospitality manager, who is white, considered for a short time not voting in the runoff but said the stakes were too high in Congress on issues she cares about, such as gun rights and funding for law enforcement. "This state is not blue," she said, of Mr. Trump's narrow loss here in November.
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Alexa Corse and Lindsay Wise contributed to this article.
Credit: By Joshua Jamerson, Cameron McWhirter and Valerie Bauerlein

## DETAILS

| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Election results; Voting machines; Presidential elections; Voter behavior; COVID-19; Congressional elections; State elections |
| Business indexing term: | Industry: 92111 : Executive Offices 92112 : Legislative Bodies |
| Location: | Atlanta Georgia; Georgia; United States--US |
| People: | Trump, Donald J; Loeffler, Kelly; Warnock, Raphael |

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| Company / organization: | Name: Republican Party; NAICS: 813940; Name: Congress; NAICS: 921120; Name: Senate-US; NA ICS: 921120 |
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## LINKS

Document 12 of 75

# U.S. News: Opioid Use Rising in Construction

Monga, Vipal . Monga, Vipal.



## FULL TEXT

Mark St. Cyr, a construction superintendent in the Pittsburgh area, often sees telltale signs of opioid use among workers at sites where he works.

"If I'm supervising 10 guys, two or three will be using almost every day," said Mr. St. Cyr, who is 57 and in recovery from his own opioid addiction. He's quick to notice users' pinprick eyes and jaundiced skin.

Opioid use, and deaths from overdoses, has jumped across North America during the Covid-19 pandemic. The Centers for Disease Control and Prevention in December said the U.S. would record 81,230 drug deaths in the 12 months through May, a record, up from 68,829 deaths during the same period ended in May 2019.

The construction industry, already facing a shortage of manual labor, has been hit particularly hard. Bricklayers, carpenters and laborers carry heavy loads and perform the same tasks day in and day out, leading to injuries like carpal tunnel syndrome, strained shoulders and bad backs. Seeking relief, workers can get hooked on strong prescription drugs such as fentanyl, oxycodone and morphine, and street drugs like heroin.

"There are higher levels of pain in construction than in other industries," said Vicky Waldron, executive director for the Vancouver-based Construction Industry Rehabilitation Plan, a nonprofit set up by labor unions and construction companies for drug-abuse treatment.

In a 2019 report by Barclays Research that examined data from the Bureau of Labor Statistics and the National Institute on Drug Abuse, the bank's analysts said that opioid use in the U.S. has made workers in the industry less productive and has increased costs to the industry. While the precise number of overdose deaths in the North American construction industry is hard to determine, the workers are roughly six times as likely as workers in other manufacturing industrial and services industries to become addicted to opioids, according to the report.

That toll, in turn, is aggravating an existing labor shortage. According to a fourth-quarter survey of the commercial construction industry by the U.S. Chamber of Commerce, 83% of contractors reported having difficulty finding skilled workers.

The costs add up. A worker with a substance-use disorder costs companies $4,700 per worker yearly on average in health-care costs, according to the National Safety Council. That is 62% more than the $2,900 estimated health-care cost for nonusers.

Some industry groups, such as the Keystone Contractors Association in Pennsylvania, are stepping up efforts to tackle the problem. The association joined in 2018 with the National Safety Council to create educational materials for companies to teach workers about the dangers of prescription painkillers and drug use.

Other treatment and rehabilitation programs are being led by unions, such as John Anderson's local. Mr. Anderson, a 28-year-old elevator mechanic who works in New York City, became addicted to Percocet and OxyContin when he started his first construction job framing houses at age 19. He found that he could get more work done when he was high and unable to feel the strain of the job.

"I was doing my thing, doing my work, and life didn't become a mess," he said. "It was no harm, no foul."

Eventually, however, he found he couldn't even get to work without the drugs and spent almost all his money on the pills. When those became too expensive or difficult to find, he switched to heroin.

The heroin use led to arrests, lapses at work, and several stints in rehab facilities. Finally, he turned to his union, Local One of the New York and New Jersey chapter of the International Union of Elevator Constructors, which had just started a recovery and treatment program for members. He has now been clean for three years.

The elevator union has a full-time person on staff to help coordinate recovery and education efforts for members and their families. Brendan Loftus, himself a recovering alcoholic, started the program in 2016 after he went to his fifth funeral for a colleague who overdosed on opioids. He said the drug toll was being ignored.
"If you had five guys die in the field from other accidents, people would have been up in arms," he said.
Credit: By Vipal Monga

## DETAILS

| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Drug overdose; Workers; Heroin; Construction industry; Prescription drugs; Elevators & escalators; Costs; Labor unions; Substance abuse treatment; COVID-19; Narcotics |
| Business indexing term: | Subject: Workers Construction industry Costs Labor unions; Industry: 81393 : Labor Unions and Similar Labor Organizations |
| Location: | United States--US |
| Company / organization: | Name: National Safety Council; NAICS: 813319 |
| Classification: | 81393: Labor Unions and Similar Labor Organizations |
| Publication title: | Wall Street Journal, Eastern edition; New York, N.Y. |
| First page: | A.3 |
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| Publisher: | Dow Jones & Company Inc. |
| Place of publication: | New York, N.Y. |
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| Language of publication: | English |
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| ProQuest document ID: | 2475244584 |
| Document URL: | https://www.proquest.com/newspapers/u-s-news-opioid-use-rising-construction/docview/2475244584/se-2?accountid=14681 |
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## LINKS

Document 13 of 75

# World-Wide

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

Trump disparaged Senate Republicans who aren't backing further challenges to Biden's presidential victory, further roiling a party that has split over whether to support Trump's attempts to stay in power or accept the incumbent's loss.

Georgians were bracing for Tuesday's Senate runoff elections with their state in the spotlight after Trump urged state officials to nullify Biden's November win.

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Saudi Arabia moved to end a yearslong regional dispute with Qatar, taking a first step toward resolving a bitter feud that has fractured the Middle East and hampered U.S. efforts to isolate Iran.

Iran said it has resumed enriching uranium to 20% purity, exceeding limits set in a 2015 nuclear deal and slashing the time it would take for Tehran to produce weapons-grade fuel.

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Lopez Obrador said Mexico would offer Assange political asylum after a British judge refused to order the WikiLeaks founder's extradition to the U.S. on spying charges.

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Johnson ordered schools and nonessential shops across England to shut amid spiraling infection rates caused by a new coronavirus variant.

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The House passed rules that weakened a procedural tool Republicans had used to force Democrats to take tough political votes.

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Trump awarded the Presidential Medal of Freedom to Rep. Nunes, bestowing the nation's top civilian honor on a close Republican ally.

## DETAILS

| | |
|---|---|
| Location: | Iran; United States--US |

| | |
|---|---|
| Company / organization: | Name: Senate; NAICS: 921120 |
| Publication title: | Wall Street Journal, Eastern edition; New York, N.Y. |
| First page: | A.1 |
| Publication year: | 2021 |
| Publication date: | Jan 5, 2021 |
| column: | World-Wide |
| Section: | What's News |
| Publisher: | Dow Jones & Company Inc. |
| Place of publication: | New York, N.Y. |
| Country of publication: | United States |
| Publication subject: | Business And Economics--Banking And Finance |
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| Language of publication: | English |
| Document type: | News |
| ProQuest document ID: | 2475028524 |
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## LINKS

Document 14 of 75

# NYSE Scraps Chinese Delistings

Chong, Koh Ping; Otto, Ben . Chong, Koh Ping; Otto, Ben.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

The New York Stock Exchange reversed its decision to delist China's three largest telecommunications companies, after consulting with regulatory authorities about a recent U.S. investment ban.

In a statement released late Monday in New York, the Big Board said "it no longer intends to move forward with the delisting action" on China Mobile Ltd., China Telecom Corp. and China Unicom (Hong Kong) Ltd.

The Hong Kong-listed shares of the three telecom majors surged on the news. Shares of China Mobile, which is among the most valuable of China's listed state-owned enterprises, rose as much as 7.5% in late morning trade on Tuesday, while China Telecom and China Unicom jumped 8.1% and 11%, respectively.

NYSE's earlier plan to delist the companies followed a U.S. government order, signed by President Trump in November, that prohibits Americans from investing in a list of companies the U.S. government says supply and support China's military, intelligence and security services.

The trading ban was supposed to start on Jan. 11, and investors would have until November to shed their holdings.

The NYSE had sent out a notification about its plans to commence delisting procedures around New Year's Day, while markets were closed. The surprise announcement roiled the Hong Kong-listed shares and American depositary receipts of the three companies on Monday after trading resumed, as large and small investors scrambled to figure out what to do with their American depositary share holdings.

The current blacklist covers 35 companies, including the privately held parents of the three listed telecom companies, as well as China's largest chip maker, surveillance, aerospace, shipbuilding, construction and technology companies.

The U.S. Treasury Department's Office of Foreign Assets Control, which handles economic sanctions, has said the ban covers derivatives and depositary receipts, as well as exchange-traded funds, index funds and mutual funds.

Last week, the Treasury said it would add subsidiaries to the blacklist if they were majority owned -- or controlled -- by a company that has been named.

The NYSE on Monday said it had further discussions with "relevant regulatory authorities" about the Treasury Department's recent statement on its intention to publicly name the subsidiaries of the banned groups.

"At this time, the Issuers will continue to be listed and traded on the NYSE," the exchange said, adding its regulation arm will continue to evaluate how the executive order applies to the three telecom companies and their continued listing status.

China Mobile has been listed on the Big Board for more than two decades, while China Unicom and China Telecom have been traded on the exchange since 2000 and 2002 respectively. All had raised billions of dollars in their initial public offerings.

Some analysts said the delisting would likely force some American investors to sell their shares when they were trading near multiyear lows.

The China Securities Regulatory Commission on Sunday said the U.S. government "implemented the administrative order for political purposes, completely ignoring the actual situation of the companies concerned and the legitimate rights and interests of global investors, and seriously disrupting the normal market rules and order."

In separate statements released a day earlier, the three Chinese telecom companies said their American depositary receipts represent ownership of 3.3% to 8% of the companies' tradable shares, and account for 9% to 22% of total trading volumes, when both ADRs and Hong Kong shares are considered.

On Tuesday, China Unicom and China Telecom noted the NYSE's updated decision and said they will continue to

monitor developments.
Credit: By Chong Koh Ping and Ben Otto

## DETAILS

| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Blacklisting; Stock market delistings; Investments; Bans |
| Business indexing term: | Subject: Stock market delistings; Corporation: China Unicom Ltd China Mobile Ltd |
| Location: | China; Hong Kong; New York; United States--US |
| Company / organization: | Name: China Mobile Ltd; NAICS: 517112; Name: New York Stock Exchange--NYSE; NAICS: 523210; Name: China Unicom Ltd; NAICS: 517111, 517112 |
| Publication title: | Wall Street Journal, Eastern edition; New York, N.Y. |
| First page: | B.1 |
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| Language of publication: | English |
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## LINKS



# U.S. News: Vaccine Makers Struggle to Fill Jobs

Koh, Elizabeth . Koh, Elizabeth.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

Contract-manufacturing companies working to accelerate the global availability of Covid-19 vaccines are struggling with a shortage of their own: There aren't enough workers to meet this year's big production push.

The talent pool is so tight that Emergent BioSolutions Inc., a Covid-19 contractor based in Gaithersburg, Md., for AstraZeneca PLC and Johnson & Johnson, enlisted its CEO and a half-dozen other senior executives to pitch potential hires at a virtual career fair in October. More than 550 people attended.

Not enough of them were swayed. More than two months later, Emergent still has roughly 200 openings for warehouse associates, quality-assurance analysts and even a supply-chain management director.

"Hiring and ramping up has become challenging," said Sean Kirk, an Emergent executive vice president, who spoke at the event.

Outsourcing companies such as Emergent make about one-sixth of complex treatments including vaccines, but the scale and abruptness of Covid-19 shots is likely to boost that share much higher, say industry executives and experts.

With demand dwarfing supply, Pfizer Inc., Moderna Inc. and others are turning to contract manufacturers for assistance in what is the largest pharmaceutical rollout in modern history.

But those helping drugmakers need more help themselves. More than 5,000 open jobs exist at the world's 10 largest companies that have won Covid-19 outsourcing work, according to a Wall Street Journal analysis of the companies' websites. The firms were ranked by production capacity.

The labor crunch is another potential drag on a global vaccine rollout already facing a supply backlog and requiring near-flawless logistics. Many contract manufacturers are trying to fill roles that often require years of experience in pharmaceutical manufacturing or biotechnology-related degrees. They are also struggling to hire workers willing to work overnight shifts, as production goes round-the-clock. The jobs are likely to be permanent.

"We are truly in unprecedented territory because of the world-wide demand outstripping supply," said Rena Conti, a Boston University business professor who studies biopharmaceutical supply chains.

Many contract manufacturers were already staffing up before the pandemic. Demand has soared for niche production of complex medications treating diseases such as breast cancer or rheumatoid arthritis, taken by a minority of the population. But Covid-19 vaccines have created a massive new product category where the potential market is every person on Earth.

World production of Covid-19 vaccines is expected to reach six billion doses in 2021, according to industry tracker PharmSource. Nearly every major pharmaceutical company with a potential vaccine candidate has enlisted contract manufacturers to help meet production targets.

Catalent Inc., one of the largest contract manufacturers in the U.S., has leaned into unusual recruiting strategies, including ads on the radio-streaming app, Pandora, targeting people who live near its manufacturing plants. It offers

$3,000 sign-on bonuses for its manufacturing associates willing to work overnight shifts at its Madison, Wis., facility.
The company, based in Somerset, N.J., has hundreds of unfilled jobs, which could directly affect how much extra production it can allot to Covid-19 vaccines, said Bernie Clark, Catalent's vice president of marketing and strategy.
The company has signed multiple Covid-19 vaccine contracts.
"To keep adding capacity and new lines, you have to have the people to run them," Mr. Clark said.
Credit: By Elizabeth Koh

## DETAILS


| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Pharmaceutical industry; Vaccines; Production capacity; Coronaviruses; Employment; Executives; COVID-19; COVID-19 vaccines; Immunization; Manufacturing |
| Business indexing term: | Subject: Pharmaceutical industry Production capacity Employment Executives Manufacturing; Industry: 32541 : Pharmaceutical and Medicine Manufacturing |
| Location: | United States--US |
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| Document URL: | https://www.proquest.com/newspapers/u-s-news-vaccine-makers-struggle-fill-jobs/docview/2475028511/se-2?accountid=14681 |
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## LINKS

Document 16 of 75

# U.S. News: EPA Narrows Use Of Science in Rules

Puko, Timothy . Puko, Timothy.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

WASHINGTON -- The Environmental Protection Agency is issuing new rules that will give preference in future decisions about public health to scientific studies that disclose their underlying data.

The policy change, in the works since the start of the Trump administration, has been opposed by public-health experts, scientists and former staff. They say it could undermine the agency's effectiveness, and in many cases it is impossible to require these types of disclosures without violating patient confidentiality.

EPA Administrator Andrew Wheeler said the changes are aimed at increasing transparency so that the public has a chance to scrutinize findings that underlie major regulations.

"By shining light on the science we use in decisions, we are helping to restore trust in government," Mr. Wheeler wrote in a commentary published by The Wall Street Journal on Monday. "We want the EPA to be able to say, 'you can check our work.'"

Many public-health studies rely on information about individual patient health that is required to be kept confidential, which may now exclude groundbreaking health findings from EPA consideration, critics say.

The rules apply to the EPA's consideration of "dose-response studies," used to figure out how much exposure to a chemical or pollutant increases the risk to a person's health. Those determinations are fundamental to many core EPA rules on public health.

In future decisions, the agency must now give greater consideration to studies in this area in which underlying dose-response data is available for independent validation. And when it proposes new regulations it must make available to the public that science that informs the rule.

The rule won't categorically exclude any data, Mr. Wheeler wrote, adding that the new practices can be done without releasing personal information or violating confidentiality.

The rule will prevent agency leaders from trying "to cherry-pick research to derive politically helpful results," he wrote.

It outlines specific criteria for when the administrator can make case-by-case exemptions to these requirements.

Several scientists and health experts have questioned Mr. Wheeler's claims. The disclosure requirement is more likely to narrow what research will be considered, they said.

"If left unchallenged, this rule would essentially bar the agency from using the most relevant medical studies when creating rules about air pollution, toxic chemicals, water contaminants," Chris Zarba, a former director of the EPA's

Science Advisory Board, said in a statement. "The rule . . . doesn't ensure transparency in science, but rather is detrimental to high-quality impartial decision-making."
Mr. Zarba was joined in the statement by other former EPA employees, who say the change will benefit industrial interests by excluding certain types of studies.
They noted the EPA has long had a public review process for the science it uses.
Credit: By Timothy Puko

## DETAILS

| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Public health; Science; Outdoor air quality; Decision making; Confidentiality |
| Company / organization: | Name: Environmental Protection Agency--EPA; NAICS: 924110 |
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## LINKS



# U.S. News: House Weakens Tool Used by Minority

Andrews, Natalie . Andrews, Natalie.



## FULL TEXT

WASHINGTON -- The House passed rules that weakened a procedural tool Republicans had used to force Democrats to take tough political votes as well as added exemptions to a budget rule that progressives deemed a win.

The rules package for the new Congress passed on partisan lines in a 217-206 vote Monday. The rules are set by the majority party's leadership and must be passed at the start of each session of Congress.

The new package strengthens congressional oversight, seeks to protect whistleblowers and specifically defines that any current and former White House employees can be subpoenaed. It also renews proxy voting, which allows lawmakers to vote remotely during the pandemic by designating a lawmaker to vote on their behalf. Republicans object to the remote voting rule and are disputing it in court, though some GOP lawmakers have used it.

The package also instructs lawmakers to honor all gender identities by changing pronouns and familial relationships in the House rules to be gender-neutral. Among specific changes, the new rules strike "himself or herself" and insert "themself," and changes "chairman" to "chair." The rules also change familial terms to make them gender neutral, changing "uncle" and "aunt" to "parent's sibling," for example. The changes affect the language in House rules but doesn't apply to lawmakers' own language or legislative proposals.

Democrats said the rules change was designed to reflect the increasingly diverse Congress, but Republicans said the move was absurd.

Notably, the new rules also include a change to a House procedure called a motion to recommit, a procedural vote that the minority can use to change legislation in a final amendment vote before legislation passes. The rules adopted on Monday would prevent the procedural vote from altering bills on the floor directly before passage. Instead, the minority would only be able to use the motion to send a bill back to the committee.

Republicans in the last session effectively used the motion to recommit for political messaging and to trap the majority into taking difficult votes on a part of the legislation and occasionally getting GOP provisions through the Democratic-controlled body.

The change was pushed by Democrats likely to face competitive re-election races who are leery of votes that can then be turned into attack ads. Democrats argued that Republicans often aren't proposing amendments in good faith because they often end up voting against the final legislation.

"The only thing being taken away is their gotcha opportunities," said Majority Leader Steny Hoyer (D., Md.) about the Republicans.

"The Democrat majority is just coming right out and admitting that they are unable to stand by their caucus's radical beliefs," said Rep. Ted Budd (R., N.C.).

The rules package also changes the longstanding pay-as-you-go, or PAYGO, provision that says legislation that would increase the deficit needs to be offset. Progressives sought to eliminate the provision so they could push for

legislation that doesn't have a direct offset, such as Medicare for All or the Green New Deal. Moderate Blue Dog Democrats argued for specific exemptions, rather than a complete end to PAYGO, according to a senior Democratic aide.
The resulting compromise gives the Budget Committee chairman the ability to declare bills that respond to the pandemic or seek to combat climate change as having no cost, effectively exempting them from the PAYGO rules.
Credit: By Natalie Andrews

## DETAILS

| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Legislation; Congressional investigations; Legislators; Pandemics; Gender |
| Business indexing term: | Industry: 92112 : Legislative Bodies |
| Company / organization: | Name: Republican Party; NAICS: 813940; Name: Congress; NAICS: 921120 |
| Classification: | 92112: Legislative Bodies |
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| ProQuest document ID: | 2475028508 |
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## LINKS

Document 18 of 75

# U.S. News: Travel Reaches Pandemic High Over Holidays

Melanie Grayce West . Melanie Grayce West.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

More than 1.3 million people traveled through U.S. airports on Sunday, the highest number since March and an indication that many didn't heed public-health warnings to avoid travel and gatherings with family and friends during the Christmas and New Year holidays.
For seven of the past nine days, more than one million people passed through airport checkpoints daily, according to data from the Transportation Security Administration. The number of travelers moving through airports around the Christmas holidays mirrors the number who traveled immediately before and after Thanksgiving.
Compared with last year, however, travel is significantly down: Some 2.4 million people traveled on Jan. 3, 2020.
Health authorities, including the U.S. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, have maintained that the risk of infection on airplanes is low. But as a fall surge of the coronavirus strained hospitals across the country, public-health experts and the CDC urged people not to travel over the holidays, and instead recommended that people remain at home and celebrate only with those in their households.
Public-health authorities have said that small gatherings and shared meals led to post-Thanksgiving Day spikes of Covid-19 cases around the country, and predicted that Christmas and New Year's would lead to similar surges.
In the past seven days, there have been some 1.5 million new cases of Covid-19 in the U.S., according to the CDC. U.S. hospitalizations on Sunday were at a record-high of 125,544 people, according to analysis from the Covid Tracking Project. Data is still likely affected by the holidays, when closed offices and limited staffing lead to lags in reporting.
The seven-day moving average of newly reported cases on Sunday was 213,437, according to a Wall Street Journal analysis of Johns Hopkins data, topping 200,000 once again after a slight drop during the Christmas holidays. The 14-day average was 198,781. When the seven-day average exceeds the 14-day average, it suggests cases are on the rise.
Credit: By Melanie Grayce West

## DETAILS

| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Holidays & special occasions; Coronaviruses; Christmas; COVID-19; Airline security; Airports |
| Business indexing term: | Subject: Airports; Industry: 48811 : Airport Operations |
| Location: | United States--US |
| Classification: | 48811: Airport Operations |
| Publication title: | Wall Street Journal, Eastern edition; New York, N.Y. |
| First page: | A. 3 |
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| Publication date: | Jan 5, 2021 |
| Publisher: | Dow Jones & Company Inc. |
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| Country of publication: | United States |
| Publication subject: | Business And Economics--Banking And Finance |
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| ProQuest document ID: | 2475028501 |
| Document URL: | https://www.proquest.com/newspapers/u-s-news-travel-reaches-pandemic-high-over/docview/2475028501/se-2?accountid=14681 |
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## LINKS

# World News: Mexican President Offers Asylum

de Cordoba, Jose . de Cordoba, Jose.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

MEXICO CITY -- President Andres Manuel Lopez Obrador offered political asylum to Julian Assange after a British court denied a U.S. request to extradite the founder of WikiLeaks to face spying charges.

Mr. Lopez Obrador on Monday said Mexico would ask the U.K. government about the possibility of freeing Mr. Assange, and that Mexico would offer him asylum.

"Therefore, a pardon for Mr. Assange, pardon and asylum," he said.

Mr. Lopez Obrador said Mexico was happy that the British court had denied the U.S. extradition request, which he called a "triumph for justice." He said Mr. Assange is a journalist who deserves an opportunity.

A British judge denied the U.S. request because she said it would put Mr. Assange, who faces espionage charges for publishing secret documents pertaining to the wars in Iraq and Afghanistan, at risk of suicide if he was sent to the U.S. to await trial in a maximum security prison.

Mr. Lopez Obrador said the right to asylum is part of Mexico's foreign-policy tradition, "which is protection, but at the same time carries the responsibility of making sure the person receiving asylum doesn't intervene, doesn't interfere in political matters of any country."

Credit: By Jose de Cordoba

## DETAILS

| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Mayors; Political asylum; Papal visits |
| Business indexing term: | Industry: 92111 : Executive Offices |
| Location: | Mexico; United States--US |
| People: | Lopez Obrador, Andres Manuel |
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## LINKS

Document 20 of 75

# U.S. News: Georgia Girds For Senate Runoff Vote

Jamerson, Joshua; McWhirter, Cameron; Corse, Alexa . Jamerson, Joshua; McWhirter, Cameron; Corse, Alexa.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

DALTON, Ga. -- Georgians were bracing for Tuesday's Senate runoff elections with their state in the political spotlight after President Trump urged state officials in a weekend phone call to nullify President-elect Joe Biden's win in the November vote.

Gabriel Sterling, voting system implementation manager at the Georgia secretary of state's office, on Monday debunked a host of inaccurate claims by the president and his allies about fraud in the state's Nov. 3 election during a news conference at the state Capitol.

Mr. Trump's campaign and a Trump elector previously said that data indicated that more than 66,000 voters under the age of 18 illegally voted. But state officials found that no underage voters cast ballots, Mr. Sterling said.
"This is all easily, provably false. Yet the president persists and, by doing so, undermines Georgians' faith in the election system," Mr. Sterling said.
Mr. Trump's campaign earlier said as many as 2,560 felons voted illegally. Mr. Sterling said Monday that state officials have access to better data. He said 74 potential cases are under investigation but some of those people may have been eligible to vote for reasons such as having completed their sentences.
There are potentially two cases of ballots cast by people who died before the election, Mr. Sterling said, but that is still being investigated. That data contradicts a claim that there were more than 10,000 votes from people who died before the election, he said.
"If you're a Georgia voter, if you want your values reflected by your elected officials, I strongly beg and encourage you, go vote tomorrow. Do not let anybody discourage you," Mr. Sterling said.
Asked about Mr. Sterling's remarks, Trump campaign senior legal adviser Jenna Ellis said in a statement, in part: "The Trump Legal Team has presented facts and evidence, including witnesses and expert testimony" that she argued show there were election issues.
The secretary of state's office said Monday it had received reports of some counties preparing to bolster security at some polling stations. Bishop Reginald T. Jackson, who oversees Georgia's African Methodist Episcopal churches and is head of a nonpartisan faith-based voter-turnout organization, said some get-out-the-vote rallies were canceled over the weekend because of threats and several churches that planned to serve as polling stations had received bomb threats.
"Our community is deeply concerned for our congregations' safety and the voting rights of every Georgian," the bishop said.
Late Monday, Mr. Trump held a rally in Dalton on behalf of Republican candidates David Perdue and Kelly Loeffler, both locked in close races. Mr. Perdue, whose term as senator expired Sunday at noon, is battling Democrat Jon Ossoff to return to Washington. Ms. Loeffler -- appointed last year to fill a Senate seat vacated by Sen. Johnny Isakson, who retired -- is running in a special election against Democrat Raphael Warnock to finish two years of that term.
Before Mr. Trump arrived in Georgia, Ms. Loeffler said that she would be joining about a dozen GOP senators to object to certifying Mr. Biden's 306-232 Electoral College win.
Taking the stage before a crowd of thousands, Mr. Trump immediately declared his election rigged and claimed victory. "They're not taking this White House, we're going to fight like hell."
He urged voters to support the candidates. If Republicans lose the seats, he said, Democrats could push through their agenda. "America as you know it will be over," Mr. Trump said. "That's why I'm here. I don't want to do rallies for other people . . . . if you don't show up the radical Democrats will win."
Mr. Biden traveled to Atlanta for a campaign event for the Democratic candidates hours ahead of Mr. Trump.
He didn't directly mention the president but said generally that the Republican Party ought to have more respect for election results. "In America, as our opposition friends are finding out, all power flows from the people," Mr. Biden said. "That's our democracy. Politicians cannot assert, take or seize power. Power is given -- granted -- by the American people alone."
The races are some of the most expensive for the Senate in history, and the results will determine which party controls the chamber.
More than three million Georgians had already voted early in the runoff elections before news broke Sunday of the weekend conversation during which Mr. Trump urged Georgia Secretary of State Brad Raffensperger and his staff to overturn November's presidential election results.
Throughout the conversation, Mr. Raffensperger, who oversaw the state's elections, rejected pressure to further investigate an election that has gone through multiple recounts and legal challenges without any evidence of widespread fraud being found. His office on Monday expressed confidence in Tuesday's voting as well.
"President Trump and Georgia GOP chairman David Shafer have run around this state saying 'You can't trust the

voting machines, you can't trust absentee ballots,' which has left many Republican voters wondering, 'Will my vote even count?'" said Mr. Raffensperger's spokesman, Ari Schaffer. "Our office believes every vote counts. Your vote matters."

In a response by text, Mr. Shafer said: "I have criticized Raffensperger for weakening signature verification and refusing to allow meaningful observation of the verification process. Our only remedy at this point is to turn out the vote tomorrow. The more of us who vote, the harder it is for them to cheat."

GOP politicians in Georgia who have come under attack from Mr. Trump since November include Gov. Brian Kemp, a onetime ally Mr. Trump endorsed in 2018. On the Saturday call, Mr. Trump called Mr. Kemp "a disaster" and said, "Like a schmuck I endorsed him." On Fox News Sunday night, Mr. Kemp said, "I haven't listened to the tape. I would just say all those things to me right now are distractions. The thing that matters is Tuesday."

Vice President Mike Pence, campaigning Monday in Milner, Ga., said that he shared concerns about whether the November election was conducted fairly. "I know we all have got our doubts about the last election," he said. "I promise you come this Wednesday, we will have our day in Congress; tomorrow is Georgia's day," Mr. Pence said, noting the effort by some Republicans to object to certifying Mr. Biden's win.

Some Georgia Republican voters were disturbed by news of Mr. Trump's Saturday conversation. Emory Morsberger, a former Republican state representative who voted for Mr. Trump in 2016, said he had planned to vote for Mr. Perdue and against Ms. Loeffler in the contests. He changed his mind after learning of the president's call and voted against both Republicans. He dropped his absentee ballot off Monday.

"We need to get rid of the whole Trump mentality," Mr. Morsberger said. "Trump and Trump puppets need to go. It's embarrassing for our country. We need to clear out support for this kind of goofiness."

Representatives for Ms. Loeffler didn't respond to requests to comment.

Mr. Perdue said Monday on Fox News that it was "disgusting" that the president's conversation was leaked to the news media, and renewed his call for Mr. Raffensperger to resign. He said a day earlier that he didn't think the news of the conversation would alter the outcome of the runoffs.

"A lot of people in Georgia and 75 million Americans I think align with him right now that something untoward happened here in Georgia, and we have not gotten to the bottom of it," Mr. Perdue said.

State Republican officials and former U.S. Attorney General William Barr have said there is no evidence of widespread voter fraud.

The Senate currently has 50 Republicans and 48 members of the Democratic caucus. If Democrats win both Georgia races, they will gain control because Vice President-elect Kamala Harris would cast tiebreaking votes.

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Lindsay Wise in Washington contributed to this article.

Credit: By Joshua Jamerson, Cameron McWhirter and Alexa Corse

## DETAILS

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|---|---|
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| Business indexing term: | Industry: 92111 : Executive Offices |
| Location: | United States--US; Georgia |
| People: | Trump, Donald J |
| Company / organization: | Name: Senate; NAICS: 921120; Name: Republican Party; NAICS: 813940; Name: Fox News Channel; NAICS: 516120 |

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## LINKS

Document 21 of 75

# U.S. News: Manufacturers Ended Year on High Note

Hannon, Paul; Omeokwe, Amara . Hannon, Paul; Omeokwe, Amara.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

Factories in the U.S., Asia and Europe boosted their output as 2020 drew to a close, aided by a rise in new orders and a revival in trade that has continued despite a sharp rise in coronavirus infections across many large economies.

The resilience of the global manufacturing sector contrasts with weakness in services businesses that rely on close physical proximity and that have suffered as consumers try to lower their risk of infection and governments impose restrictions on their behavior.

Economists expect that divergence to be a feature of the global economy well into 2021, and until vaccines are distributed broadly enough to ensure widespread immunity against Covid-19.

Surveys of purchasing managers at factories across Asia and Europe released Monday recorded strong rises in activity during December, with Taiwan's manufacturing sector recording its strongest month in almost a decade. The results of a similar survey of U.S. manufacturers also pointed to an increase in activity.

Despite increases in infections in both the U.S. and Europe that have prompted governments to impose or extend restrictions, manufacturers continued to report a recovery from the sharp declines in output that accompanied the pandemic's first wave and the lockdowns that accompanied it.

Data firm IHS Markit said its purchasing managers index for the U.S. manufacturing sector rose to 57.1 in December from 56.7 in November. That was the biggest improvement since September 2014, IHS Markit said. A reading above 50 points to an increase in activity from the previous month, while a reading below that level points to a decline.

IHS Markit's purchasing managers index for the eurozone's manufacturing sector also rose, to 55.2 in December from 53.8 in November, reaching its highest level since May 2018.

"The solid performance of manufacturing amid the tightening of Covid-19 restrictions in the closing months of 2020 represents a major contrast to the lockdowns earlier in the year, with factories acting as a crucial support to the economy as the service sector is hit by tough social distancing measures," said Chris Williamson, IHS Markit's chief business economist.

Meanwhile, in the U.S., the resurgence of coronavirus cases and coronavirus-related supply-chain disruptions posed challenges for some manufacturers, Mr. Williamson said. Consumer-goods producers, for example, reported a decrease in orders and production as Americans pulled back on spending, and factories overall said input prices were up sharply.

Europe's factory revival has been led by Germany, which is seeing strong demand for its exports. The country's PMI rose to its highest level in almost three years during December.

Japan, another leading exporter of manufactured goods, saw its PMI rise to its highest level since April 2019, while South Korean factories reported the same strong growth in activity as in November.

By contrast, China's Caixin PMI for the manufacturing sector fell slightly, partly reflecting a cooling of demand for the country's exports. During the pandemic, protective gear and work-from-home tech products have served as pillars for China's overseas trade, helping it gain global market share.

Despite the lengthening recovery, the surveys of purchasing managers indicate that many factories around the world continue to cut payrolls. That suggests that many remain cautious about their prospects in 2021, even as the deployment of vaccines gets under way.

Credit: By Paul Hannon and Amara Omeokwe

## DETAILS

| | |
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| Business indexing term: | Subject: Purchasing managers index International trade Manufacturing Factories Manufacturers; Corporation: IHS Markit |
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## LINKS

# U.S. News: Proud Boys Leader Is Charged After Clashes

Levy, Rachael . Levy, Rachael.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

WASHINGTON -- The leader of the far-right Proud Boys was arrested on Wednesday in Washington, D.C., and charged in connection with unrest that followed pro-Trump protests in the nation's capital last month.

Metropolitan Police arrested Enrique Tarrio, 36 years old, and charged him with destruction of property related to the burning of a Black Lives Matter banner belonging to a historic Black church. Police also charged him with possession of what they said were two "high-capacity firearm magazines."

Mr. Tarrio didn't return a phone call seeking comment. A social-media account for the Proud Boys on Monday night said the group had started a legal-defense fund for him.

Mr. Tarrio told the Washington Post in December he participated in burning a Black Lives Matter banner that had been ripped from the Asbury United Methodist Church during unrest that followed pro-Trump protests in the capital. He told the Post he would plead guilty to destruction of property, pay the church the cost of the banner and accept arrest if authorities filed charges.

The night of the burning, brawls broke out between some demonstrators and counterprotesters. Several people, including eight police officers, were hurt, authorities said at the time.

Mr. Tarrio's arrest came the same day civil-rights groups filed a lawsuit against Mr. Tarrio and Proud Boys International LLC over vandalism they say the group committed at another Black church, the Metropolitan African Methodist Episcopal Church.

"I love a good fight," Mr. Tarrio said in a social-media post about the lawsuit earlier on Monday.

Fresh protests are expected in Washington on Tuesday and Wednesday to support President Trump's claims the election was "stolen" from him. Mr. Tarrio had said he plans to attend.

Credit: By Rachael Levy

## DETAILS

| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Methodist churches; Arrests; Black churches; Black Lives Matter movement |
| Business indexing term: | Industry: 81311 : Religious Organizations |
| Company / organization: | Name: Proud Boys (neo-fascist organization); NAICS: 813940 |
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## LINKS



# U.S. News: U.S. Watch

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

FEDERAL RESERVE

Stimulative Policy to

Remain, Official Says

Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago President Charles Evans said the U.S. economy has a long period of very stimulative monetary policy ahead of it as the central bank works to help the nation emerge from the coronavirus pandemic.

Mr. Evans, who was making a virtual appearance Monday at an economic conference, made limited comments about the outlook for the economy. He noted that in terms of the recovery, "progress on the vaccine front has been very positive, and it looks like the health crisis will be brought under control as we move through the year."

As for central-bank interest-rate policy, Mr. Evans said the Fed's new framework that aims for inflation to overshoot its 2% target to make up for times when it has fallen short argues in favor of a long period of low rates.

"It likely will take years to get average inflation up to 2%, which means monetary policy will be accommodative for a long time," Mr. Evans said in the text of his speech. "This translates into low-for-long policy rates, and indicates that the Fed likely will be continuing our current asset purchase program for a while as well."

Mr. Evans will be a voting member of the rate-setting Federal Open Market Committee this year. When that body met in mid-December, policy makers indicated that an uncertain recovery from the pandemic and no expectation inflation will reach the official goal of 2% points to near zero rates through at least 2023. The Fed also gave no hint it is prepared to cut back on its large-scale purchases of Treasury and mortgage bonds.

-- Michael S. Derby

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WISCONSIN

Governor Activates

National Guard

Wisconsin Gov. Tony Evers authorized deployment of the state National Guard ahead of an expected decision on whether to charge a Kenosha police officer in the shooting of Jacob Blake.

The Democratic governor said that 500 troops were activated at the request of local authorities.

Kenosha faced several weeks of civil disorder and extensive property damage after Mr. Blake was shot multiple times in the back by a police officer as Mr. Blake attempted to get in his car on Aug. 23. Police made several attempts to detain Mr. Blake, a Black man who was wanted under a felony warrant.

A bystander video captured officers yelling for Mr. Blake to drop a knife, which was later found on the floorboards of his car. Mr. Blake was left paralyzed by the shooting.

Amid the unrest, Kyle Rittenhouse was charged with homicide and other offenses after shooting three protesters demonstrating against the treatment of Mr. Blake, leaving two dead. Mr. Rittenhouse faces an arraignment hearing on Tuesday.

-- Joe Barrett

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OHIO

Gun Law Eliminates

Duty to Retreat

An individual's duty to retreat before using force has been eliminated in Ohio under a gun-rights bill signed by Republican Gov. Mike DeWine on Monday despite the governor's vocal concerns that GOP lawmakers were ignoring his own legislation proposed following the 2019 mass shooting in Dayton.

The measure expands the so-called stand-your-ground right from an individual's house and car to any place, "if that person is in a place in which the person lawfully has a right to be."

As recently as last month Gov. DeWine hinted he might veto the bill, saying lawmakers should focus on what he sent them instead. But on Monday, he signed the bill in "the spirit of cooperation" with the General Assembly.

He said he was disappointed lawmakers didn't add the measures he sought for more than a year that would toughen background checks and boost penalties for felons committing new crimes with guns. The governor has pushed these proposals since the Aug. 4, 2019, Dayton massacre that killed nine and wounded more than two dozen.

Nan Whaley, the Democratic mayor of Dayton, accused Mr. DeWine of giving into extremists in his own party.

-- Associated Press

## DETAILS

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## LINKS



# U.S. News: As Virus Hits Jails, Guards Want Inoculation

Maher, Kris . Maher, Kris.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

Prison guards, criminologists and public-health advocates across the U.S. are pushing for prisons to receive Covid-19 vaccines early, arguing that a national surge of the disease among inmates and staff puts them at particularly high risk of infection and death.

Health officials say inoculating guards without giving the shot to prisoners wouldn't help stop the spread, spurring a debate over whether people convicted of crimes should be vaccinated ahead of the general population.

"There's no way it's going to go to prisoners before it goes to people who haven't committed any crime," said Colorado Gov. Jared Polis, a Democrat, after a draft of a state vaccine plan that came out in December put the incarcerated people ahead of those over 65 and other vulnerable populations.

A spokeswoman for the governor said inmates will receive the vaccine based on need, at the same time as members of the general public.

For many states, the relatively small number of initial doses and complicated logistics of delivering the vaccine to competing groups are adding to the pressures of prioritizing its distribution.

Prisons have been among the nation's worst coronavirus hot spots. On average, the rate of Covid-19 cases in state and federal prisons was four times that of the general population and the mortality rate was twice as high, according to a September report by the Council on Criminal Justice.

The nation's aging prison population is more likely to have chronic health conditions than the general population, putting inmates at greater risk of developing a severe case of the disease, and then infecting corrections staff who can carry the virus home, health officials say.

There have been 307,898 cases among inmates, with 1,801 deaths, according to the University of California, Los Angeles Law Covid-19 Behind Bars Data Project. About 67,000 cases of Covid-19 have been reported among prison staff with over 100 deaths, according to the project.

"It doesn't make sense to vaccinate workers but not vaccinate the people they are charged with protecting," said Wanda Bertram, a spokeswoman for the Prison Policy Initiative, which is advocating that staff and inmates receive the vaccine.

At the Monroe County Correctional Facility in Stroudsburg, Pa., roughly three dozen corrections officers out of about 130 at the facility have tested positive since late November. Some 20 officers said they inadvertently brought the virus home and infected family members and friends, according to Teamsters Local 773.

"We are advocating across the country for corrections officers to be among the first to receive the vaccine," said Matt

Weidman, business agent for Teamsters Local 773. "They're doing front-line work. It's just behind a prison wall."
Several officers at the Monroe County facility said they were required to stand close together in a briefing room, weren't informed when inmates tested positive and that N95 masks weren't readily given to guards working in units with Covid-19-positive inmates. The union also alleged that a vehicle used to transport prisoners wasn't cleaned regularly.

"You're putting your life on the line for this facility, and they're not doing anything for you," said Alizabeth Plows, a corrections officer there.

Warden Garry Haidle said the facility is following federal and state safety protocols and that except for a temporary shortage of sanitizing wipes, it has had enough personal protective equipment for officers.

Pennsylvania has included correctional employees in Phase 1 of its vaccine-distribution plan. But medical staff will receive the vaccine first, a spokeswoman for the state department of corrections said. Nonmedical staff and inmates will likely be inoculated at the same time, she added. It is unclear whether county corrections officers will be part of the first phase, according to the warden and the union.

About 14 states currently list corrections staff in the first phase of their vaccine rollout, according to an analysis of 49 state distribution proposals by the Prison Policy Initiative. Seven states include prison inmates in the first phase. Some states put corrections staff and inmates in a second phase, while others haven't accounted for either group in existing distribution plans.

UCLA law professor Sharon Dolovich said inmates should be given priority when it comes to Covid-19 inoculation for public-health reasons -- and because there is a moral imperative to do so.

"These are people in close quarters where conditions are perfect for the spread of Covid," said Ms. Dolovich.

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Zusha Elinson contributed to this article.

Credit: By Kris Maher

## DETAILS


| | |
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## LINKS



# Saudis, Qatar to Settle Feud, Aiding U.S. Efforts on Iran

Nissenbaum, Dion . Nissenbaum, Dion.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

Saudi Arabia moved to end a yearslong regional dispute with Qatar, taking a first step toward resolving a bitter feud that has fractured the Middle East and hampered U.S. efforts to isolate Iran, Saudi, Kuwaiti and U.S. officials said.

Riyadh on Monday reopened its airspace and land and sea borders to its tiny neighbor, and leaders of the rival nations will gather on Tuesday to sign an agreement meant to end a three-year-old regional blockade of Qatar, which Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, Bahrain and Egypt accused in 2017 of supporting terrorism and aligning with Iran.

White House senior adviser Jared Kushner, who helped broker an end to the standoff over the past few weeks, flew to Saudi Arabia on Monday to attend the signing after receiving a rare invitation to the Gulf Cooperation Council meeting where leaders are expected to take the first major steps in ending the dispute.

U.S. and Saudi officials said Saudi Arabia had a new incentive to end the dispute: The imminent start of the administration of President-elect Joe Biden. Mr. Biden, a Democrat, has vowed to take a tougher approach toward Saudi Arabia than President Trump, a Republican who stood by Riyadh's leaders when they were accused of jailing human-rights activists and killing Saudi journalist Jamal Khashoggi.

If it holds, an end to the blockade takes a diplomatic problem off the table for the incoming Biden team, which wants to turn its focus toward consolidating support for efforts to draw Iran back into the 2015 nuclear agreement and negotiate a follow-on agreement addressing Tehran's ballistic-missile program and regional ambitions.

U.S. and Saudi officials said they had secured a compromise that will allow Qatar again to fly planes over the Gulf nation in exchange for Qatar Airways dropping a series of legal challenges against the four nations that sought $5 billion in compensation for the airspace bans.

While the detente won't address the underlying issues that led to the dispute, it will resolve the most problematic short-term challenges for Qatar and its rival Gulf neighbors.

"This is the biggest breakthrough we've had to date," one senior Trump administration official said. "It doesn't mean they will love each other and be best friends, but it does mean they will be able to work together."

Qatar's regional rivals remain wary. Officials from several Gulf nations warned that the Saudi-led deal would only paper over the problems and predicted that the divisions will quickly re-emerge unless Qatar takes major steps to reorient relations with its Gulf neighbors.

"Everyone is now waiting to see if Qatar does what it says it will do, now that we have a framework agreed upon," a senior Bahraini official said.

Qatari Emir Sheikh Tamim bin Hamad Al Thani is expected to attend Tuesday's meeting as a sign of the nation's commitment to resolving the dispute, according to an official government statement.

U.S. and Middle East officials said they hope Tuesday's meeting will set the stage for new talks meant to consolidate regional opposition to Iran and curb the animosity among the Gulf neighbors.

One major sticking point is the media war among the nations, where state-backed news outlets routinely target their rivals with negative coverage.

"Is it perfect? No," a second senior Trump administration official said. "Ultimately, I think what this shows is that the parties have more to gain from ending this now than from letting it go on beyond the Trump administration."

The Middle East nations' severing of ties with Qatar in 2017 had Mr. Trump's enthusiastic backing, even though Qatar is home to the largest U.S. military base in the region, which has long been used to carry out airstrikes against Islamic State forces in the Middle East and Taliban insurgents in Afghanistan.

Saudi Arabia and its allies issued a list of 13 demands for Qatar, including shutting the state-backed Al Jazeera satellite news network, severing ties with the Muslim Brotherhood, and cutting off its military cooperation with Iran. Doha rejected the accusations that it was aligned with Iran and supported terrorism, and managed to mitigate the damage caused by the dispute.

The Trump administration quickly reversed course and sought unsuccessfully for years to broker an end to the dispute. Over the past year, negotiations focused mainly on resolving the fight over airspace.

To evade the ban on flying over Saudi Arabia, Qatar rerouted some planes over Iran, providing Tehran with a new source of funds for use of its airspace while the U.S. was working to choke off money flowing to the government. Mr. Trump pressed Saudi Arabia to cede ground on the issue, but Riyadh was reluctant to give up its main pressure point with Qatar.

The feud was stoked by critical media coverage that incensed leaders in the rival capitals. In the fall of 2019, Qatar's foreign minister secretly flew to Riyadh to offer a new deal to end the dispute. Qatar agreed to constrain coverage by Al Jazeera, Gulf officials said, but the network continued to run programming that infuriated leaders in Saudi Arabia, the U.A.E. and Egypt.

Late last year, Gulf leaders reached out to Mr. Kushner and asked him to help, U.S. officials said. Mr. Kushner had developed close ties with Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman. And he had business ties in Qatar, where the Kushner family unsuccessfully tried to secure critical funding to bail out a financially troubled Manhattan real-estate

project.
While Mr. Kushner was working to end the dispute in December, the Trump administration approved the sale of more than $760 million in arms to Saudi Arabia and more than $100 million to Egypt, which had pushed back on the U.S.-brokered deal.
U.S. officials said the arms sales weren't related to the deal to be signed on Tuesday.
Qatar has its own incentives to strike a deal to end the airspace restrictions: The tiny Gulf nation is preparing to host the 2022 soccer World Cup.
---
Summer Said in Dubai contributed to this article.
Credit: By Dion Nissenbaum

## DETAILS

| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Professional soccer; Cooperation; Territorial issues |
| Business indexing term: | Corporation: Al Jazeera; Industry: 71121 : Spectator Sports |
| Location: | Iran; Riyadh Saudi Arabia; Middle East; United States--US; Saudi Arabia; Qatar; Egypt |
| Company / organization: | Name: Al Jazeera; NAICS: 516120 |
| Classification: | 71121: Spectator Sports |
| Publication title: | Wall Street Journal, Eastern edition; New York, N.Y. |
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## LINKS

Document 26 of 75

# Business News: U.S. Insurer's Chinese Merger Stalls

Scism, Leslie; Ng, Serena . Scism, Leslie; Ng, Serena.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

China Oceanwide Holdings Group Co.'s four-year-old agreement to buy Genworth Financial Inc., one of the world's longest deal engagements, is petering out.

In October 2016, Genworth agreed to sell itself to the Chinese conglomerate for $2.7 billion in cash. But on Monday, Richmond, Va.-based insurer Genworth said a year-end 2020 deadline to complete the transaction with Beijing-based China Oceanwide wasn't extended -- after 16 extensions.

While the companies didn't cancel the merger agreement, the move indicates the long-running affair could end without a marriage.

Genworth said a stumbling block was the deal's financing, which was to be partially supplied by Hony Capital, a Chinese private-equity firm. A Hony Capital representative declined to comment.

Genworth said the Covid-19 pandemic "and associated restrictions" also delayed the deal's closing.

Shares of the insurer tumbled $1.09, or 29%, Monday to $2.69, taking the New York-listed company's market capitalization down to about $1.4 billion.

The deal was supposed to give Genworth a much-needed $1.5 billion capital infusion, and was agreed to at a time when Chinese conglomerates were flush with cash and paying top dollar for assets all over the world. It passed many regulatory hurdles, getting approval from Chinese authorities, insurance regulators and the Committee on Foreign Investment in the U.S., which reviews cross-border deals for national-security concerns.

Given the many closing extensions, some regulators had to approve the deal a second time after their earlier approvals expired.

At Genworth's annual shareholders meeting last month, Chief Executive Thomas McInerney said quarantine requirements for travelers to Hong Kong -- along with pandemic prohibitions in the Asian financial center on gatherings of more than two people -- complicated efforts by China Oceanwide to finalize and execute its financing

plan with Hony.
Earlier, the company had said Oceanwide and Hony needed to hold in-person discussions to finalize the terms for up to $1.8 billion in debt financing for the deal.
Mr. McInerney wasn't available for comment on Monday. The company plans to host an investor call Tuesday.
Hong Kong, a major hub for Chinese companies' fundraising, in December tightened travel restrictions following a rise in coronavirus cases. Since late last month, it imposed 21-day mandatory quarantines on arrivals from most countries, deterring many international travelers.
Both companies said in Genworth's release Monday that they remain open to completing the transaction, but either side can terminate the merger agreement at any time.
As Oceanwide and the U.S. insurer struggled to close the deal over the past year, Wall Street analysts said they believed Genworth has financial resources to run its operations without a buyer. The company has a robust mortgage-insurance business to generate revenue and profits, and it has enough money on hand to cover its 2021 debt obligations, analysts said in recent months.
But the collapse of the deal would mean that Genworth's days as a pioneer in long-time-care insurance are over. Genworth helped popularize the product line in the 1990s and 2000s, and it led the sales charts in many years.
The policies typically pay for in-home aides, nursing homes and other costs of people who no longer can care for themselves. Millions of Americans own policies, which were once sold by an array of prominent insurers.
But insurers miscalculated the costs they would incur, including such factors as the length of time people would be on claims and how many policyholders would file claims. Ultralow U.S. interest rates since 2008 also badly hurt the product line, as insurers invest the policies' annual premiums until needed for payouts.Since 2007, insurers have bulked up their reserves with more than $10 billion in charges against their earnings to reflect the higher anticipated payouts.
Many received regulatory approval to pass on double-digit and even triple-digit rate increases to consumers, angering their customer base. Most quit selling new policies.
Few companies were hit as hard as Genworth.
The absence of a deal will shine a spotlight on longstanding concerns about the adequacy of many insurers' reserves for paying long-term-care claims potentially over decades. According to a December report by Moody's Investors Service, Genworth has about $30 billion in such reserves, making it home to the biggest single block of long-term-care policies in the U.S. life-insurance industry.
Genworth said Monday it intends to manage its U.S. life insurance companies "on a stand-alone basis with no plans to infuse capital into those companies in the future, absent an Oceanwide transaction."
The company also said it is focusing on executing a contingency plan that could include an initial public offering of stock of its U.S. mortgage-insurance business. Genworth said this and other steps would help improve its financial position, adding that it has enough cash and assets to pay off debt coming due next month.
---
Jing Yang contributed to this article.
Credit: By Leslie Scism and Serena Ng

## DETAILS

| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Coronaviruses; Regulatory approval; Shareholder meetings; Pandemics; Debt financing; COVID-19; Insurance industry |
| Business indexing term: | Subject: Regulatory approval Shareholder meetings Debt financing Insurance industry |
| Location: | China; Hong Kong; United States--US |

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| Company / organization: | Name: Hony Capital; NAICS: 523910 |
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## LINKS

Document 27 of 75

# U.S. News: Nunes, a Trump Ally, Awarded Presidential Medal of Freedom

Lucey, Catherine . Lucey, Catherine.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

President Trump awarded the Presidential Medal of Freedom to Rep. Devin Nunes on Monday, bestowing the nation's top civilian honor on a close Republican ally during the closing days of his presidency, the White House said.
Mr. Nunes, of California, was the top Republican on the House Intelligence Committee when it conducted the Russia probe. He aggressively defended Mr. Trump during investigations into Russian interference in the 2016 election and throughout the president's impeachment trial in the House of Representatives.
The Democratic-majority House voted to impeach Mr. Trump on charges stemming from his efforts to press Ukraine to announce investigations that could benefit him politically. The Republican-led Senate acquitted the president.
In a news release, the White House praised Mr. Nunes for his role in attempting to discredit investigations of the Trump campaign's contacts with Russia, calling him "a public servant of unmatched talent, unassailable integrity, and unwavering resolve."
In a 2019 report, special counsel Robert Mueller confirmed that Moscow interfered in the 2016 election and detailed contacts between the Russian operatives and members of the Trump campaign, but said the evidence didn't establish a conspiracy or coordination between the two.
As chairman of the House Intelligence Committee in 2017, Mr. Nunes oversaw the House panel's Russia probe, but drew criticism from Democrats, who accused him of providing political cover to the Trump administration rather than leading a serious, independent inquiry.
Mr. Trump also plans to award the Presidential Medal of Freedom to Rep. Jim Jordan (R., Ohio), according to people familiar with his plans.
During a 2018 interview with "Fox & Friends," Mr. Trump said Mr. Nunes should get the medal, calling them "high awards for civilians, and he's done amazing."
Considered one of the nation's highest civilian honors, the medal is awarded to people "who have made especially meritorious contributions to the security or national interests of the United States, to world peace, or to cultural or other significant public or private endeavors." It was established in 1963 by President John F. Kennedy.
In December, Mr. Trump awarded the medal to retired Notre Dame football coach Lou Holtz and Iowa wrestling icon Dan Gable.
Mr. Trump's plans were earlier reported by the Washington Post.
Credit: By Catherine Lucey

## DETAILS

| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Presidents; Candidates; Awards & honors |
| Business indexing term: | Industry: 92111 : Executive Offices |
| Location: | Russia; United States--US |
| People: | Nunes, Devin |
| Classification: | 92111: Executive Offices |

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## LINKS



# World News: U.K. Spurns U.S. Bid for Assange --- Judge rejects request to extradite founder of WikiLeaks, citing risk of suicide in prison

Douglas, Jason . Douglas, Jason.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

LONDON -- A British judge rejected a U.S. request to extradite Julian Assange on spying charges, saying the WikiLeaks founder would be at severe risk of suicide if sent to the U.S. to await trial in a high-security prison.

The decision marks a major setback in Washington's pursuit of Mr. Assange for publishing secret documents relating to the Iraq and Afghanistan wars. A lawyer for the U.S. government said it would appeal, setting the stage for another hearing in the coming months at the High Court in London. A bail application is scheduled to be heard on Wednesday.

Delivering her ruling on Monday, District Judge Vanessa Baraitser said Mr. Assange has already toyed with suicide and the prospect of detention in isolation in the U.S. would likely result in a suicide attempt.

The judge said the harsh conditions under which he would likely be held in the U.S. prison system would exacerbate that risk. The court heard evidence from doctors who diagnosed Mr. Assange with depression and autism.

Under British extradition law, as well as European human-rights law to which the U.K. is a party, a judge can block extradition on health grounds if it would result in unjust or oppressive treatment.

"I find that the mental condition of Mr. Assange is such that it would be oppressive to extradite him" to the U.S., Judge Baraitser said in a 132-page ruling. "The overall impression is of a depressed and sometimes despairing man who is genuinely fearful about his future," she said.

The judge did, however, dismiss multiple other arguments against extradition, including the defense's assertion that Mr. Assange's prosecution was politically motivated and violated his rights to free expression.

A spokesman for the U.S. Department of Justice said that while it was disappointed in the court's decision, the U.S. had prevailed on every point of law raised. "We will continue to seek Mr. Assange's extradition to the United States," he said.

Mr. Assange, a 49-year-old Australian who appeared in court in person Monday, is wanted in the U.S. on 18 charges of breaking espionage laws and conspiring to hack a military computer. The alleged offenses relate to the publication in 2010 and 2011 by WikiLeaks of a huge trove of classified material that painted a bleak picture of the American campaigns in Iraq and Afghanistan and their aftermath.

Mr. Assange has repeatedly defended his work and the wider WikiLeaks project as public-interest journalism that exposed wrongdoing by the U.S. and other governments.

His case isn't the first occasion where a British judge has blocked extradition on the grounds that aspects of the U.S. prison system would qualify as unjust or oppressive treatment for someone who is ill. London's High Court rejected the extradition to the U.S. of Lauri Love, an alleged computer hacker, on similar grounds in 2018.

Nick Vamos, a partner at London law firm Peters & Peters and a former head of extradition for England and Wales's Crown Prosecution Service, said it was an argument defense teams frequently deploy when resisting extradition to the U.S.

"If you are in perfect health you are never going to win that argument. But if you have, as Assange does, these underlying, serious mental-health problems, then it's going to be a problem always with the Americans," he said.

The U.S. alleges that Mr. Assange broke the law by soliciting classified material from former U.S. Army intelligence analyst Chelsea Manning and by helping her crack a password to obtain that material. Publication of the diplomatic cables and military logs she provided endangered the lives of U.S. intelligence sources, the U.S. government alleges.

In June, the Justice Department issued a fresh indictment that included new allegations that broadened the scope, the department said, of the conspiracy surrounding alleged computer intrusions with which Mr. Assange has been charged. He is alleged between 2007 and 2015 to have encouraged and assisted hackers affiliated with the groups

Anonymous and LulzSec obtain classified information published by WikiLeaks, and to have played a role in helping Edward Snowden, a National Security Agency contractor who in 2013 leaked details of clandestine surveillance programs to the media, to evade arrest.

In hearings at a London court spread over almost a year, Mr. Assange denied he solicited anything from Ms. Manning or helped her steal classified files. His defense argues that his prosecution is politically motivated, a potential bar to extradition under a bilateral treaty between the U.S. and U.K. that governs extradition requests.

Credit: By Jason Douglas

## DETAILS


| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Indictments; Court hearings & proceedings; Extradition; Suicides & suicide attempts; Classified information |
| Location: | United States--US; United Kingdom--UK; Iraq; Afghanistan |
| People: | Assange, Julian Paul |
| Company / organization: | Name: Wikileaks.org; NAICS: 516210 |
| Publication title: | Wall Street Journal, Eastern edition; New York, N.Y. |
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## LINKS

Document 29 of 75

# U.S. News: FDA Dismisses Talk Of Cutting Doses

Burton, Thomas M; Hopkins, Jared S . Burton, Thomas M; Hopkins, Jared S.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

The U.S. Food and Drug Administration rejected suggestions to cut the recommended dosages of Covid-19 vaccines so more people could be inoculated.

The federal health agency said Monday that suggestions to lower the dosages weren't supported by evidence and could put public health at risk. The two vaccines authorized for use in the U.S. -- from Pfizer Inc. and Moderna Inc. -- require two doses, given three or four weeks apart.

Moncef Slaoui, chief adviser to the federal government's Operation Warp Speed coronavirus response program, said Sunday that federal officials were considering giving some individuals two half-doses of Moderna's vaccine to speed up the overall pace of vaccination to the public.

Clinical trials for both vaccines showed they were highly effective at protecting against symptomatic Covid-19 when given in two doses. The FDA authorized giving the two doses of the vaccines on the timetables used in late-stage testing.

Dr. Slaoui suggested reducing dosages as the number of people vaccinated so far in the U.S. has fallen short of projections.

In a statement, FDA Commissioner Stephen M. Hahn and FDA vaccine chief Peter Marks said that "changes that are not supported by adequate scientific evidence may ultimately be counterproductive to public health." They said doctors and nurses administering the Covid-19 vaccines should follow their FDA-authorized dosing schedules.

Credit: By Thomas M. Burton and Jared S. Hopkins

## DETAILS

| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Public health; Vaccines; Coronaviruses; COVID-19; COVID-19 vaccines |
| Location: | United States--US |
| Company / organization: | Name: Food & Drug Administration--FDA; NAICS: 926150 |

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## LINKS



# Stocks Start Year With a Selloff --- S&P, Dow fall after both benchmarks closed at records on last day of 2020

Otani, Akane; Hirtenstein, Anna . Otani, Akane; Hirtenstein, Anna.



## FULL TEXT

Stocks tumbled on the first trading day of the year, retreating sharply from records set just days ago.
Investors are starting off the new year fixated on the same issue that dominated markets for much of 2020: the coronavirus pandemic. Many believe economic activity will pick up later this year as more of the population is vaccinated and businesses reopen. But they acknowledge the path to recovery will likely be long and uneven.
News on the pandemic has painted a grim picture in recent days. Hospitalizations in the U.S. jumped to a record Sunday. Meanwhile, governments across Europe are extending lockdowns to try to slow the spread of the virus.
The difficulties countries face in containing the pandemic mean many companies will remain vulnerable to financial pressures in the near term.
The Dow Jones Industrial Average fell 382.59 points, or 1.3%, to 30223.89. The S&P 500 shed 55.42 points, or 1.5%, to 3700.65, and the Nasdaq Composite declined 189.83 points, or 1.5%, to 12698.45.
"We have continued concerns over Covid-19 and the ability to staunch this wave, not just in the U.S. but globally," said Quincy Krosby, chief market strategist at Prudential Financial.
Ms. Krosby added that there appeared to be growing nervousness over Tuesday's Georgia runoff races, which will determine whether Republicans can hold on to control in the Senate. In recent days, betting markets have shown the Republican lead shrinking, pointing to what will likely be a tight race.
"These are all of these concerns, and then we have a market that is priced to perfection, which is denting returns right now," Ms. Krosby said.
Among individual stocks, Coca-Cola shares fell $2.08, or 3.8%, to $52.76. RBC Capital Markets analysts downgraded the stock to sector perform from outperform, saying they believe the pandemic will continue to limit major public events and dining at restaurants, potentially hurting demand for Coca-Cola products.
Airline stocks, another group that has been hard hit by the pandemic, fell as well, with American Airlines falling 64 cents, or 4.1%, to $15.13, and Delta Air Lines losing $1.48, or 3.7%, to $38.73.
Hotel operators also retreated, with Hilton Worldwide Holdings shedding $3.80, or 3.4%, to $107.46 and Marriott International losing $7.09, or 5.4%, to $124.83.
One stock that bucked the trend: Tesla. The electric-car maker rose $24.10, or 3.4%, to $729.77 after saying it delivered a record 499,550 cars last year, just shy of its half a million target.
As investors broadly withdrew from stocks, gold prices jumped 2.7% to $1,944.70 a troy ounce, posting their biggest one-day percentage gain since April. The precious metal tends to gain favor with investors when market volatility increases.
Overseas, the pan-continental Stoxx Europe 600 rose 0.7%, paring earlier gains.
The U.K.'s FTSE 100 added 1.7%. The trade deal struck on Christmas Eve between the U.K. and European Union is likely delivering a boost to British stocks, said Sebastian Mackay, a multiasset fund manager at Invesco.
"A lot of the tail risks of a no deal [Brexit] have been removed now. This will lead people to start dipping their toes again in the U.K. market," he said.
Investors also said they were reassured by newly released data on the health of the manufacturing sector. Factories in Asia and Europe increased their output as 2020 drew to a close, according to surveys of purchasing managers that showed strong rises in activity during December.
"We're going through renewed lockdowns, which is curtailing activity to some extent, but what we've seen through the pandemic is that manufacturing activity tends to hold up quite well," Mr. Mackay said.
Most major stock benchmarks in the Asia-Pacific region advanced. South Korea's Kospi led gains, rising 2.5%. Early

Tuesday, the Kospi was up 0.1%.
On Monday, the Shanghai Composite rose 0.9%, even after a private survey showed China's manufacturing activity moderated in December due to weak demand for the country's exports.
Ben Luk, senior multiasset strategist at State Street Global Markets, said the data pointed to continued fragility in the Chinese economy. But he said that helped ease concerns that China's central bank would act prematurely to tighten monetary policy.
Early Tuesday, the Chinese benchmark was down 0.3%.
Japan's Nikkei 225 dropped 0.7% Monday after Prime Minister Yoshihide Suga said he might declare a state of emergency in Tokyo and surrounding areas as new coronavirus infections continue to rise. The Nikkei was down 0.1% at midday Tuesday.
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Joanne Chiu contributed to this article
Credit: By Akane Otani and Anna Hirtenstein

## DETAILS


| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Dow Jones averages; Stock exchanges; Investments; Coronaviruses; Pandemics; COVID-19; Manufacturing; Benchmarks |
| Business indexing term: | Subject: Stock exchanges Manufacturing; Industry: 52321 : Securities and Commodity Exchanges |
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## LINKS

Document 31 of 75

# World News: Tehran Accelerates Uranium Enrichment --- New nuclear activity exceeds deal's limits, speeds up timetable to produce a weapon

Aresu Eqbali; Malsin, Jared . Aresu Eqbali; Malsin, Jared.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

TEHRAN -- Iran said it has resumed enriching uranium to 20% purity, exceeding limits set in a 2015 nuclear deal and slashing the time it would take for Tehran to produce the grade of fuel needed for a nuclear weapon.

The nuclear activity, which returns Iran to an enrichment level it last reached before entering the international accord, dials up pressure on Washington and crosses a red line set by European countries that remained committed to the agreement after the Trump administration withdrew from it in 2018.

The move threatens to complicate President-elect Joe Biden's plan to rejoin the deal that placed limits on Tehran's nuclear program, but which floundered after the U.S. left it and reimposed crippling economic sanctions on Tehran. Mr. Biden has said the U.S. would rejoin the deal as long as Iran complies with its terms.

The enrichment activity also raises tensions in the Middle East when the region is on edge during the waning days of the Trump administration.

Tehran has vowed to avenge the killings of a top Iranian nuclear scientist in November and a senior Iranian general, who died in a U.S. drone strike last January. The strike followed a year of spiraling hostilities in the region that included explosions on oil tankers and an attack on Saudi oil facilities that the U.S. blamed on Iran. Tehran has denied involvement in the explosions and the Saudi attack.

An Iranian government spokesman on Monday defended the decision to lift the enrichment levels, saying it complied with a law passed by Parliament in December. President Hassan Rouhani had said he opposed the move, urging caution with respect to actions that could provoke hostilities with the West.
"The government finds itself obliged to carry out this law," said the spokesman, Ali Rabie. The enrichment is taking place at the Fordow nuclear facility beneath a mountain south of Tehran, he said.
The heightened level of enrichment cuts the time it would take for Iran to create weapons-grade uranium, which is 90% enriched. David Albright, a former weapons inspector and president of the Institute for Science and International Security, a security think tank in Washington, estimated that it would take six to nine months to build a nuclear explosive, prepare a test site and carry out a nuclear test.
President Trump's withdrawal from the nuclear agreement reimposed economic sanctions on Tehran and launched an era of renewed hostilities with Iran and its allies in the Middle East.
Iran told the International Atomic Energy Agency on Dec. 31 that it planned to proceed with 20% enrichment, the agency has said. IAEA Director-General Rafael Grossi confirmed to member states on Monday that Iran began feeding uranium that was already enriched up to 4.1% into six centrifuge cascades at the Fordow facility for enrichment up to 20%. The agency said its inspectors were present at the nuclear site to detach the agency's seal from a cylinder containing the uranium supply.
A U.S. State Department spokeswoman called Tehran's move "a clear attempt to increase its campaign of nuclear extortion, an attempt that will continue to fail."
The increase in uranium-enrichment levels accelerates Iran's approach, in which it had been gradually increasing uranium enrichment as it ramps up pressure on Western countries, reaching 4.5% purity last year. The 2015 deal limits Iran to 3.67% purity.
The increased nuclear activity and the Dec. 1 law that set it in motion could be designed to improve Iran's position in negotiations toward a revival of the 2015 nuclear deal under Mr. Biden, who will be inaugurated as president on Jan. 20.
Iran's Foreign Minister Javad Zarif said the nuclear activity was in response to noncompliance by other members of the agreement. "Our measures are fully reversible upon FULL compliance by ALL," he said on Twitter on Monday.
Tensions between Iran and its opponents have soared since the killing of Iran's top nuclear scientist, Mohsen Fakhrizadeh, who died in an attack on his car outside Tehran in late November. Iranian leaders accused Israel of carrying out the attack. Israel has neither confirmed nor denied involvement.
The killing further unsettled the Middle East in a tense period as the region awaits the inauguration of Mr. Biden, who has vowed to change course on U.S. policy toward the region following years of a pressure campaign on Iran carried out by the Trump administration.
The campaign included crippling economic sanctions and the January 2020 killing of Maj. Gen. Qassem Soleimani, a senior leader in Iran's Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps and the architect of Iran's alliances with powerful militia groups that enhanced Tehran's influence across the Middle East.
Iranian proxy groups in the region called for revenge attacks on the anniversary of Gen. Soleimani's death on Jan. 3, which came and went without spectacular violence.
"These anniversaries are big. This is a way for Iran to mark them, to say we didn't engage in revenge that we would be taking, but we are doing things," said Ariane Tabatabai, an Iran expert at the Alliance for Securing Democracy at the German Marshall Fund.
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South Korean Ship
Is Seized in Gulf
Iranian forces seized a South Korea-flagged ship on Monday, a semiofficial Iranian news agency reported, heightening tensions with a U.S. ally.
Forces boarded the vessel because it was creating unspecified pollution in the Persian Gulf, the agency reported.
The vessel's owner, DM Shipping of Busan, South Korea, didn't respond to calls.

Tehran is in a dispute with South Korea over Seoul's refusal to unlock frozen oil-revenue accounts to pay for Covid-19 vaccines and other humanitarian goods.

Iran has previously seized vessels from countries with which it has had disputes.

In 2019, Tehran detained a British-owned tanker for months after the U.K. seized an Iranian vessel that was on its way to Syria.

Credit: By Aresu Eqbali and Jared Malsin

## DETAILS

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|---|---|
| Subject: | Presidents; Uranium; Sanctions |
| Business indexing term: | Subject: Sanctions; Industry: 92111 : Executive Offices |
| Location: | Iran; Middle East; United States--US; Israel; South Korea |
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## LINKS

Document 32 of 75

# Business & Finance

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

Haven, a health-care, venture launched with great fanfare by Amazon, Berkshire Hathaway, JPMorgan and their chief executives, is folding after about three years.

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Fiat Chrysler and Peugeot maker PSA are accelerating plans to complete their merger, saying the combination should be accomplished in mid-January.

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Factories in the U.S., Asia and Europe boosted their output as 2020 drew to a close, aided by a rise in new orders and a revival in trade.

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U.S. stocks tumbled on the first trading day of 2021, retreating from records set just days ago. The Dow fell 1.3% and the S&P 500 and Nasdaq both gave up 1.5%.

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The NYSE reversed a decision to delist China's three largest telecom carriers after consulting with authorities about a U.S. investment ban.

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A group of Google employees has formed a union to organize workers across the company's global operations, a rare move in Silicon Valley.

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Mondelez is nearing a deal to buy paleo chocolate-bar maker Hu, the latest move by an established food firm to tap into growing demand for healthier snacks.

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ViacomCBS said it had reached a distribution deal with Disney's Hulu that puts many of its most popular cable channels on the live-TV video-streaming service.

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Workplace messaging platform Slack suffered a widespread service disruption for several hours Monday.

## DETAILS

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## LINKS

# U.S. News: Congress Should Certify Biden Win, CEO Group Says

Glazer, Emily . Glazer, Emily.



## FULL TEXT

Nearly 200 top U.S. business leaders pressed Congress to certify President-elect Joe Biden's electoral victory in a letter Monday, the latest attempt by corporate executives to publicly urge a smooth transition of power as President Trump and many Republicans continue to dispute the election results.

The letter, sent by the Partnership for New York City, which represents the city's business leaders and largest employers, called on Congress to certify the electoral vote on Wednesday as the nation continues to reel from the coronavirus pandemic.

"Attempts to thwart or delay this process run counter to the essential tenets of our democracy," the letter said. "Our duly elected leaders deserve the respect and bipartisan support of all Americans at a moment when we are dealing with the worst health and economic crises in modern history."

Among the nearly 200 business leaders who signed the letter are the heads of financial firm BlackRock Inc., consultancy Deloitte, airline JetBlue Airways Corp. and pharmaceutical company Pfizer Inc., according to a release sent by the partnership. The group includes a number of Fortune 500 companies across industries as well as New York-based financial-services firms and law firms.

Eleven current and incoming Republican senators said this past weekend that they would vote to reject the Electoral College votes of some states on Wednesday as not "lawfully certified" unless Congress appoints a commission to conduct an emergency, 10-day audit of the election results. Although none of the challenges are expected to succeed, they could slow the process.

By law, Congress must hold a joint session on Jan. 6 to ratify Mr. Biden's 306-232 Electoral College win. Objections from some Republican senators and House members are expected to force debate and votes in Congress. Majorities in the House and Senate would have to agree for the challenge to succeed, an extremely unlikely prospect given that Democrats control the House.

In a Saturday telephone call, Mr. Trump urged Georgia's Republican secretary of state, Brad Raffensperger, to overturn the November election results that led Mr. Biden, a Democrat, to win the state.

The U.S. Chamber of Commerce, which represents more than three million businesses, also urged Congress on Monday to certify Mr. Biden's win.

"Efforts by some members of Congress to disregard certified election results in an effort to change the election outcome or to try to make a long-term political point undermines our democracy and the rule of law and will only result in further division across our nation," said Chamber CEO Thomas J. Donohue in a statement.

Credit: By Emily Glazer

## DETAILS

| | |
|---|---|
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| | |
|---|---|
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LINKS

Document 34 of 75

# Year-End Review & Outlook: Markets & Finance (A Special Report) --- Lessons From a Crazy Year In

# Financial Markets --- A historic downturn and dizzying comeback show markets still have the capacity to surprise us all

Otani, Akane . Otani, Akane.



## FULL TEXT

Here is something many investors would have found difficult to believe during March's stomach-churning selloff: 2020 would turn out to be a stellar year for the stock market.

The Dow Jones Industrial Average closed the year at a record, rising about 0.7% on Thursday alongside the S&P 500, which finished the year up 16% at its own new high.

The market for initial public offerings is flourishing. Just weeks ago, home-rental startup Airbnb Inc. made a stock-market debut so stunning that its chief executive was briefly left speechless on live television.

These are things that would be easy to imagine in boom times. But 2020 has been anything but that for the world outside Wall Street. The cold reality is that the market's rally has occurred in the midst of a catastrophic pandemic that has killed more than a million people, halted business and travel and wreaked havoc on the economy. Although there are plenty of reasons for the market's comeback, not the least of which is the Federal Reserve's massive intervention, the staggering rally is still difficult to comprehend for many investors.

"The path we took to get here is something we never, ever, ever would have foreseen," said Ralph Bassett, head of equities for North America at Aberdeen Standard Investments.

Here are the lessons investors say they have learned from an unforgettable year.

Markets don't perfectly reflect the economy

When stocks bottomed March 23 and began to race higher, many observers were perplexed. Coronavirus cases were surging. Restaurants, stores and theaters went dark and millions of Americans queued up outside of career centers to apply for unemployment benefits. How could the market be doing so well when the world seemed to be doing so badly?

The answer: The stock market often begins to recover far sooner than the economy. In the case of the financial crisis, U.S. stocks hit their nadir March 9, 2009. But it took seven years from that point for the unemployment rate to fall below precrisis levels.

Similarly, while stocks managed to charge higher in 2020, many economists don't expect the U.S. to recover all the jobs lost during the pandemic until 2023 or later.

"A lot of people said the market is disconnected to reality, but stocks are pricing in what's going to happen in six months to a year," not what the economy looks like today, said Andrew Slimmon, managing director and portfolio manager at Morgan Stanley Investment Management. In the pandemic, investors who began betting on a stock recovery in the spring weren't assuming the economy was about to come roaring back -- they were assuming things would be better some months down the line than they were at the time. And they were right.

"It's not until you have this huge rally that suddenly people realize, 'Oh, the stock market isn't wrong, I've been wrong,' " Mr. Slimmon said.

It pays not to try to time the markets

With both the pandemic and the financial crisis, those who sold on bad news and waited for the economy to recover to get back into the market would have missed out on the bulk of stocks' upside. As emotionally harrowing as sizable selloffs may be, history shows that the vast majority of investors are better off not trying to hop in and out of the

market.
The returns of a hypothetical investor who put $10,000 into an S&P 500 index fund at the start of 1980 and missed the market's five best days through the end of August 2020 would be 38 percentage points lower than those of someone who stayed invested the whole period, according to a Fidelity Investments Inc. analysis.
"What the long-term investor needs to think about is over the next year or next two years, is the economy going to grow? Are corporate earnings going to grow? We think the answer to those points is yes, and because of that, we think the market has a pretty good foundation," said Kelly Bogdanova, vice president for RBC Wealth Management's portfolio advisory group.
Forecasts are just forecasts
This time last year, Wall Street's top strategists identified the biggest risk to the markets as deteriorating trade relations between the U.S. and China. Trade all but fell off the radar for many money managers in 2020, quickly replaced by concerns about the coronavirus pandemic and the ensuing economic shutdown.
They also widely predicted modest gains for the S&P 500. But by March, analysts at BMO Capital Markets and Oppenheimer Asset Management said they would suspend their year-end targets because of how difficult predicting the market's path had become. Others slashed their targets after the spring selloff, only to bump them up again after the summer rally. Goldman Sachs Group Inc. cut its year-end target to 3000 in March, then raised it to 3600 in August and to 3700 in November. The index closed the year at 3756.07.
Then of course, the elections brought their own missed predictions, most notably that the Democrats would take control of Congress in a "blue wave."
If anything, myriad examples of calls gone wrong show there is plenty of humility to be learned from markets, which regularly prove the smartest investors and strategists wrong.
"You always think about things trending through the influence of typical variables like macroeconomic policy, fiscal policy, global growth. . .but what tends to happen with big moves is unseen shocks," Aberdeen's Mr. Bassett said.
The tech trade is only getting bigger
Investors predicting value would finally unseat growth were proved wrong yet again.
In 2020, electric-car maker Tesla Inc. became the most valuable auto maker in the world and Airbnb made its debut on the public market with a valuation greater than that of Marriott International Inc., Hilton Worldwide Holdings Inc. and Hyatt Hotels Corp. combined. It also was the year when many technology companies disproportionately benefited from a pandemic that has forced individuals to spend more time at home and online. Zoom Video Communications Inc. rose 396% during the year, roughly 24 times the S&P 500's gain. Online retailer Etsy Inc. added 302% while PayPal Holdings Inc. climbed 117%.
Appetite for newly listed technology stocks has been even more striking -- so much so that a few companies, including Roblox Corp., decided to delay their planned IPOs to try to better understand how to price their shares.
It is the type of scenario that can make investors feel like the most reliable stock market play is simply betting on the fastest-growing technology stocks.
To be sure, an investor fixated on growth might have missed out on a number of cheaper, more "old-school" stocks that benefited from the pandemic, such as Clorox Co. or Domino's Pizza Inc. Money managers who are overwhelmingly concentrated in growth stocks also have had the disadvantage of being hit particularly hard during recent market reversals, like in November when Pfizer Inc. released promising news about its Covid-19 vaccine. Stocks including Zoom and Peloton Interactive had one of their worst days of the year Nov. 9, logging double-digit percentage declines, although they quickly made up ground in the weeks that followed.
But none of that necessarily means 2021 will be the year that growth stocks take a back seat to value. Society as a whole was becoming more technology-oriented, even before the pandemic, Mr. Bassett said. The end of the coronavirus pandemic won't be a panacea to companies in already struggling sectors such as oil or bricks-and-mortar retail.
"I don't recommend buying companies that were tarnished goods before Covid," Mr. Slimmon said.
Credit: By Akane Otani

## DETAILS

| | |
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## LINKS

Document 35 of 75

# U.S. News: Inaugural To Feature A Virtual Parade

Tarini Parti . Tarini Parti.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

President-elect Joe Biden's inauguration will include a virtual parade as part of a series of events on Jan. 20 that have been scaled down because of the coronavirus pandemic, the inaugural committee said Sunday.

After being sworn in on the west side of the Capitol, Mr. Biden, Vice President-elect Kamala Harris and their spouses will participate in Pass in Review, a military tradition that reflects the peaceful transfer of power and will include every branch of the military, according to the committee. Mr. Biden is expected to review the readiness of the troops and will then be escorted from 15th Street to the White House by members of the military.

With the coronavirus raging across the country, the inauguration committee will be holding a virtual parade instead of the traditional in-person parade and balls. The planned programming is expected to feature Americans across the country along with musical acts, local bands and poets to pay tribute to front-line workers during the pandemic.

"There are many grand traditions to the inaugural and we plan to honor them by highlighting more of our nation's people than ever before while keeping everyone safe," said Tony Allen, chief executive of the inaugural committee.

The inaugural committee has told people not to attend the inaugural activities and hired a chief medical adviser to help plan the event based on health safety protocols.

Credit: By Tarini Parti

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## LINKS



# World News: China Export Rise Faces Jam

Xie, Stella Yifan . Xie, Stella Yifan.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

HONG KONG -- A logjam in the global shipping industry is testing the resilience of China's exporters, who have driven the country's economic recovery by churning out goods to meet surging global demand during the Covid-19 pandemic.

That demand in recent months has outpaced the capacity of a global shipping industry that has been slowed by pandemic safety measures. Chinese exporters have been paying sharply higher rates and struggling to find containers for their goods.

Chen Yang, who runs a textile-trading unit at a state-owned enterprise in the southern city of Hefei, said the business, which mostly exports to the U.S., has weathered the pandemic and the China-U.S. trade war, but he expected to incur losses in 2020 in part because of a sharp rise in shipping costs.

A 40-foot container arriving at the port of Charleston, S.C., in December cost Mr. Yang around $7,500, up from $2,700 in April, he said. He also has to book space on the vessel at least 20 days in advance, more than double the usual time.

"I have never seen anything like this in my 18 years of experience as an exporter," said Mr. Yang. "We've been operating at a loss since August."

The problem has been aggravated by a worsening imbalance in global trade. In November, China logged a record trade surplus of $75 billion, fueled by strong consumer demand from Western countries ahead of the holiday season for everything from electronic gadgets to furniture and bikes.

Major U.S. ports imported 2.21 million 20-foot containers in October, up 17.6% from a year earlier and setting a record since the National Retail Federation began tracking imports in 2002. Container freight rates from Asia to the U.S. surged to a record in September and rates from Asia to Europe reached a 10-year high in December.

Pandemic-related safety measures have lowered efficiency at ports, leading to delivery delays and containers getting stuck all over the world. In November, only half of global carriers managed to stay on schedule, compared with 80% a year ago, according to a service-reliability index from Sea-Intelligence.

The average turnaround time for containers returning to China was up to 100 days in December from the more typical 60 days, according to the China Container Industry Association.

"The logjam is completely unprecedented, both in terms of the scale of the surge and the duration," said Tan Hua Joo, a Singapore-based consultant at Liner Research Services.

While economists say shipping problems haven't derailed China's solid recovery yet, they pose a challenge to sustaining the export growth that has driven it.

China's official manufacturing purchasing managers index, a gauge of China's factory activity, suggested that growth slowed in December. A subindex for new export orders edged down from the previous month to 51.3%, though still in expansion territory.

China's rapidly appreciating currency, the yuan, which has risen more than 8% against the U.S. dollar in the past six months, is also eroding the profit margins for Chinese traders, most of whom still accept payments in U.S. dollars.

Bruce Pang, head of macro and strategy research at China Renaissance Securities, said that high shipping costs would likely remain a major headache for most Chinese exporters until the Lunar New Year holiday in February, when most factories will close for at least two weeks.

"It will certainly strain cash flow for some smaller exporters, especially those trading in low-margin goods," said Mr. Pang. Many manufacturers have been reluctant to expand capacity and are cautious about taking new orders, he added.

Tony Chen, a toy exporter in the southern Chinese city of Shantou, said many of his clients in the U.S. and Europe have told him to halt delivery, because the hefty logistics costs have eroded their profit margins.

"It has been very frustrating," he said, adding that he has stopped accepting new orders from customers in recent weeks because he can't guarantee when he will be able to deliver.

In early December, China's ministry of commerce vowed to increase production of containers to ease the supply shortage, as well as monitor the shipping market more closely to stabilize costs.

But fixing the problems won't be easy. China International Marine Containers (Group) Co., the world's largest container producer, told investors in November that its factories are fully booked until the end of March. More than

95% of shipping containers are built in China.
Churning out more container boxes could lead to a glut down the road, but some say that is the only viable option to ease the shortage now.
"You are damned if you do and you are damned if you don't," said Charles Du Cane, commercial director at Seastar Maritime Ltd., which operates dry bulk vessels. "The real solution to all of this is to deal with the pandemic and the global logistics system."
Credit: By Stella Yifan Xie

## DETAILS


| | |
|---|---|
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## LINKS

Document 37 of 75

# U.S. News --- THE OUTLOOK: Boom Should Follow a Tough Winter

Torry, Harriet . Torry, Harriet.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

Headed into 2021, the U.S. faces a surge in coronavirus cases, new restrictions on business, cautious holiday shopping and slowing economic growth. Forecasters anticipate that the Labor Department's December jobs report, due to be released Friday, will show the labor market closed last year on a weak footing.

Economists surveyed by The Wall Street Journal expect to see employers added 68,000 new jobs in December, down from 245,000 a month earlier. That would mark the slowest month of the labor market's recovery since May.

As the Covid-19 pandemic drags into another year, however, economists see several reasons for optimism.

First, the recently enacted pandemic-relief legislative package will pump $900 billion into the economy in coming months.

Second, with much of the services sector hobbled by the pandemic, Americans have been saving an unusually high share of their income since spring, when the pandemic first prompted widespread restrictions on business activities.

The U.S. personal saving rate was 12.9% in November, down from 33.7% in April but still well above the 7.5% rate a year earlier. Many households will be able to draw on those reserves to boost spending once coronavirus-related restrictions ease and vaccinations embolden people to venture out more, according to economists.

These two factors together could fuel a resurgence in spending that will jazz the economy in the second half of 2021.

Third, borrowing costs are low, and most Federal Reserve officials expect the central bank will hold short-term rates near zero for at least three more years.

Goldman Sachs expects U.S. gross domestic product to grow 5.8% in 2021 after contracting 3.5% in 2020. Moody's Investors Service expects 4.2% growth in 2021.

One cloud on the horizon is that the latest coronavirus-relief package might be coming too late to prevent the economy from slowing further in the first quarter of 2021.

In a Journal survey of economists last month, forecasters slashed their projections for economic growth and job creation in the first quarter of 2021, but raised them for the second, third and fourth quarters.

"I look at 2021 as a critical transition year for the U.S. economy," said Bernard Baumohl, chief global economist at Economic Outlook Group. He welcomed the new pandemic-relief package, but cautioned that uncertainty remained

around the vaccine rollout. He said he expected 2021 "to be a year of adjustment, of adaptation."
Richard Moody, chief economist at Regions Financial Corp. in Birmingham, Ala., said the recovery's shape would depend on consumers' psychology, particularly whether and when they feel comfortable going back to spending as they did before the pandemic.
Analysts caution that the economy is likely to look different as it emerges from the pandemic, with some crisis-driven shifts proving permanent. Companies are rethinking whether to bring workers back to offices and how much employees need to travel now that teleconferencing is a bigger part of daily life. American consumers have accelerated their embrace of digital shopping, telehealth appointments and online fitness classes while shunning malls, doctors' offices and gyms.
Economists say the recovery could follow a path different from recoveries in the past because the downturn has been so unusual. Previous major recessions tended to originate with high interest rates hitting the construction and manufacturing industries, which then rebounded strongly after rates eventually fell. This time, services provided in-person were among the business activities hardest hit.
High-turnover hospitality jobs are likely to come back faster than jobs lost in past recessions, said Alexander Bartik, assistant professor of economics at the University of Illinois. A quicker recovery could be in store, he said.
Still, that serves as little consolation for businesses facing a tough few months at the start of 2021. U.S. shoppers spent less than in the previous year over a five-day stretch in November including Black Friday and Cyber Monday. Retail sales dropped a seasonally adjusted 1.1% in November from the prior month.
"There's literally no one on the streets," said Shelley Meyer, co-founder of five specialty retail stores in Austin, Texas. "It's desolate."
The stores sell toys, fashion, music and candy and largely cater to downtown office workers and visitors from out of town. Curbside pickup and online shopping are offered, "but that will never make a dent; our stores are experiential, it depends on people walking in for us to do well," Ms. Meyer said.
"My downtown stores are doing 35% to 40% of last year's business," she said, adding: "We live every day wondering when the other shoe is going to drop. Are we going to be evicted? Are we going to have to declare bankruptcy?"
For many businesses, the concern about 2021 transcends the bottom line.
Aaron Rubin, co-founder of the New York-based shipping company ShipHero LLC, said growth slowed over the holiday season after a blockbuster third quarter.
"Overall our business is fine," Mr. Rubin said. "The bigger issue is, people-wise, we've got a lot of people out" because of coronavirus exposure. "The human tragedy around Covid is the big thing right now," he said.
Credit: By Harriet Torry

## DETAILS


| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Gross Domestic Product--GDP; Shopping; Interest rates; Economists; Economic growth; Coronaviruses; Pandemics; Recessions; Labor market; COVID-19 |
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## LINKS

Document 38 of 75

# World News: Hackers Bolster Kremlin Ambitions --- Cyber operations play a major role in Russia's confrontation with the West

Kantchev, Georgi . Kantchev, Georgi.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

The sprawling SolarWinds hack by suspected Russian state-backed hackers is the latest sign of Moscow's growing resolve and improving technical ability to cause disruption and conduct espionage at a global scale in cyberspace.

The hack, which compromised parts of the U.S. government as well as tech companies, a hospital and a university, adds to a string of increasingly sophisticated and ever more brazen online intrusions, demonstrating how cyber operations have become a key plank in Russia's confrontation with the West, analysts and officials say.

Moscow's relations with the West continue to sour, and the Kremlin sees the cyber operations as a cheap and effective way to achieve its geopolitical goals, analysts say. Russia, they say, is therefore unlikely to back off from such tactics, even while facing U.S. sanctions or countermeasures.

"For a country that already perceives itself as being in conflict with the West practically in every domain except open military clashes, there is no incentive to leave any field that can offer an advantage," said Keir Giles, senior consulting fellow at Chatham House think tank.

The scope of Russia's cyber operations has grown in tandem with Moscow's global ambitions: from cyberattacks on neighboring Estonia in 2007 to election interference in the U.S. and France a decade later, to SolarWinds, seen as one of the worstknown hacks of federal computer systems.

Russia has consistently denied engaging in state-backed hacking campaigns, including SolarWinds, maintaining that the country isn't conducting offensive cyber operations. In September, Russian President Vladimir Putin proposed a reset of U.S.-Russia information-security relations.

But analysts say that Moscow has added hacking to its arsenal of so-called gray-area activities -- a type of warfare that stops short of actual shooting -- alongside disinformation campaigns and the use of "little green men," the masked soldiers in green uniforms who appeared with Russian arms on Ukrainian territory in 2014.

Jeffrey Edmonds, a former White House and Central Intelligence Agency official who studies Russia at CNA, a nonprofit research organization that advises the Pentagon, said that Russia's cyber operations have numerous simultaneous goals, including gathering intelligence, testing capabilities, preparing for potential conflict by mapping adversaries' critical infrastructure and laying the groundwork for cyber negotiations.

Such operations are a relatively inexpensive and effective way to conduct geopolitics, said Bilyana Lilly, researcher at think tank Rand Corp. That is crucial for Russia, which is facing considerable economic and demographic challenges and whose economy is smaller than Italy's. A 2012 article in an official Russian military journal said that the "complete destruction of the information infrastructures" of the U.S. or Russia could be carried out by just one battalion of 600 "info warriors" at a price tag of $100 million.

Washington's retaliation measures -- sanctions, property seizures, diplomatic expulsions, even the cyber equivalent of warning shots -- appear to have done little to deter hacks.

Still, some former U.S. officials said Russia is far from flawless in the cybersphere.

"They're not 10 feet tall. They are detectable," said former senior CIA official Steven Hall, who oversaw U.S. intelligence operations in the former Soviet Union and Eastern Europe.

Credit: By Georgi Kantchev in Moscow and Warren P. Strobel in Washington

## DETAILS


| | |
|---|---|
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## LINKS

Document 39 of 75

# U.S. News: Biden's 'Buy American' Pledge Met With Cheers, but Also Resistance

Hufford, Austen; Tita, Bob . Hufford, Austen; Tita, Bob.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

President-elect Joe Biden is pledging to use the power of the federal government to buy American goods and jump-start domestic manufacturing. Some companies say rules that are too restrictive could raise their costs and complicate supply chains for items not made in the U.S.

Mr. Biden's "buy American" proposals echo those of predecessors, including President Trump, who issued executive orders to spur more federal purchases of U.S. goods and sought to use tariffs to disadvantage foreign producers. The results for companies have been uneven, with some benefiting from increased sales and others dealing with higher expenses.

Mr. Biden said during his campaign and after his election that he would tighten "buy American" rules. He has proposed $400 billion in spending on infrastructure projects that use American products such as domestically made steel and protective gear for medical workers battling the coronavirus pandemic. He has also proposed that Congress devote an additional $300 billion to research and development of new products.

"From autos to our stockpiles, we're going to buy American," Mr. Biden said in November.

Those promises could be difficult to turn into reality, however, and could face resistance in a divided Congress. Some economists and trade experts said such government purchasing might help some companies but not the industrial sector overall. The policies carry risks including higher prices and retaliation from other countries against U.S. exports, said some executives and economists.

"It raises the cost of things that will be purchased," said Mary Lovely, a senior fellow at the Peterson Institute for International Economics.

Mr. Trump also pledged to buy American, but some manufacturers want the federal government to go further to give priority to their products. Tariffs boosted some companies such as domestic aluminum makers while raising costs for others that import components and materials from abroad.

Mr. Biden's transition team declined to comment on his plans beyond his public statements and proposals on his website.

Many U.S. manufacturers have weathered the pandemic well, but a year of economic dislocations continues to present challenges for the sector. Manufacturing output fell sharply at the start of the pandemic but has expanded for seven months to 3.4% below year-ago levels, Federal Reserve data show. Strong consumer demand for products such as appliances and cars has kept factories humming.

Some manufacturers said supply-chain problems during the pandemic and tensions between the U.S. and China could help Mr. Biden build support for "buy American" initiatives.

Morey Corp., an Illinois manufacturer of wireless communications equipment, has been relocating production and engineering operations to the U.S. from Asia for five years. Chief Strategy Officer Ryne DeBoer said Morey found that truck and construction-equipment makers were willing to pay more for U.S.-made products in exchange for better quality and more service support. He said he hopes that proves true of the Biden administration as well.

"We believe we're perfectly primed to get more government work," he said.

But other manufacturers rely on global supply chains and demand from other countries that could be hurt by made-in-America requirements. Many of these companies said the Trump administration's imposition of double-digit tariffs on imports from China hurt their business.

"We have to depend on raw materials from other countries," said Rakesh Tammabattula, chief executive of QYK Brands LLC.

The California company in 2020 began producing surgical masks with imported fabric from China that he said is subject to a U.S. tariff. Mr. Tammabattula said prices for masks made in China have dropped below what he pays for fabric to make masks in the U.S. He said QYK has started making disinfectant wipes rather than masks.

The International Safety Equipment Association, a trade group, said requiring personal-protective equipment to be made in the U.S. could make supply chains less flexible if other countries implement their own restrictions.

Supporters of Mr. Biden's plans say a willingness to pay more for domestic goods will help companies cover startup costs and restore supply chains that disappeared as production moved overseas.
Sherrill Manufacturing Inc., the last maker of stainless-steel flatware in the U.S., lobbied for years for its products to be added to a law known as the Berry Amendment, which requires the military to buy certain supplies domestically. Provisions to extend Berry requirements to more defense contracts were included in the defense spending bill voted into law on Friday.
Mr. Trump signed off on stainless-steel flatware's addition to the law in 2019. "The forks were in there because we fought for them," said Sherrill's president, Matthew Roberts. He said the government should add more items to the law: "We need to be as self-sufficient as possible."
Credit: By Austen Hufford and Bob Tita

## DETAILS


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|---|---|
| Subject: | International trade; Supply chains; US exports; Medical supplies; Costs; Pandemics; Masks; Tariffs; Manufacturing |
| Business indexing term: | Subject: International trade Supply chains US exports Costs Tariffs Manufacturing; Industry: 33911 : Medical Equipment and Supplies Manufacturing |
| Location: | China; United States--US |
| People: | Biden, Joseph R Jr |
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## LINKS

Document 40 of 75

# World News: World Watch

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

NIGER

At Least 100 Slain

In Jihadist Attacks

Islamic extremists killed at least 100 people in attacks on two villages in Niger near the border with Mali, Niger's prime minister said Sunday.

Prime Minister Brigi Rafini traveled to the villages of Tchombangou and Zaroumdareye a day after the attack. The villages were attacked Saturday after locals killed two fighters, officials said.

Niger has endured several attacks by Islamists, including the Nigeria-based Boko Haram, and fighters linked to the Islamic State group and al-Qaeda. Thousands of people have been killed and hundreds of thousands displaced.

-- Associated Press

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PAKISTAN

Gunmen Kill 11 Shiite

Minority Coal Miners

Gunmen opened fire on minority Shiite Hazara coal miners after abducting them, killing 11 in southwestern Pakistan on Sunday, a Pakistani official said.

The Islamic State group later claimed responsibility. The militant group has repeatedly targeted Pakistan's minority Shiites.

Moazzam Ali Jatoi, an official with the Levies Force, which serves as police and paramilitary in the area, said the

attackers took the miners into nearby mountains and killed them. The attack took place near the Machh coal field, about 30 miles east of the provincial capital Quetta.
-- Associated Press
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UNITED KINGDOM
Judge Set to Rule on
Assange Extradition
WikiLeaks founder Julian Assange will find out on Monday whether he can be extradited from the U.K. to the U.S. to face espionage charges over the publication of secret American military documents.
District Judge Vanessa Baraitser is due to deliver her decision at London's Old Bailey courthouse at 10 a.m. Monday. If she grants the request, Britain's home secretary, Priti Patel, would make the final decision.
Stella Moris, Mr. Assange's partner, has appealed to President Trump to pardon him.
-- Associated Press
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IRAQ
Baghdad Rally Marks
Iran General's Killing
Chanting anti-American slogans, thousands of Iraqis converged on central Baghdad to commemorate the anniversary of the killing of a powerful Iranian general and a top Iraqi militia leader in a U.S. drone strike.
The killing last year of Gen. Qassem Soleimani and Abu Mahdi al-Mohandes at Baghdad's airport pushed Iran and the U.S. close to conflict and sparked outrage in Iraq, leading parliament to pass a nonbinding resolution days later calling for the expulsion of all foreign troops from Iraq. The protest was organized by the Iran-backed Popular Mobilization Forces.
-- Associated Press

## DETAILS


| | |
|---|---|
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## LINKS

Document 41 of 75

# U.S. News: U.S., in Shift, Orders Carrier Back to Mideast Amid Iran Tension

Lubold, Gordon; Youssef, Nancy A . Lubold, Gordon; Youssef, Nancy A.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

WASHINGTON -- The Pentagon's acting chief abruptly reversed course, sending an aircraft carrier to the Middle East to counter threats posed by Iran, days after directing it to leave the region over the advice of top military advisers.

Acting Secretary of Defense Chris Miller said in a statement Sunday evening that he had directed the USS Nimitz to the Middle East, three days after ordering that it be sent home.

The move was a remarkable change of heart for Mr. Miller, who had previously ordered the carrier be sent home against advice by top commanders that the carrier needed to remain near the Middle East because it represented an important show of force at a time when the threat posed by Iran was high, officials said.

"Due to the recent threats issued by Iranian leaders against President Trump and other U.S. government officials, I have ordered the USS Nimitz to halt its routine redeployment," the statement said. "The USS Nimitz will now remain on station in the U.S. Central Command area of operations. No one should doubt the resolve of the United States of America."

The statement didn't say how long the carrier would remain in the region.
Fears are rising that Tehran or its proxies may retaliate around the first anniversary of the killing of Maj. Gen. Qassem Soleimani, the head of Iran's powerful Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps, and Iraqi paramilitary commander Abu Mahdi al-Mohandes. They were hit by a U.S. drone strike while traveling on Baghdad's airport road on Jan. 3, 2019.
Late last week, Mr. Miller, who was appointed acting secretary after the firing of Defense Secretary Mark Esper in November, directed that the carrier redeploy to its home port in Washington state. The ship's crew was quarantined for two weeks because of the coronavirus pandemic and then deployed for nearly 10 months, an unusually long period, and Mr. Miller believed returning the ship home was necessary for its maintenance and the well-being of the ship's crew, officials said.
"We are glad that we can conclude 2020 by announcing these warriors are headed home," the Pentagon said in a statement on Thursday about the carrier and its accompanying ships.
Other officials also believe Mr. Miller was convinced that drawing the carrier out of the region would signal U.S. interest in de-escalating tensions with Iran. The carrier is considered one of the most potent symbols of American military might, and its presence can send a message.
Military advisers, including the chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff, Army Gen. Mark Milley, and Marine Gen. Frank McKenzie, who heads U.S. Central Command, which is responsible for U.S. military operations in the Middle East and Central Asia, had urged Mr. Miller to keep the carrier in the region, defense officials said.
But after the Defense Department said that the carrier was going to depart the region, U.S. officials became aware of many public statements from Iranian officials that they considered concerning, officials said. On Twitter, Iran Foreign Minister Javad Zarif repeatedly warned of plots to provoke conflict between the two nations.
"Intelligence from Iraq indicate plot to FABRICATE pretext for war," Mr. Zarif wrote in a tweet Friday. "Iran doesn't seek war but will OPENLY & DIRECTLY defend its people, security & vital interests."
Iraqi officials have scrambled to prevent retaliatory attacks by militias, warning that it could lead to an aggressive U.S. military response.
The U.S. Central Command and the Joint Chiefs of Staff didn't respond to queries on Sunday.
In recent weeks, the U.S. has seen increased chatter among some militia groups in Iraq threatening to retaliate for the deaths of Gen. Suleimani and Mr. al-Mohandes, the official said.
There has been an escalating U.S. presence in the region. On Wednesday, the U.S. dispatched two B-52 bombers on a flight over the Middle East in a show of force directed at "anyone who intends to do harm to Americans or American interests," according to the U.S. Central Command. In addition, an amphibious assault ship, the USS Makin Island, with a squadron of F-35s, is currently near the Persian Gulf.
Credit: By Gordon Lubold and Nancy A. Youssef

## DETAILS


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| Business indexing term: | Industry: 92811 : National Security |
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## LINKS



# U.S. News: GOP Pours Money Into Georgia

McWhirter, Cameron; Jamerson, Joshua . McWhirter, Cameron; Jamerson, Joshua.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

ATLANTA -- Republicans across the country are pouring an unprecedented amount of money and resources into Georgia to try to hold their Senate majority by winning at least one of two runoff elections on Tuesday.

Four outside groups associated with Senate Majority Leader Mitch McConnell (R., Ky.) alone have invested $138.5 million in the races. The Georgia Battleground Fund, a group supporting both Republican incumbents and the National Republican Senatorial Committee, set fundraising targets for each of the 50 states to pump about $50 million into advertising and the Georgia GOP's voter turnout operation.

Democrats are also investing heavily in the races, as expenditures by the campaigns and outside groups have reached well beyond $500 million, making them among the most expensive Senate races in history.

Historic trends favor Republicans. Since the early 2000s, the Republican Party has dominated Georgia politics, and the GOP controls both chambers of the legislature and every elected statewide office. Since 1988, Republicans have also won every statewide runoff in Georgia except one in 1998, mostly because of a drop in Democratic turnout.

That reliable pattern was thrown into question in November when President-elect Joe Biden defeated President Trump in Georgia by 12,000 votes, becoming the first Democratic presidential candidate to capture the state since 1992.

In the Senate contests, Republicans David Perdue and Sen. Kelly Loeffler fell short of garnering the 50%-plus-one-vote threshold set by state law to avoid a runoff race. Mr. Perdue, 71 years old, must beat Democrat Jon Ossoff, 33, a filmmaker, to return to the Senate; his term has lapsed and his former seat will remain vacant pending the outcome of the election. Ms. Loeffler, who was appointed to her post after the previous senator retired because of health reasons, is running against Democrat Raphael Warnock, a pastor. Her term hasn't expired yet.

The Senate currently has 51 Republicans and 48 Democrats. If Democrats win both Georgia races, they will gain control because Vice President-elect Kamala Harris would cast tiebreaking votes. If Republicans win just one of them, the GOP will maintain its majority.

While both parties have been flooding the television airwaves, Republicans and Democrats agree that turning out their base voters is likely to be the key to winning.

More than three million Georgians voted early as of Saturday afternoon, according to the U.S. Elections Project. Black voters, a core Democratic constituency, are making up roughly 31% of the early-voting electorate thus far -- a larger share than the group had in November, which is a good indicator for Democrats.

Some Republicans who are monitoring early voting trends acknowledge those positive signs for Democrats but caution that GOP voters who show up on Election Day could act as a counterweight to early voting that leans Democratic.

Republicans "need a supercharged Election Day," said Washington-based GOP strategist Scott Reed, who is doing some fundraising for the Georgia races. "The Democrats have done very well on early voting and they've done really well on fundraising, but at the end of the day we believe we can win both these races and will."

Messrs. Biden and Trump are holding competing campaign rallies in Georgia on the eve of the election; Mr. Biden in Atlanta, and Mr. Trump in Dalton. Ms. Harris was slated to headline a rally on Sunday in Savannah.

In addition to rallies with Mr. Trump, Vice President Mike Pence and many visits from Republican senators from other states, the party and conservative groups have been fanning out across the state, visiting homes of people they believe to be GOP voters to ensure they get to the polls. The goal is to reach these homes numerous times before election day. Some groups are sponsoring commercials urging people who voted for Mr. Biden to back Sens. Perdue and Loeffler to secure a balanced government.

The GOP effort, which party leaders here say is unprecedented in its scope, is an effort to match the Democrats' extraordinary push, which has included door-knocking, rap concerts, visits from former President Obama, and streaming fundraisers with Hollywood stars. Will Ferrell and the cast of the holiday movie "Elf" held a live internet reading of the film to raise money.

Democrats said they are cautiously optimistic. "Going into the runoffs there were a lot of questions about the Democratic turnout operation and doubts about if we would be able to turn out voters on Jan. 5. I think that what

you're seeing mainly in the early vote. . .is that those questions have been answered: Democrats have an enthusiasm that's still off the charts," said Terrence Clark, communications director for Mr. Warnock.
However, he added Democrats still needed a strong showing on election day.
"It is still Georgia, and it is still going to be close," he said, noting the GOP's longtime voter turnout operation in the state.
Julianne Thompson, a Georgia Republican strategist who worked with Mr. Trump's 2020 campaign, said the party going forward needs to broaden its appeal and have a consistent message regardless of Mr. Trump's role in the party.
"It cannot be about one personality," she said. "It has to be about policies that transcend whoever is in office at the time."
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Lindsay Wise contributed to this article.
Credit: By Cameron McWhirter and Joshua Jamerson

## DETAILS


| | |
|---|---|
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| Business indexing term: | Industry: 92111 : Executive Offices 92112 : Legislative Bodies |
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## LINKS



# U.S. News: Vaccine Study On Campuses Is Held Up

Loftus, Peter . Loftus, Peter.



## FULL TEXT

Plans have stalled for a large study on U.S. college campuses that was intended to answer a question critical to the coronavirus pandemic response: Do the new Covid-19 vaccines stop the virus from spreading, in addition to protecting individuals from getting sick?

A network of medical researchers who have helped run federally funded studies of Covid-19 vaccines were hoping to start a clinical trial of Moderna Inc.'s shot in more than 20,000 college students this month. The study would test whether the vaccine prevented transmission of the coronavirus from person to person and whether it prevented infections that don't trigger symptoms.

But in late December, the researchers told about 20 universities that were considering participating in the study that it wouldn't move forward yet, according to people involved in the effort. The researchers weren't able to secure federal funding for the trial, which would have cost several hundred million dollars, and faced time constraints in getting the complex study up and running so it could yield results before students ended the spring semester, these people said.

"In the end, there just wasn't enough support to get it off the ground at this point in time," said Myron Cohen, director of the Institute for Global Health and Infectious Diseases at the University of North Carolina. "We just could not get everything together to do it now."

The study had been planned by leaders of the Covid-19 Prevention Network, which the National Institute of Allergy and Infectious Diseases formed to conduct large studies of Covid-19 vaccines and treatments. The network includes clinical research sites around the U.S. that in the past have run studies of HIV/AIDS vaccines. Researchers from the network proposed the study to a public-private partnership led by the National Institutes of Health, known as Activ, which has crafted a research strategy.

The NIH and other federal agencies have funded the large efficacy trials of several Covid-19 vaccines, including Moderna's, under the auspices of the Trump administration's Operation Warp Speed initiative to develop and deliver Covid-19 vaccines.

A spokeswoman for the National Institute of Allergy and Infectious Diseases, which is part of the NIH, said NIAID was considering such a study but decided not to move forward with it because it had concerns about its feasibility, and it saw other paths to finding the same answers.

The spokeswoman said NIAID had concerns that university health-care workers were already overwhelmed with managing Covid-19 on campuses, and it would have been difficult to enlist them to also run a clinical trial. NIAID expects to learn more about the vaccines' effect on transmission and asymptomatic infection from additional data from the existing efficacy trials and observational studies during the vaccine rollout.

The change of plans for the college-student study means it might take longer to find out whether the new vaccines prevent transmission and asymptomatic infections, or that those questions will have to be answered in other ways.

U.S. regulators authorized the Moderna vaccine, and one from Pfizer Inc. and BioNTech SE, in December based on evidence that they protected people from Covid-19 with symptoms like cough and fever, including in severe cases. But these studies didn't yield enough evidence of whether the shots prevent viral transmission and asymptomatic infections.

The planned study would have used near-daily Covid-19 testing and contact tracing to determine whether vaccinated students subsequently contracted Covid-19 -- with or without symptoms -- and whether they transmitted the virus to others. The study would have compared these rates with those seen in unvaccinated students, Dr. Cohen said.

Researchers believed colleges would have been ideal for the study because the virus has spread rapidly on some campuses where students live in close quarters. Many students' infections are asymptomatic, and younger people generally are at lower risk of severe disease. Some colleges are already performing frequent Covid-19 testing and contact tracing.

Some of the colleges that were being considered for the study included Louisiana State University, the University of Michigan, the University of Washington, Morehouse College and the University of North Carolina, according to a person familiar with the matter.

Credit: By Peter Loftus

## DETAILS

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|---|---|
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## LINKS

Document 44 of 75

# Alabama, Ohio State Took Different Paths --- The Crimson Tide navigated the coronavirus pandemic with little disruption, while the Buckeyes were rocked by it

Higgins, Laine . Higgins, Laine.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

A year ago, Alabama rang in 2020 with a New Year's Day bowl win that was no salve for the bitter taste of missing the College Football Playoff for the first time in its short history. Ohio State was in Columbus, licking its wounds after a crushing semifinal playoff loss to Clemson in the Fiesta Bowl.

Both programs felt snakebit by dream seasons derailed and vowed to return to college football's pinnacle in 2021.

Now, Alabama and Ohio State have made good on their offseason vows by making it to this year's championship game in Miami Gardens, Fla., on Jan. 11.

Their paths to the 2021 College Football Playoff Championship could not have been any different, however. No. 1 Alabama was not immune from coronavirus-induced uncertainty, but played its entire pandemic-season schedule without incident, a model of discipline. No. 3 Ohio State was a model of disruption, played just six regular season games and never quite conquered the virus.

Yet both teams, which have now won 12 and seven games, respectively, have played their way to the final.

Alabama punched its ticket to Hard Rock Stadium first on Friday, defeating No. 4 Notre Dame 31-14 in the Rose Bowl, which this year relocated to AT&T Stadium in Arlington, Texas, due to rising coronavirus cases in Southern California.

Alabama's pair of Heisman Trophy finalists -- quarterback Mac Jones and wideout Devonta Smith -- connected for three touchdown receptions and stud running back Najee Harris turned in a highlight-reel of a game with 126 rushing yards and one gravity-defying hurdle over a Notre Dame defender.

Yet the aspect of Alabama's performance that drew the most praise from Coach Nick Saban was its adherence to strict health protocols designed to mitigate viral spread.

"I'm really proud of the way our players have handled disruptions all year long," said Saban. In a testament to his trust in the team, the Alabama coach allowed players return home to their families for the Christmas holiday -- a gambit that could have proved folly had an athlete's cross-country travel introduced the virus into the locker room. No other team that competed in Friday's semifinal allowed players to leave campus between conference championships on Dec. 19 and the first round of the playoff 12 days later.

"I can't verify we didn't have somebody go someplace they weren't supposed to go, but if they did we'll certainly confront them," said Saban. "Because if a player did that, he actually doesn't just put himself at risk, he's putting his teammates at risk when he comes back. And that's the one thing our players have been pretty good about so far this year."

Alabama doesn't disclose the results of its thrice-weekly coronavirus testing, but has seemingly avoided major outbreaks. The most notable personnel absences, receiver Jaylen Waddle and center Landon Dickerson, were the result of leg injuries in October and December, respectively, rather than viral infections. The Crimson Tide saw only one game postponed -- because its opponent, Louisiana State, did not have enough healthy players to go forward with kickoff.

The only person affiliated with the team with a known positive Covid-19 result was Saban. The coach contracted the virus the week of Thanksgiving and watched the Iron Bowl against Auburn from his living room after recording a false positive in October. His absence hardly registered: Alabama crushed its in-state rival 42-13 with offensive coordinator Steve Sarkisian, who last week won the Broyles Award given to the top assistant coach in college football, at the helm.

If the Crimson Tide exemplified how to get through a pandemic season relatively unscathed, Ohio State was an example of achieving greatness in spite of adversity and viral disruptions.

"Not being able, as the head coach and the leader of the program, to look people in the eye and let them know what's coming next. . .that's the biggest challenge," said Buckeyes coach Ryan Day of the pandemic season. "That wears on you."

In late summer, the Buckeyes spent five weeks in limbo, after the Big Ten Conference first postponed the season and then revived a shortened version of it in late October.

Then three of Ohio State's nine games were canceled, dozens of players and several coaches were sidelined by

positive tests and contact tracing and the team required a last minute rule change from the Big Ten's top brass to get a shot at winning its fourth consecutive league title.
"This is one of my favorite teams I've been around. Maybe not because of what's gone on all the time on the field. But more importantly this team is so tough. They've been through so much and they haven't flinched," Day said after defeating Northwestern in the Big Ten Championship on Dec. 19. He was even more effusive leading up to Friday night, calling the Buckeyes' 2020 run "a great story in overcoming so much."
Both teams' victories Friday were followed by noteworthy personnel developments on Saturday.
In the wee hours of Saturday morning, Ohio State quarterback Justin Fields revealed that his torso was "pretty messed up" after he absorbed a crushing "targeting" hit late in the second quarter that got Clemson linebacker James Skalski ejected from the Sugar Bowl. Fields missed just one play, a time during which he said he received "a shot or two" of an unspecified substance in the medical tent, and muscled through the rest of the game despite being in pain on "each and every throw."
"Pretty much my whole right is sore. That's messed up. And a little, my hip," said Fields following the game. "But they [Ohio State's team physicians] didn't really give me a diagnosis at all."
Fields has eight more days to rest up before the national championship, but with the extent of his injuries unclear it is not known whether he will be healthy enough to play. Ohio State has not released details on his condition. Some have suggested that the quarterback, who is slated to be a top pick in the next NFL draft, might benefit from opting out of the title game to prevent further injury. Fields has not said whether he intends to play against Alabama.
Then on Saturday, Alabama had its own bombshell. Sarkisian, the offensive coordinator who previously was a head coach at Washington and Southern California, revealed he would trade crimson for burnt orange as Texas's new head coach. The news came within minutes of the university's surprise decision to fire fourth-year coach Tom Herman. Sarkisian has not yet given an indication about whether he will stay with Alabama to call plays through the national championship.
Credit: By Laine Higgins

## DETAILS


| | |
|---|---|
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## LINKS

Document 45 of 75

# U.S. News: Pelosi Wins Fourth Term as Speaker

Andrews, Natalie . Andrews, Natalie.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

WASHINGTON -- Nancy Pelosi won her fourth term as House speaker on Sunday, showing in the first vote of the new session of Congress how her narrow majority will make it difficult for House Democrats to pass legislation in the new Congress.

The 80-year-old California Democrat, who has led her party in the chamber since 2003, won in a 216-209 vote between her and Minority Leader Kevin McCarthy (R., Calif.), with five Democrats voting present or for someone besides the speaker. The daughter of a congressman from Baltimore, Mrs. Pelosi is the first woman speaker and the first since 1955 to lose the gavel and regain it.

To win the speakership, Mrs. Pelosi had to carry a majority of those present and voting by name. Democrats have 222 seats to Republicans' 211 because one race in New York is still in dispute, and a seat in Louisiana is vacant because Republican Rep.-elect Luke Letlow died on Tuesday from complications of Covid-19.

"Nancy Pelosi believes that our sacred mission is to continue America's long, necessary and majestic march toward a more perfect union," Democratic Caucus Chair Hakeem Jeffries (D., N.Y.) said when he nominated the speaker on the House Floor.

Some lawmakers voted behind plexiglass because they had recently been exposed to the coronavirus, though they had tested negative for Covid-19. Rather than assemble at once, House lawmakers entered the chamber in small groups for social distancing.

Republicans objected to the plexiglass structure, which they said Democrats surprised them with to allow Mrs. Pelosi to get more votes for speaker. Two Democrats and one Republican used it, at the direction of the House physician.

"The lack of communication with the minority makes this 100% political," said Illinois Rep. Rodney Davis, the top Republican on the House Administration Committee. "To build a structure like that, in the dark of night, to only protect the votes that Speaker Pelosi needs to get re-elected speaker, is shameful."

Under the Constitution, Congress starts on Jan. 3. In the past, when Congress has been set to open on a Sunday, lawmakers reached a bipartisan agreement to move the date. However, this year Democrats wanted to avoid a chance for President Trump to make recess appointments, and wanted to be ready for the joint session Wednesday to ratify Democratic President-elect Joe Biden's Electoral College win, the final formal step ahead of his Jan. 20 inauguration.

Some Republicans plan to raise challenges to some of the states' results on Wednesday, alleging election irregularities. Their objections could force debate and votes in both chambers of Congress.

The new Congress will be more diverse than the session before it, with more women and more people of color. At least 118 women will serve in the U.S. House, beating the previous record of 102 set in 2019. Of those, 29 are Republican, breaking the previous GOP record of 25 set in 2006, according to an analysis by the Center for American Women and Politics at Rutgers University.

It is expected to be Mrs. Pelosi's last term as speaker. In 2018, to win the support of detractors, she said she would only seek a fourth and final term if she had the support of two-thirds of her caucus. She ran unopposed in her conference.

"The question is: Are you going to empower the Republican leader, Kevin McCarthy, to which the answer is no," said incoming Rep. Mondaire Jones, a New York Democrat, who said he backed Mrs. Pelosi. An outspoken progressive and one of the first openly gay Black men to be elected to Congress, he said he is ready to push the party to take up Medicare for All and climate legislation.

Rep. Elissa Slotkin (D., Mich.) voted present for the speaker as did two other Democrats, Reps. Abigail Spanberger of Virginia and Mikie Sherrill of New Jersey. Rep. Jared Golden (D., Maine) voted for Sen. Tammy Duckworth (D., Ill.), and Rep. Conor Lamb (D., Pa.) voted for Mr. Jeffries.

Lawmakers won't be able to vote by proxy as they have done during the pandemic until Congress passes its new rules package on Monday. The rules package will implement remote voting as well as several procedural changes. One major change will be that the motion to recommit, a procedural vote that allowed the minority to amend a bill just before it passed, will now send the bill back to the committee of jurisdiction.

Credit: By Natalie Andrews

## DETAILS

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## LINKS

Document 46 of 75

# U.S. News: How GOP Challenge to Biden's Victory Will Play Out

Hughes, Siobhan; Wise, Lindsay . Hughes, Siobhan; Wise, Lindsay.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

Congress is set to hold a joint session Wednesday to ratify Democrat President-elect Joe Biden's Electoral College win in the November election. Some Republicans plan to raise challenges to some of the states' results, alleging election irregularities. Their objections could force debate and votes in both chambers of Congress.

None of the challenges are expected to succeed, but they could slow the process. Here are some questions and answers about it will play out.

What happens on Wednesday?

The law specifies that Congress is to convene at 1 p.m. Jan. 6 for a joint meeting to officially count and validate the 538 electoral votes that have been certified by the 50 states and District of Columbia.

Vice President Mike Pence, acting in his constitutional role as the president of the Senate, opens up all the certificates reflecting the vote tallies sent by the states. He hands them to "tellers," who then read the states' certificates, stating that the certificate from each state "seems to be regular in form and authentic." Mr. Pence has the power to recognize any lawmaker who objects.

What is the process for challenging the results?

Any lawmaker can challenge a state's Electoral College votes, but it takes one member of the House and one senator to formally object to a state's result and bring the challenge to a vote by lawmakers. The objection must be in writing. Once an objection is filed with the backing of a House member and a senator, lawmakers break up into their separate chambers to discuss and vote. At the end of debate, lawmakers hold a simple majority vote on the objection. Both the House and the Senate must agree for the challenge to be successful.

If the House and Senate disagree, "Then the challenge is not sustained," said Gregory Koger, a professor of political science at the University of Miami.

A majority consists of a majority of the lawmakers who are present, unless otherwise stipulated, according to Sarah Binder, a George Washington University professor who is also a scholar at the Brookings Institution.

The House has been conducting business through proxy voting, in which one lawmaker may ask a lawmaker who is physically present to vote on his or her behalf. If the organizing resolution for the new Congress permits proxy voting, then members may vote by proxy.

Are some lawmakers expected to challenge the 2020 results?

Yes. Several Republicans have indicated they will do so.

Rep. Mo Brooks (R., Ala.) has said that he plans to challenge the results from several states. He has said Republicans numbering "in the double digits" are joining the effort.

Sen. Josh Hawley (R., Mo.) said he would challenge at least one tally as well.

Mr. Trump and the Republicans challenging the results have alleged widespread fraud and irregularities. No evidence of significant fraud has emerged since the election.

On Saturday, 11 current and incoming Republican senators said they would vote to reject the Electoral College votes of some states as not "lawfully certified" unless Congress appoints a commission to conduct an emergency, 10-day audit of the election results.

Is Congress expected to uphold any of the objections?

No. The Democratic-controlled House is expected to reject any challenge to states' results. Moreover, many

Republicans in the GOP-controlled Senate have expressed skepticism of the challenges.
Why does Congress play a role?
The current process was established through the Electoral Count Act of 1887 to minimize potential involvement by Congress in changing states' reported results. It followed the 1876 presidential election, in which results from Louisiana, Florida, South Carolina and Oregon were in dispute.
Credit: By Siobhan Hughes and Lindsay Wise

## DETAILS

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## LINKS

Document 47 of 75

# World-Wide

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

Trump in a telephone call on Saturday urged Georgia Secretary of State Brad Raffensperger to overturn the November election results that delivered the state to President-elect Joe Biden.

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U.S. workers can look forward to improved post-pandemic commutes because of the expected staying power of the work-from-home trend, say people who study transportation.

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Pelosi won a fourth term as House speaker, showing in the first vote of the new session of Congress how her narrow majority will make it tough for House Democrats to pass legislation in the new Congress.

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The Marines are stepping up training for island-based conflict in the Western Pacific, putting them at the leading edge of a pivot by the U.S. to face the military challenge from China.

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India's emergency authorization of two Covid-19 vaccines begins a massive government inoculation campaign in the world's second-most-populous nation.

Israel has inoculated nearly half of its most at-risk citizens and more than 10% of the population in two weeks as authorities accelerate a Covid-19 vaccination drive.

## DETAILS

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## LINKS

Document 48 of 75

# U.S. News: A Downtown Stretch Shows Uneven Pain

DeBarros, Anthony; Omeokwe, Amara . DeBarros, Anthony; Omeokwe, Amara.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

A 2.5-mile stretch of downtown Asheville, N.C., provides a window into how the coronavirus pandemic slammed small businesses in one American city -- and how a federal loan program helped some stay afloat but was ill-suited for others.

More than 100 businesses and nonprofits in this slice of Asheville along Broadway Street and Biltmore Avenue received a total of about $16 million in forgivable loans through the Paycheck Protection Program. Many have exhausted the money and plan to apply for more, after Congress in December approved $284 billion for a new round of loans.

Businesses receiving aid in the city of 93,000 included restaurants, bars, doctor's offices, auto-repair shops and art galleries. Many are dependent on tourists.

Dozens of business owners along the two streets say the money helped, but the health of their bottom lines -- and their outlook for 2021 -- varies as widely as the products they sell and the meals they offer.

Their divergent trajectories show the uneven impact of a pandemic that has lasted much longer than expected when the loan program was hastily crafted in March.

"That's the weird thing about this pandemic. It's affected everybody, but by no means equally," said Chall Gray, co-owner of Little Jumbo, a cocktail bar that has been closed since March. "It's helped many businesses and hurt many others."

Asheville has begun to rebound in part because its mountain setting attracts visitors seeking outdoor activities seen as safe, said Victoria Isley, chief executive of the Explore Asheville Convention and Visitors Bureau. Still, the area's lodging revenue for the fiscal year ended in June was down roughly 17% compared with the prior year, according to figures provided by Explore Asheville.

Here are six stories from downtown Asheville:

Little Jumbo

Like others in Asheville, Mr. Gray didn't think lockdowns would last long. When Little Jumbo was approved for a nearly $52,000 PPP loan in April, "We thought we should be open by late summer," he said.

But months later, state coronavirus mandates prohibited the bar from serving patrons indoors, and its outdoor serving space was too small to make reopening worthwhile. Mr. Gray said he hadn't been able to bring back the 10 employees he laid off in March amid the state's first shutdown orders. Little Jumbo hasn't spent any of its PPP money, and Mr. Gray said he was holding on to the funds in case of a cash crunch.

While he acknowledged he wasn't using the loan to support payroll, Mr. Gray said he wanted to adhere to state guidelines while also managing the challenge of having no revenue.

Mr. Gray hopes the bar will reopen by early spring. He said he's prepared to repay the loan, which bears a 1% interest rate, if he doesn't qualify for forgiveness. "We decided to treat it as a long-term, low-interest loan," he said.

Moog Music

When the pandemic first disrupted Moog Music's supply of components from China in February, the manufacturer of electronic musical gear decided to pivot -- to making plastic face shields and refurbishing medical equipment.

The company, which has about 160 employees, qualified for a $1.86 million PPP loan that helped offset a drop in revenue. That allowed Moog to redirect some of its staff to work on the medical products.

"We didn't make any money on it," said Mike Adams, president of Moog. "It was just a survival move more than anything else."

Workers at the Moog plant made 15,000 face shields and refurbished continuous positive airway pressure, or CPAP,

machines. Moog did both projects under contract to local manufacturers.
By June, Moog shifted back to music gear full-time. Mr. Adams said he expects the company to have ended 2020 with revenue 15% above 2019.
Old Europe Pastries
Melinda Vetro's pastry shop saw business plummet in the spring and then roar back.
A $62,500 PPP loan helped Old Europe Pastries through the valley. A shift to takeout service and smaller cakes helped spur its revival.
"We lost business for two months," said Ms. Vetro. The shop has a kitchen on-site, so it was deemed essential and allowed to remain open. The staff pushed the pastry display case close to the front door and served coffee, croissants, eclairs, cakes, and other drinks and pastries to go.
"By May, business was up 5% compared to last year because we were able to stay open," Ms. Vetro said.
The PPP loan was spent on payroll, rent and a mixer for the kitchen. During early slow months, Ms. Vetro had to lay off two baristas and a pastry chef. When business rebounded, she brought back the pastry chef and added employees. She now employs 16, up from 13 before the pandemic.
Suwana's Thai Orchid
Suwana Cry is no stranger to economic disasters. In 2005, Hurricane Katrina damaged her Thai restaurant in Mississippi, eventually forcing her to file for bankruptcy.
Ms. Cry opened Suwana's Thai Orchid in 2008. It has 16 tables, and on a normal pre-virus weekend, "The waiting time is 30 to 45 minutes to an hour, depending on what's going on in town," said Ms. Cry, who owns the restaurant with her son and daughter.
She expects revenue to have fallen 20% to 30% from 2019, with seated service taking the biggest hit. A $72,126 Paycheck Protection Program loan has kept an average of nine employees on the payroll. The loan kept the restaurant going as it shifted from a dine-in business to one that is largely takeout. On a recent Friday, just three tables were occupied.
Early on, a "curfew closed dine-in, but we still can do to-go and delivery. That kept us going," Ms. Cry said.
Shay Brown Events
Shay Brown has years of experience planning weddings, birthday parties and other events. But her role evolved in 2020, as the pandemic forced her to reschedule many of the events she had on her books.
"I have turned into a legal adviser. I have turned into a therapist," Ms. Brown said. "It has been an emotional roller coaster."
Revenue at Shay Brown Events Management was down more than 90% from 2019. Business modifications, such as live-streaming over the internet, could only take her so far. "An event is about having people gather," Ms. Brown said.
A nearly $39,000 PPP loan, along with a grant from a local financial institution, kept her afloat.
Pre-pandemic, Ms. Brown employed 20 to 25 people. Now, her staff is down to four full-time workers. Because of evolving state restrictions, Ms. Brown said some events had to be rescheduled. That has left a crowded 2021 calendar.
Center for Craft
When the pandemic hit, the things that make Center for Craft a place that celebrates and supports artisans and artists also suffered. The nonprofit's exhibition space closed for five months, and its co-working space went mostly unused, depriving it of revenue.
Meanwhile, donations slowed. Revenue in 2020 was about a third lower than projected, said the center's executive director, Stephanie Moore.
"We have a lot of donors who just have not had the funds to support us as they were in the past," Ms. Moore said.
The center has had to lay off two employees, though a nearly $97,000 PPP loan has allowed it to keep 10 on the payroll.
"Lots of nonprofits won't be able to sustain themselves for the next three to four months or however long it takes for vaccines to circulate," she said.
---

Ryan Tracy contributed to this article.
Credit: By Anthony DeBarros and Amara Omeokwe

## DETAILS


| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Art galleries & museums; Restaurants; Coronaviruses; Coronavirus Aid Relief & Economic Security Act 2020-US; Small business loans; Employees; Layoffs; Pandemics; COVID-19 |
| Business indexing term: | Subject: Restaurants Coronavirus Aid Relief & Economic Security Act 2020-US Small business loans Employees Layoffs; Industry: 71211 : Museums 72251 : Restaurants and Other Eating Places |
| Location: | Europe |
| Company / organization: | Name: Moog Music; NAICS: 339992 |
| Classification: | 71211: Museums; 72251: Restaurants and Other Eating Places |
| Publication title: | Wall Street Journal, Eastern edition; New York, N.Y. |
| First page: | A.6 |
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## LINKS

Document 49 of 75

# Trump Pressures Official To 'Find' Votes --- Tells Georgia secretary of state to recalculate results, warns of legal action in phone call

McWhirter, Cameron; Wise, Lindsay . McWhirter, Cameron; Wise, Lindsay.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

ATLANTA -- President Trump in a telephone call on Saturday urged Georgia Secretary of State Brad Raffensperger to overturn the November election results that delivered the state to President-elect Joe Biden.

At one point in the roughly hourlong call, Mr. Trump told Mr. Raffensperger that he could face legal action and said he wanted him to find nearly 12,000 votes so he could reverse Mr. Biden's victory.

"I just want to find 11,780 votes, which is one more than we have because we won the state," he told Mr. Raffensperger on the call, adding later, "it's not a problem that is going away." Mr. Biden won the state by 11,779 votes out of about 5 million cast.

A recording of the call was reviewed by The Wall Street Journal.

News of the extraordinary conversation of a sitting president pressuring a state elections official to overturn election results comes just days before Tuesday's runoff elections in Georgia that will determine which party controls the U.S. Senate and a Wednesday joint session of Congress to ratify Mr. Biden's Electoral College win.

Bob Bauer, a senior adviser to Mr. Biden, said of the Trump phone call, "We now have irrefutable proof of a president pressuring and threatening an official of his own party to get him to rescind a state's lawful, certified vote count and fabricate another in its place. It captures the whole, disgraceful story about Donald Trump's assault on American democracy."

Vice President-elect Kamala Harris said the call represented an "abuse of power."

Looking ahead to the joint session of Congress, 11 current and incoming Republican senators said Saturday they would vote to reject the Electoral College votes of some states as not "lawfully certified" unless Congress appoints a commission to conduct an emergency, 10-day audit of the election results.

None of the challenges are expected to succeed, but they could slow down the process and give Mr. Trump's allies a high-profile chance to demonstrate their loyalty to him.

Plans for the joint session were thrown into further turmoil by the recording of Mr. Trump's call. He spent much of it angrily and repeatedly alleging fraud in voting, ballot destruction, voting-machine manipulation and other charges.

"What we are seeing is not at all what you are describing," Ryan Germany, the secretary of state's general counsel, told the president.
Throughout the conversation, Mr. Raffensperger, who oversaw the state's elections, rejected pressure to further investigate an election that has gone through multiple recounts and legal challenges without any evidence of widespread fraud being found.
"There is nothing wrong with saying, you know, that you recalculated," Mr. Trump told Mr. Raffensperger, a fellow Republican, in the conversation.
During the call, first reported by the Washington Post, Mr. Trump repeatedly asserted the election was fraudulent and claimed hundreds of thousands of votes were destroyed and that he had clearly won the state.
"Well, Mr. President, the challenge that you have is that the data you have is wrong," Mr. Raffensperger said at one point.
"There are many, many infractions and the bottom line is it's many, many times the 11,779 margin that they said we lost by," Mr. Trump said at one point. "We had vast, I mean you have, the state is in turmoil over this and I know you would like to get to the bottom of it although I saw you on television today and you said that you found nothing wrong, I mean you know, and I didn't lose the state, Brad."
Mr. Raffensperger held a special hand recount of every paper ballot, as well as a scan recount of the ballots and a special partial audit of one county and all showed no widespread irregularities. Court challenges to the election in Georgia have been dismissed.
The president asserted repeatedly that thousands of dead people had voted in the election, a claim Mr. Raffensperger said was false. At another point, Mr. Trump claimed ballots were being burned and voting machines removed. "This may or may not be true," he said.
On Monday, Mr. Trump plans to hold a rally in Dalton, Ga., on behalf of Republican Senate candidates David Perdue and Kelly Loeffler, both locked in close races. Mr. Perdue, whose term as senator expired Sunday, is battling Democrat Jon Ossoff. Ms. Loeffler, who was appointed last year, is seeking to defeat Democrat Raphael Warnock.
The runoffs, which have drawn national attention and hundreds of millions of dollars in campaign spending, have been overshadowed in many respects by Mr. Trump's continued claims that he didn't lose the state in November. Democrats need to win both races to take control of the Senate.
By law, Congress must hold a joint session on Jan. 6 to ratify Mr. Biden's 306-232 Electoral College win. Objections from some Republican senators and House members are expected to force debate and votes in both chambers. Majorities in both the House and Senate would have to agree for the challenge to be successful, an unlikely prospect given that Democrats control the House.
In a statement, the senators and senators-elect who object to certifying the result said a commission was needed to study "unprecedented allegations of voter fraud." They are Sens. Ted Cruz of Texas, Ron Johnson of Wisconsin, James Lankford of Oklahoma, Steve Daines of Montana, John Kennedy of Louisiana, Marsha Blackburn of Tennessee and Mike Braun of Indiana. The effort was also joined by Senators-elect Cynthia Lummis of Wyoming, Roger Marshall of Kansas, Bill Hagerty of Tennessee and Tommy Tuberville of Alabama.
Recently departed Attorney General William Barr has said there was no evidence of voter fraud that could reverse Mr. Biden's win.
Credit: By Cameron McWhirter and Lindsay Wise

## DETAILS

| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Political campaigns; Election results; Presidents; Voting machines; Appointments & personnel changes; Voter fraud; Presidential elections; State elections |
| Business indexing term: | Subject: Appointments & personnel changes; Industry: 92111 : Executive Offices |

| | |
|---|---|
| Location: | Tennessee; Georgia; United States--US |
| People: | Trump, Donald J; Raffensperger, Brad |
| Company / organization: | Name: Congress; NAICS: 921120; Name: Electoral College; NAICS: 921190; Name: Senate-US; NAICS: 921120 |
| Classification: | 92111: Executive Offices |
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| Last updated: | 2024-08-28 |
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## LINKS

# World News: Marines Shift Training to Meet Challenge From China

Gale, Alastair . Gale, Alastair.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

CAMP SOUMAGAHARA, Japan -- The Marine Corps is stepping up training in Japan for island-based conflict in the Western Pacific, putting it at the leading edge of a pivot by the U.S. to face the military challenge from China.
The Marines are preparing for a far larger and more sophisticated adversary than extremists in the Middle East and Afghanistan, the focus of their operations in recent years. China's military satellites, cyberwarfare capabilities, use of artificial intelligence and narrowing gap with U.S. firepower make it what the Pentagon calls a "near-peer" rival.
At one of a series of recent exercises, a few dozen Marines faded into long grass after touching down in two CH-47 Chinook helicopters, followed by Japanese soldiers arriving in two Osprey tilt-rotor aircraft. Their simulated mission: avoiding detection and recapturing a port on an island within range of much of the enemy's missiles and artillery.
The exercise reflected a new emphasis on small, dispersed troop units and command centers, which are intended to be harder to locate and destroy. The simulation was one of the first to be directed from a command hub consisting of three armored vehicles that can be set up or moved in minutes and emit fewer traceable signals.
"We're trying to get away from tents, from computer screens, because, one, it's very stationary and, two, it has a huge electromagnetic signature," said Lt. Col. Neil Berry, commander of the third battalion of the Eighth Marine Regiment, based in Camp Lejeune, N.C.
China's emergence as a military force has brought a new focus at the Pentagon on updating strategies and training plans. Gen. Mark Milley, the chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff, said recently that China's rise is the single most important security challenge to the U.S., and that the Chinese military was on a path to parity with the U.S.
Beijing says its military rise is peaceful. It hasn't commented on the recent series of Marine Corps exercises in Japan but has previously called U.S. and Japanese drills in the region provocations.
"I don't think China has any intention to occupy islands," said Zhu Feng, an international relations and security scholar at Nanjing University in China. "How can China achieve development? It's not by military adventurism."
The U.S. and its allies worry about possible challenges to the "first island chain," a string of territory from the Japanese archipelago through Taiwan and the Philippines to the South China Sea. Armed Chinese coast guard ships sailed near a group of Japanese-held islets in the chain more than 1,100 times in 2020, the highest frequency since a dispute over ownership flared in 2012. Under a security treaty, the U.S. is committed to help defend Japan.
Credit: By Alastair Gale

## DETAILS

| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Military helicopters; Military exercises; International relations-US; Military training; International relations |
| Business indexing term: | Subject: International relations; Industry: 92811 : National Security |

| | |
|---|---|
| Location: | China; United States--US; Japan |
| Company / organization: | Name: Department of Defense; NAICS: 928110; Name: Marine Corps-US; NAICS: 928110 |
| Classification: | 92811: National Security |
| Publication title: | Wall Street Journal, Eastern edition; New York, N.Y. |
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| Source type: | Newspaper |
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| Document type: | News |
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| Document URL: | https://www.proquest.com/newspapers/world-news-marines-shift-training-meet-challenge/docview/2474770200/se-2?accountid=14681 |
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| Last updated: | 2025-01-30 |
| Database: | ProQuest Central |

## LINKS

Document 51 of 75

# U.S. News: U.S. Watch

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

CORONAVIRUS

Fauci Sees Faster

Pace of Vaccinations

Federal officials on Sunday acknowledged the rollout of the coronavirus vaccine in 2020 was disappointing but predicted the pace will quicken and could soon surpass one million shots per day.

"We are not where we want to be, there's no doubt about that, but I think we can get there," said Anthony Fauci, the director of the National Institute of Allergy and Infectious Diseases, on ABC's "This Week."

Dr. Fauci and Surgeon General Jerome Adams said Sunday that 1.5 million Americans were vaccinated in the previous three days, an uptick from the pace at year's end.

The Trump administration had hoped to vaccinate 20 million people in 2020 but fell well short of that goal. Dr. Fauci said about four million people had received shots.

Both officials said the pace of vaccinations is expected to increase in the coming weeks. "We expect to see it rapidly ramp up over the next year," Dr. Adams said on CNN's "State of the Union."

Dr. Fauci also took issue with a tweet by President Trump in which the president criticized the "ridiculous" methodology used by the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention to calculate coronavirus deaths, which it put at 349,353 as of Sunday morning.

"Well, the deaths are real deaths," Dr. Fauci said. "That's not fake. That's real."

-- Brody Mullins and Dustin Volz

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TEXAS

Pastor Is Killed in

Shooting at Church

A pastor was killed and two other people were injured in a shooting at an East Texas church Sunday after the pastor confronted a man who had hidden from police in the church overnight, a local sheriff said.

Authorities had been using dogs and drones to search for the man late Saturday in woods near Winona following a car chase, and the pastor of the nearby Starrville Methodist Church discovered him hiding in a church bathroom Sunday morning, Smith County Sheriff Larry Smith said at a news conference.

Mr. Smith said he didn't know why the man was initially being pursued but that the license plates on his vehicle were "fictitious."

The pastor drew a gun and ordered the man to stop, Mr. Smith said, but the man grabbed the weapon and began shooting with it. The pastor was killed, a second person was injured by gunfire and another was hurt in a fall.

The man then stole the pastor's vehicle and fled east before being arrested by deputies in nearby Harrison County, Mr. Smith said. He said the man was hospitalized with gunshot wounds to his hand.

Mr. Smith declined to identify the pastor, the other people injured or the suspect. The sheriff said the shooting suspect will likely face a capital murder charge.

-- Associated Press

## DETAILS

| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Shootings; Coronaviruses; Immunization |
| Location: | United States--US |
| Publication title: | Wall Street Journal, Eastern edition; New York, N.Y. |
| First page: | A.2 |
| Publication year: | 2021 |
| Publication date: | Jan 4, 2021 |
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| Place of publication: | New York, N.Y. |
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| Database: | ProQuest Central |

LINKS

Document 52 of 75

# U.S. News: Economic Calendar

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

Monday: The health of the manufacturing sector will be in focus with the release of purchasing-managers index data from China, the eurozone, U.K. and U.S. Economists expect U.S. construction spending rose 1.1% in November, according to a Wall Street Journal poll.

Tuesday: A report on the manufacturing sector from the Institute for Supply Management is expected to show it continued to expand in December, albeit at a slower pace than in November.

Wednesday: The Federal Reserve will release minutes of its December policy meeting , when the central bank said large-scale purchases of government debt and mortgage securities would continue "until substantial further progress has been made" toward broader employment and inflation goals.

Thursday: Jobless claims are expected to have risen to 800,000 in the week ended Jan. 2, from 787,000 the previous week. Economists also expect the U.S. trade deficit to have widened sharply in November. The ISM's gauge of services-sector activity will likely show it fell slightly but remained in growth territory in December.

Friday: The December jobs report is expected to show the labor market ended the year on a weak footing, with employers adding 68,000 jobs and the unemployment rate ticking up to 6.8%. That would represent a significant cooling from the 245,000 jobs added in November and the slowest month of job creation since the labor-market recovery began in May.

## DETAILS


| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Construction spending; Manufacturing |
| Business indexing term: | Subject: Construction spending Manufacturing |
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| Language of publication: | English |
| Document type: | News |
| ProQuest document ID: | 2474770193 |
| Document URL: | https://www.proquest.com/newspapers/u-s-news-economic-calendar/docview/2474770193/se-2?accountid=14681 |
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| Database: | ProQuest Central |

## LINKS

Document 53 of 75

# EXCHANGE --- Business News: Hackers Accessed Microsoft Systems

McMillan, Robert . McMillan, Robert.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

The Russia-linked hackers behind a widespread cyber-intrusion into U.S. corporate and government systems were able to access internal systems within Microsoft Corp. and view internal source code, used to build software products, the company said Thursday.

Microsoft had previously confirmed that it had downloaded malicious software from a vendor called SolarWinds Corp. that had been modified by the hackers. Thursday's disclosure is the first indication that the hackers were able to access internal systems at Microsoft.

"We detected unusual activity with a small number of internal accounts and upon review, we discovered one account had been used to view source code in a number of source code repositories," Microsoft said.

This compromised account was able to view Microsoft's source code, but not make changes, the company said.

Microsoft's disclosure raises the specter that the hackers may have targeted and then compromised other technology companies as well, said Sherri Davidoff, chief executive of the security consulting firm LMG Security LLC.

"That's why these hackers are going after these companies," she said. "They don't want access to just one company. They want access to everything."

A Microsoft spokesman declined to say what products or internal systems were affected by the intrusion.

Microsoft said it has "found no evidence of access to production services or customer data," and "no indications that our systems were used to attack others."

The SolarWinds attack dates back to at least October 2019 and has prompted a flurry of cyber investigations within government and private industry. Through a backdoor the attackers installed in SolarWinds' Orion networking software, the hackers found their way into systems belonging to the Department of Homeland Security, the State Department, the Treasury and Commerce departments and others.

U.S. government and cybersecurity officials have linked the attack to Russia. The Kremlin has denied involvement in the hacks.

A Wall Street Journal analysis of internet records identified infected computers at two dozen organizations that installed the tainted network monitoring software from SolarWinds. Among them: networking-gear maker Cisco Systems Inc., chip makers Intel Corp. and Nvidia Corp., and accounting firm Deloitte LLP.

The hackers also compromised at least one reseller of Microsoft's cloud-based computing services and tried to use that as a way of gaining access to emails belonging to the cybersecurity vendor CrowdStrike Inc. That attempt was unsuccessful, CrowdStrike said last week. Microsoft is the world's second-largest cloud-computing company after Amazon.com Inc.

The SolarWinds attack went undetected for months and was discovered by FireEye Inc., a cybersecurity company, when hackers tripped an alarm. FireEye put more than 100 cyber sleuths on the job of investigating the hack of its systems, before ultimately zeroing in on SolarWinds' software as the source of the compromise.

U.S. government and corporate Investigators are still trying to assess what information the hackers were able to glean in what cybersecurity officials have characterized as one of the biggest breaches of U.S. networks in years.

Credit: By Robert McMillan

## DETAILS


| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Software; Investigations; Cybersecurity |
| Business indexing term: | Corporation: Microsoft Corp |
| Location: | Russia; United States--US |
| Company / organization: | Name: Microsoft Corp; NAICS: 334610, 513210 |
| Publication title: | Wall Street Journal, Eastern edition; New York, N.Y. |
| First page: | B.3 |
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| Publisher: | Dow Jones & Company Inc. |
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## LINKS



# U.S. News: Yellen Earned Millions in Speaking Fees

Andrews, Natalie; Timiraos, Nick . Andrews, Natalie; Timiraos, Nick.



## FULL TEXT

WASHINGTON -- Janet Yellen, President-elect Joe Biden's pick for Treasury secretary, collected more than $7 million in speaking fees during more than 50 in-person and virtual engagements over the past two years, according to financial disclosures released Thursday.
A separate ethics agreement outlined Ms. Yellen's plans to resign as a consultant to Magellan Financial Group Ltd., an investment-fund manager based in Australia, upon her confirmation. Ms. Yellen began consulting for the firm one year after leaving her post as Federal Reserve chairwoman in early 2018.
The agreement said Ms. Yellen would seek special authorization for one year when dealing with matters pertaining to Magellan, according to forms posted online by the U.S. Office of Government Ethics.
The agreement outlines similar steps she would take for 16 additional financial firms or entities from which she collected speaking fees in the past year, including Goldman Sachs Group Inc., Citigroup Inc. and hedge-fund firm Citadel LLC. Those measures would be in place until one year after the speaking fee was paid.
Like many former government officials, Ms. Yellen signed a contract shortly after leaving the Fed with the Washington

Speakers Bureau, an agency that helps former heads of state and other political personalities manage scores of speaking requests. Ms. Yellen has spoken frequently since leaving the central bank on the economic outlook and monetary policy, a topic of intense interest to Wall Street firms that closely follow the Fed.
Ms. Yellen and her husband -- Nobel Prize-winning economist George Akerlof -- had assets such as stocks, bond-fund shares and bank accounts valued at between $8 million and $19.6 million in 2020, according to the disclosures. The disclosure forms use ranges rather than specific amounts.
The assets belonging to Ms. Yellen, 74, and her husband are primarily in the form of investments, many of which are part of a living trust the couple created in 1982. In her ethics agreement, Ms. Yellen said she would divest her shares in 13 large companies, including AT&T, Pfizer and Conoco Phillips, within 90 days of her confirmation.
Her disclosures also show she and her husband own a stamp collection worth between $15,000 and $50,000.
No hearings for Biden nominees have been scheduled in the Senate. Complicating matters are two Georgia runoff elections on Tuesday. Should Democrats win both, they will take control of the Senate and be able to schedule hearings. If Republicans retain one or both positions, they will keep control.
Confirmation hearings for Ms. Yellen and others are in the process of being scheduled and are expected to be announced shortly after the Georgia runoff, according to a person familiar with the matter.
Ms. Yellen served as Fed chairwoman from 2014 to 2018 and as vice chairwoman from 2010 to 2014. From 2004 until 2010, she served as president of the San Francisco Fed. She also was a Fed governor from 1994 to 1997, and she chaired the Council of Economic Advisers in the Clinton White House from 1997 to 1999.
She has been a fellow at the Brookings Institution since leaving the Fed and she served this past year as the president of the American Economic Association.
Credit: By Natalie Andrews and Nick Timiraos

## DETAILS


| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Agreements; Hearings & confirmations; Ethics |
| Location: | United States--US; Georgia |
| Company / organization: | Name: Senate; NAICS: 921120 |
| Publication title: | Wall Street Journal, Eastern edition; New York, N.Y. |
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| Publication year: | 2021 |
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| Source type: | Newspaper |
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| ProQuest document ID: | 2474520892 |
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## LINKS

Document 55 of 75

# U.S. News: December Broke Records For Virus Cases, Deaths

Ansari, Talal . Ansari, Talal.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

By nearly every measure, December was the worst month since the pandemic took hold in the U.S.

Thanksgiving gatherings, cooler weather and general fatigue from nine months of restrictions contributed to an onslaught of new confirmed coronavirus cases across much of the country, bringing with it the subsequent surge in hospitalizations and deaths that public-health officials had warned of.

New Covid-19 cases stayed above 100,000 a day throughout the month, and more often than not were closer to 200,000, according to an analysis of data from Johns Hopkins University by The Wall Street Journal. Of the country's 20 million infections reported since the start of the pandemic, over 6.3 million new cases were recorded in December -- far more than in any other month.

The second-highest month for newly reported cases was November, which saw 4.4 million infections added. The next closest month was July, during a summer surge that hit some of the country's most populous states, including California, Texas and Florida, resulting in 1.92 million cases, according to the Journal analysis.

"We are clearly in the third wave of the pandemic in the United States, and it doesn't show many signs of slowing

down," said Dr. Shira Shafir, an associate professor of epidemiology at the University of California, Los Angeles. "Even if we see a plateau or even a decline in the next few days, it would be the end of January before we see the burden on hospitals lessen and deaths beginning to plateau."
While the mortality rate of those contracting the virus has improved since the spring thanks to earlier detection and advancements in treatment and therapeutics, the sheer number of cases ultimately resulted in a steadily increasing number of deaths.
On Thursday, the U.S. set a new record for the number of current hospitalizations due to complications from Covid-19, with 125,379 people in hospital beds, according to the Covid Tracking Project.
A month earlier, that figure hadn't yet broken the 100,000 mark and at the end of October, hospitalizations stood at less than 50,000. At the height of the summer surge, hospitalizations never exceeded 60,000.
In California, which has been experiencing a prolonged and severe surge, hospital-bed availability and qualified nurses needed to staff those beds have become a major concern for government and health officials. The intensive-care availability has been at 0% in two large regions.
A total of 77,572 people died in December, according to Johns Hopkins data, making it the deadliest month of the pandemic.
During the spring and summer surges, deaths reached new heights, with the seven-day average exceeding 2,000 fatalities a day in the spring, and nearly 1,500 in the summer. The seven-day average of deaths in December, meanwhile, has almost always exceeded 2,000 a day and reached a high of 2,659 on Dec. 22, according to the Covid Tracking Project.
On Wednesday, a record 3,750 deaths were reported in a single day, according to the Journal analysis of Johns Hopkins data.
The surge in America's key Covid-19 metrics came despite disruptions in data reporting from Thanksgiving and winter holidays.
Christmas and New Year's closures were expected to interrupt Covid-19 data reporting from counties and states across the county. Based on previous holidays, including Labor Day, reported cases and deaths tend to drop before the numbers bounce back and level off as local governments and labs catch up on processing tests and reporting results.
A number of factors made the end of the year a deadly and difficult time for many Americans, including underfunded public-health departments, some people's distrust of health guidelines, fatigue over pandemic restrictions and holiday travel, said Mark S. Dworkin, professor of epidemiology at the University of Illinois at Chicago.
Sunday marked the biggest air-travel day since the pandemic began, with more than 1.28 million people passing through U.S. airport checkpoints, according to the Transportation Security Administration. Significant travel days in 2020 also included the day before Thanksgiving, when 1.07 million took to the air, and the Sunday after, when 1.17 million people passed through checkpoints.
Vaccines by Pfizer-BioNTech and Moderna Inc. were authorized for emergency use by the Food and Drug Administration in December. But the vaccine rollout has been slower than some health officials had hoped.
Credit: By Talal Ansari

## DETAILS


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|---|---|
| Subject: | Thanksgiving; Fatalities; Holidays & special occasions; Epidemiology; Coronaviruses; Pandemics; Hospitalization; COVID-19 |
| Location: | California; United States--US |
| Publication title: | Wall Street Journal, Eastern edition; New York, N.Y. |

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## LINKS

Document 56 of 75

# World News: U.K., EU Part Ways on Day 1 of Brexit --- Decades of free trade, regulatory obstacles ended on Friday, while travelers face new rules

Douglas, Jason . Douglas, Jason.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

The U.K. left the European Union behind Thursday, 48 years after it joined the bloc, a significant shift in the global order that will also bring big changes for ordinary Britons.

On Jan. 1, decades of trade with the EU unencumbered by customs declarations and regulatory obstacles ceased, one of several changes likely to have big and lasting effects on the British economy. The rights of a U.K. citizen to live, work or study in any other EU member state also fell away, highlighting the extent of the EU's reach into its citizens' daily lives. EU citizens also lost those rights in the U.K.

For supporters of Brexit, including Prime Minister Boris Johnson, such costs are justified by the benefits and opportunities that exiting the EU will bring. Leaving will allow the U.K. to boost British trade with the rest of the world and set laws to shape its economy and society without interference from Brussels, they say.

"Brexit is not an end but a beginning and the responsibility now rests with all of us to make the best use of the powers that we have regained," Mr. Johnson said Wednesday.

The deal reached on Christmas Eve between London and Brussels on terms of their future relationship ran to more than 1,000 pages, covering areas as diverse as fishing rights and cooperation between law-enforcement agencies.

Still, some major areas of the U.K.'s post-EU arrangements with its neighbors have yet to be completed, notably the long-term basis for trade in financial services and the cross-border exchange of data. The U.K. is a powerhouse exporter of the former, while the latter is one of the most important lubricants of global commerce.

For businesses, the keenest changes on Jan. 1 will be felt by British exporters and importers trading with the EU. New procedures on customs declarations and regulatory paperwork will come into effect. Tariffs won't be levied on goods trade but companies importing components from across the world to produce goods for sale in the EU will need to comply with rules of origin, which specify a maximum level of foreign inputs that a finished product can contain to avoid tariffs.

The U.K. has said it would give firms bringing goods into the U.K. a degree of leeway in enforcing the new rules to smooth the passage of goods. The EU hasn't given any such assurance, raising the possibility of delays and disruption to cross-border trade while the new arrangements settle in.

That disruption is likely to hurt economic growth, especially in the first quarter, and linger throughout the year, economists at Citi said in a research note.

Overall, Citi estimates the disruption will reduce U.K. gross domestic product in 2021 by about 2%, compared with what it would have been if it had remained within the EU's single market, its zone of common regulation and its customs area.

Services firms face similar, if not greater challenges. The free-trade agreement between the U.K. and the EU included only general provisions for trade in cross-border services that don't match the level of access available within the single market, the Institute for Government said in a report.

For British families, Jan. 1 brought changes, too. Tourists with a British passport no longer can use fast-track lines for EU citizens with automatic gates at airports. Those traveling to EU destinations can shop duty-free -- but face new restrictions on how much alcohol they can buy. EU caps on certain cellphone charges will no longer apply. British students face higher fees and access requirements to study at EU universities. And pets, who could travel freely with their owners throughout the bloc, now need a vet to issue them a clean bill of health to enter an EU country.

Credit: By Jason Douglas

## DETAILS

| | |
|---|---|
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| Business indexing term: | Subject: International trade Gross Domestic Product--GDP Economic growth EU membership Tariffs |
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## LINKS

Document 57 of 75

# U.S. News: Covid-19 Variant Found in Florida

Alpert, Lukas I . Alpert, Lukas I.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

Florida health officials said late Thursday that they had detected a case of a new, fast-spreading variant of Covid-19 first identified in the U.K., making it the third state in the U.S. to report such a case, after Colorado and California.
The Florida Department of Health said the case had been found in a man in his 20s in Martin County, just north of Palm Beach. The department said the man had no history of travel. It offered no information about his condition.
Studies have suggested that the new variant is more easily transmitted but isn't necessarily any more virulent. It also doesn't appear to be resistant to the newly rolled-out vaccines.
Credit: By Lukas I. Alpert

## DETAILS



| | |
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| Document URL: | https://www.proquest.com/newspapers/u-s-news-covid-19-variant-found-florida/docview/2474520869/se-2?accountid=14681 |
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## LINKS

Document 58 of 75

# U.S. News: Hospitals Fret Over Reduced Pandemic Aid

Evans, Melanie . Evans, Melanie.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

Hospitals say the continued Covid-19 surge will require more relief than Congress included in the new pandemic-aid act after lawmakers scaled back health-care funding.

The sweeping bill included $3 billion for relief for hospitals, clinics and other health-care providers for revenue losses and higher expenses as a result of the pandemic, far less than the $35 billion previously proposed.

About $25 billion hasn't been spent of the $175 billion health-care relief fund Congress created in the spring. Even so, funds won't be enough to meet the strain of the latest nationwide surge, said Rick Pollack, the American Hospital Association's chief executive. More than 125,000 Covid-19 patients were in U.S. hospitals as of Wednesday, according to the Covid Tracking Project, another national record.

"The surge in cases is ongoing," said Tom Nickels, the association's executive vice president, increasing hospitals' financial strain from higher staffing and supply costs for Covid-19 patients and revenue losses, as other services are suspended. "We anticipate we will need additional funding."

New limits on relief may also inadvertently disadvantage hospitals with patients most severely affected by the pandemic, health-policy experts said.

A formula used last spring by the Department of Health and Human Services to allocate early relief to providers based awards on revenue. This method resulted in lopsided relief that left hard-hit communities with large Black populations with insufficient funding to match the pandemic's toll, researchers found.

In the latest coronavirus aid package, Congress said most federal relief must be used to reimburse providers who apply to be paid back for lost revenue or higher expenses. An earlier draft of the bill instead directed HHS to consider providers at risk of closing and those underrepresented in early relief payouts, according to hospital trade groups.

Targeting revenue losses fails to take into account that some hospitals earn more revenue because they charge high

prices to largely well-insured patients, while others with patients who struggle to get care take in less revenue, said researchers who analyzed early pandemic relief and health policy and economists not involved in the study.
"You can't lose what you never had," said Michael Norby, chief financial officer for Houston-based Harris Health System, where slightly more than half of patients are uninsured.
Prior research shows health-care revenue better reflects patients' access to care, not their medical needs, said health-policy experts.
In an analysis published in August in the Journal of the American Medical Association, researchers found that coronavirus relief money wasn't enough to match the needs of hard-hit communities with more Black residents. According to research they are more likely to face barriers to necessary care, such as insurance gaps or racial bias.
After factoring all announced spending through July 5, which totaled $120 billion, counties with the greatest share of Black residents received more funding overall, $506 per person, on average, versus $380 across remaining counties, the research said.
But when compared with largely white counties that got equal relief funds, counties with the largest share of Black residents had not only more Covid-19 deaths, but also more Covid-19 cases, more widespread chronic disease such as diabetes and hypertension that raise risks from the virus, and hospitals with less cash in reserve and worse margins.
"Even when we try to help the people most in need, while completely well-intentioned, we do manage to help them a little bit, but not as much as we ought to have," said Amitabh Chandra, a Harvard University health-care economist and one of the study's authors.
The initial revenue formula allowed HHS to distribute aid widely and quickly, an agency spokeswoman said. Federal officials considered other approaches, but they would have taken longer, she said. Subsequent payouts used more targeted approaches. The decision by Congress to call for revenue formulas in the new relief package endorses the agency's approach, the spokeswoman said.
The only hospital in Starke County, Ind., closed many services when the state ordered a halt to nonessential care in April. Starke Hospital in Knox, Ind., lost millions in revenue, said spokeswoman Kelly Credit. Federal relief offset losses, covered Covid-19 costs and supported critical services, she said.
The county received roughly the same $600 to $700 in pandemic funding per person as Terrebonne Parish, La., although the needs weren't similar.
The parish reported 54 deaths from Covid-19 for every 100,000 people between the beginning of February and the end of June, the researchers said. Black residents make up one-fifth of the population there. The figure was 13 deaths per 100,000 people in Starke County, where Black residents make up less than 1% of the population.
The pandemic delivered a "double whammy" to patients at the Teche Action Clinic in the Terrebonne Parish city of Houma, La., said physician Ronald Marts. Patients fear the new virus, but economic damage from the pandemic has also made it harder to seek care for chronic, debilitating conditions, he said.
Dwayne Clay, 53, continues to battle muscle weakness, pain and numbness after becoming ill from the coronavirus. Mr. Clay entered Ochsner Health's Leonard J. Chabert Medical Center in Terrebonne Parish in April and remained there for 35 days.
His insurance won't cover continued physical rehabilitation, he said. A truck driver before the pandemic, Mr. Clay has applied for disability. "I am having a hard time -- financially, spiritually, medically and emotionally," he said.
Credit: By Melanie Evans

## DETAILS

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|---|---|
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|---|---|
| Business indexing term: | Subject: Hospitals; Industry: 62211 : General Medical and Surgical Hospitals |
| Location: | United States--US |
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## LINKS

# EXCHANGE --- Where Travel Is Headed Next: Airlines Craft Very Different Flight Plans --- Some are cutting back schedules; others are buying planes and adding cities to their routes

Sider, Alis on . Sider, Alison.



## FULL TEXT

Airlines are betting that coronavirus vaccines will reignite demand for travel this year. The question is when.

Delta Air Lines Inc. Chief Executive Ed Bastian expects improvement starting this spring. Alaska Airlines President Ben Minicucci said he hopes to get back to 80% of pre-pandemic capacity by summer. United CEO Scott Kirby, however, said travel may not start getting back to normal until vaccines are widely distributed -- in late 2021.

"I recognize a lot of people are saying it's going to happen faster, and I hope they're right," he said in a December interview. "This is one of those strange situations where I think we're probably better at forecasting what's going to happen a year from now than we are what's going to happen next quarter."

Their strategies for coping with the uncertainty are just as diverse. Airlines are shutting down some international markets and running reduced schedules while also buying new planes and adding new cities in an attempt to capture demand where it exists.

United is returning to New York's John F. Kennedy International Airport in February after a five-year absence while rival Southwest Airlines Co. plans to fly from Chicago's O'Hare International Airport for the first time ever in 2021.

JetBlue Airways Corp. is adding flights this year at Miami International Airport -- the busiest U.S. airport it didn't yet serve.

The coronavirus pandemic brought a travel boom to a crashing halt last spring as people stopped traveling for work and everything from weddings to funerals was held over Zoom. It wiped out over two decades' worth of growth in a matter of months, according to aviation data provider Cirium, sending global air traffic plummeting to levels last seen in 1999.

The fragility of any rebound became evident last month when a new, more infectious strain of the coronavirus emerged in the U.K., prompting a new wave of travel restrictions. That followed other such setbacks in the U.S.

But the days just before and after Christmas were among the busiest in months, with airport security screenings nearing 1.3 million on Dec. 27 -- the highest level since March, according to the Transportation Security Administration.

"It's a little bit of an emotional roller coaster," said Mr. Minicucci, Alaska's president.

Competition among airlines will likely be fierce in 2021 as they duke it out for shares of a smaller pie. International travel -- a mainstay for legacy airlines such as United, Delta, and American Airlines Group Inc. -- could be slow to come back as international borders remain closed and travelers fear new lockdowns.

American Airlines recently said it would shutter operations in Prague, Manchester and Reykjavik, and said it would hold off on resuming flights to Venice -- all routes that were scheduled to return this summer. A spokeswoman for American said the airline was adding flights to match demand in Latin America and the Caribbean, but planning a more muted trans-Atlantic schedule due to weak demand.

"Normally we would see bookings for these destinations, and we're not seeing demand largely because of country

restrictions that remain in place," she said.
Some airlines are returning to strategies they put in motion before the pandemic. JetBlue aims to start flying to London in 2021, betting that it will be successful flying narrow-body jets with fewer seats to fill than the wide-bodies bigger competitors fly, according to airline President Joanna Geraghty.
Because New York-based JetBlue has strongholds in the Northeast, where the virus spread aggressively last spring, it learned to open new routes and cities more quickly and with less expense, she added. JetBlue has added dozens of new routes and recently announced service to new cities, including Miami and Key West.
"Everybody's trying to look for where demand is," she said.
Southwest is also being opportunistic by adding a dozen new cities as it looks to expand its reach. It is targeting airports such as Chicago's O'Hare that were once too crowded with other carriers. It also recently announced new service to Fresno and Santa Barbara, Calif. -- part of an effort to find untapped demand to put underutilized planes and staff to work bringing in revenue.
Another major carrier, Alaska, is pushing ahead with an order to replace most of its Airbus planes in the coming years with Boeing 737 MAX jets -- a move that it says will make the airline more efficient.
Doing the deal now helped the airline get the most favorable terms from Boeing, Mr. Minicucci said. "Even though there's a huge cloud over everything, now is the time to make a deal like this," Mr. Minicucci said.
China's recovery from the coronavirus pandemic could give some indication of how things will play out in the U.S. if vaccination becomes widespread. Domestic air traffic there is nearly back to pre-pandemic levels -- down just 1.4% in October from the year-earlier period -- as the economy improved and airlines offered deals, according to the International Air Transport Association.
In the U.S., airline executives and industry observers say pent-up demand for travel could be unleashed in a fury in the summer when more people are expected to be inoculated.
"The surge in demand for air travel could be like nothing we have ever before experienced," Deutsche Bank analyst Michael Linenberg wrote in December.
One potential development that could lift the industry is if younger people jump at the chance to visit elderly parents and grandparents once they have been inoculated, said Raymond James analyst Savanthi Syth. A federal advisory panel has recommended that people over 75, who are among the most vulnerable, be next in line for the vaccine.
"January is going to look terrible," Ms. Syth said. But "you can start to see some trips coming back even sooner than you would expect."
Analysts expect business travel will lag behind leisure in the recovery. That is bad news for big carriers that rely on business customers for large chunks of revenue but potentially less troubling for smaller carriers such as Allegiant Travel Co., which mostly flies from smaller cities to sunny vacation destinations.
Many of Allegiant's passengers still want to fly, according to the carrier's research. In weekly surveys the airline has conducted since the start of the pandemic, 60% of Allegiant's customers say they intend to travel by spring, and 70% say they'll travel by summer. The airline typically publishes flight schedules six months into the future, but is considering extending its offerings through the rest of the year.
"Customers are already thinking about holiday travel in '21," said Greg Anderson, chief financial officer of Allegiant.
"Leisure is the segment of the traveling public that's going to come back the fastest," he added. "We think all the other airlines will be vying for that segment."
Credit: By Alison Sider

## DETAILS

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|---|---|
| Subject: | Vaccines; Pandemics; Aviation; Coronaviruses; COVID-19; Airline scheduling; Air travel; Airline industry; Airlines; Travel; Alliances; Airports |

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|---|---|
| Business indexing term: | Subject: Airline industry Airports; Corporation: JetBlue Airways Corp; Industry: 48111 : Scheduled Air Transportation 48811 : Airport Operations |
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## LINKS

# EXCHANGE --- Tribune Publishing To Review Buyout Offer

Alpert, Lukas I . Alpert, Lukas I.



## FULL TEXT

Tribune Publishing Co. said it appointed a special committee to review a buyout bid proposed by its largest shareholder, New York hedge fund Alden Global Capital LLC.

Alden, which already owns a 32% stake, said Thursday it was interested in acquiring the rest of the publishing company for $14.25 a share, valuing Tribune at $521 million. The Wall Street Journal reported Alden's plans Wednesday. The offer drove Tribune's stock up 7.1% on Thursday to $13.70.

Tribune, which publishes nine papers, including the Chicago Tribune, the New York Daily News and the Baltimore Sun, said it had named three independent members of its board to the special committee to explore Alden's offer, and had engaged Lazard as its financial adviser and Davis Polk & Wardwell LLP as its legal counsel.

"No assurance can be given that Alden's proposal, or any other transaction, will be consummated," Tribune said in a statement Thursday evening.

Alden also controls MediaNews Group, a private company that owns some 60 daily newspapers around the country, including the Denver Post, San Jose Mercury News and Orange County Register. The hedge fund has a reputation for making deep cost cuts at titles it acquires.

A deal would have far-reaching implications for an industry beset by sharp declines in revenue over the past 20 years that have led to a wave of consolidation and cost cuts. Between 2008 and 2019, the industry shed 51% of its newsroom jobs, according to the Pew Research Center.

A transaction is complicated by a standstill agreement Alden had signed at the beginning of 2020 in exchange for a third seat on Tribune's board. Any deal to increase the stake would need a signoff from the board and the support of holders of two-thirds of the company's shares.

The publishing company's second-largest shareholder, with about 25%, is Patrick Soon-Shiong, a billionaire biotech investor who in 2018 bought the Los Angeles Times from Tribune for $500 million. He declined to comment on Alden's offer.

Tribune's third-largest shareholder, Florida investor Mason Slaine, who owns about 8% of the company, said he found the bid to be "unattractive at that price" as it represented less than three times the business' annual cash flow. "I would need to see more, but I believe it's probably just an opening gambit," he said in an interview.

Media analyst Doug Arthur of Huber Research Partners LLC said the offer was "significantly too low." He said a price range of between $16 and $17 a share was more on target.

In a Securities and Exchange Commission filing, Alden co-founder Randall Smith said the hedge fund had been in contact with an outside investor who was interested in certain Tribune properties, and Alden requested the board's permission to explore a joint transaction with him.

The investor, Stewart Bainum Jr., a former Maryland politician and chairman of Choice Hotels International Inc., operator of hotel chains such as Comfort Inn and Econo Lodge, didn't respond to a message seeking comment.

Credit: By Lukas I. Alpert

# DETAILS

| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Investments; Hedge funds; Stockholders; Publishing |
| Business indexing term: | Subject: Hedge funds Stockholders; Corporation: Tribune Publishing Co; Industry: 52394 : Portfolio Management and Investment Advice |
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## LINKS

Document 61 of 75

# World-Wide

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

The Senate voted to override the president's veto of a defense bill, with many Republicans joining Democrats to deliver a rebuke to Trump in the final days of his presidency and for the first time pass into law legislation he had blocked.

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The Covid-19 vaccination campaign in the U.S. is moving slower than projected and has been beset by confusion and disorganization in many states.

A review of data from more than two dozen nations with significant elder-care facilities shows that such institutions are tied to more than a third of Covid-19 deaths.

Hospitals in the U.S. say the continued coronavirus surge will require more relief than Congress included in the new pandemic-aid act.

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The U.K. left the EU behind Thursday, 48 years after joining the bloc, a significant shift in the global order that will also bring big changes for ordinary Britons.

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The White House extended a ban on immigrants coming to the U.S. on work-based visas and green cards through the end of March.

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Jimmy Lai, the outspoken newspaper mogul and advocate for democracy in Hong Kong, will have to return to jail after a court suspended his bail.

## DETAILS

| Subject: | Coronaviruses; COVID-19 |
|---|---|
| Location: | United States--US |
| Publication title: | Wall Street Journal, Eastern edition; New York, N.Y. |
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| Publication year: | 2021 |

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| Publication date: | Jan 2, 2021 |
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## LINKS

Document 62 of 75

# Business & Finance

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

The S&P 500 and Dow ended 2020 at record levels, notching annual gains of 16.3% and 7.2%, respectively, to wrap up a wild year in the stock market. The Nasdaq rose 44%, its best year since 2009.

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The NYSE will delist China's three large telecom carriers after a U.S. government order barring Americans from investing in firms it says aid the Chinese military.

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Tribune Publishing said it appointed a special committee to review a buyout proposed by hedge fund Alden Global Capital, its largest shareholder.

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BlackRock had planned to shake up the private-equity world with a $12 billion fund, but now the asset-management giant is setting its sights lower.

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The pharmaceutical industry is raising the prices of many products in the new year, although at a rate slightly below the past couple of years.

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Russia-linked hackers behind a widespread intrusion into U.S. corporate and government systems were able to access Microsoft systems and view internal source code.

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Car-renting startup Turo plans to publicly list shares this year.

## DETAILS


| | |
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| Location: | United States--US |
| Publication title: | Wall Street Journal, Eastern edition; New York, N.Y. |
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## LINKS

Document 63 of 75

# U.S. News: Vets of 1966 Disaster Win a Round vs. VA

Kesling, Ben . Kesling, Ben.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

A half-century ago, Air Force veteran Victor Skaar and hundreds of other troops were exposed to radiation when they responded to a Cold War-era accident in rural Spain involving lost nuclear weapons.

In December, a federal court demanded the Department of Veterans Affairs re-examine its longstanding policy that has for decades prevented the troops from getting compensation for cancers and illnesses they allege came about from their response to the accident, which spread radioactive debris.

The decision means the department can no longer rely on what the court determined is incomplete science to deny claims, while forcing veterans to provide overwhelming scientific proof to secure claims. Currently, the VA denies Mr. Skaar and others health and compensation benefits related to their claims -- including health care at no cost, a benefit typically reserved for those with disabilities connected to their service.

"VA is reviewing the court's decision," said VA spokeswoman Christina Noel. There is no timeline on when the VA will redecide the matter. The Air Force didn't respond to a request to comment.

The case stems from a January 1966 accident, when a B-52 bomber, the behemoth workhorse of America's airborne nuclear arsenal, collided with a refueling plane over the Mediterranean Sea, causing both to crash. Before the B-52 crashed, it dropped four hydrogen bombs that landed near the Spanish fishing village of Palomares. All four crewmen of the KC-135 tanker and three of the seven crewmen of the B-52 died in the accident, according to Air Force records.

The conventional explosives in two of the bombs detonated when they hit the ground, spreading debris and

radioactive material, though there was no thermonuclear detonation. A third landed safely and the fourth bomb fell into the sea and was later recovered. Then-Technical Sgt. Skaar and about 1,400 other troops were called in to find and clean up the debris, according to court documents.
"I'm probably the most-senior person who was at that site," Mr. Skaar said in an interview. "Those that were senior to me are already dead."
Now, Mr. Skaar is leading a class-action lawsuit that won a significant victory last month, when the Court of Appeals for Veterans Claims found flaws in the VA's reason for denying Mr. Skaar and other veterans' claims, forcing the department to reconsider the way it determines benefits for Mr. Skaar and other remaining cases.
Until now, the VA has relied heavily upon the Air Force's initial claims that Mr. Skaar and others weren't exposed to enough material to adversely affect their health, though outside evidence from a Princeton physicist and the Air Force's subsequent re-examinations show the troops' health was likely affected by their time in Palomares.
"The court essentially ruled that the VA must do now what it should have done at the very start," said Sen. Richard Blumenthal (D., Conn.), a member of the Senate Committee on Veterans' Affairs.
The scope of the decision isn't fully known.
"We aren't actually sure how many people this includes, because DoD and VA won't share names or let us know how many have passed away," said Molly Petchenik, a law student at the Veterans Legal Services Clinic at Yale Law School, which represents Mr. Skaar and others.
Mr. Skaar was one of 26 troops whose urine and nasal-swab samples showed concerning levels of radiation that warranted further scrutiny, court documents show. But in late 1967 the Air Force stopped monitoring them, saying their health wasn't in jeopardy from the exposure, according to court documents.
"I've had prostate cancer, skin cancer, leukopenia and I'm still fighting," Mr. Skaar said. "I don't want compensation," said Mr. Skaar, now 84 years old. "I want recognition.
Credit: By Ben Kesling

## DETAILS


| | |
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| Subject: | Bombings; Compensation; Veterans; Radiation |
| Business indexing term: | Subject: Compensation |
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## LINKS

Document 64 of 75

# U.S. News: Drugmakers Raise Prices in The New Year

Hopkins, Jared S . Hopkins, Jared S.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

The pharmaceutical industry is raising the prices of many products in the new year, albeit at a rate slightly below the past couple of years.

GlaxoSmithKline PLC and Sanofi SA are among the companies that raised the prices of hundreds of drugs by an average of 3.3%, according to a new analysis.

Pfizer Inc., which has a large portfolio of products, led the way with the most increases, raising prices by 5% or less on more than 200 products. The drug industry normally sets prices for its therapies at the start of the year and again in the middle of the year.

In all, about 70 drugmakers raised prices in the U.S. on Friday, according to an analysis from Rx Savings Solutions, which sells software to help employers and health plans choose the least-expensive medicines. The average increase of 3.3% included changes to different doses for the same drug, according to the analysis. Inflation registered at 1.2% for the most recent 12 months.

This year's average is lower with that of a year ago, when more than 60 companies raised the prices on hundreds of drugs by an average of 5.8%, according to the analysis. However, it found companies raised prices on at least 50% more products compared with last year.

The largest price increase, 31%, came via Advanz Pharma Corp. and its hypertension product Dutoprol, according to the analysis. The drug is a branded combination of two lower-cost generic medicines that have been around for decades. The U.K.-based company didn't respond to requests to comment.
Pfizer is currently rolling out a Covid-19 vaccine it developed with Germany's BioNTech SE in the U.S. and other countries. A year ago Pfizer similarly raised prices on a number of drugs, and has previously been criticized by President Trump for how it has priced its products.
Many of the New York-based company's products rose in price by 5% or less, according to the Rx Savings Solutions analysis. Among them are breast-cancer treatment Ibrance, which sold about $4 billion globally through the first nine months of last year, plus rheumatoid arthritis therapy Xeljanz and pneumococcal vaccine Prevnar.
A Pfizer spokeswoman said the company's price increases were in line with inflation, and were necessary to fund research of new drugs. Most of them affected hospital and sterile injectable products, about a third of which are sold at or below its cost of manufacturing, Pfizer said.
It said it is dedicated to growth through expanded use of medicines, not price increases. The company noted its net prices were flat or fell for the past three years.
The price increases for companies affect so-called list prices that are set by manufacturers; most patients don't pay these prices, which don't take into account rebates, discounts and insurance payments. Patients without insurance, or those with a pharmacy deductible may pay the full list price.
Drugmakers have said prices are increased in conjunction with rebates they give to pharmacy-benefit managers, or PBMs, in order to get favorable placement on the lists of covered drugs known as formularies. In fact, net prices have declined because of large rebates to PBMs, which negotiate prices in secret with their clients, such as employers and labor unions.
During the third quarter of 2020, net prices fell 2.3% versus a 4.7% drop in 2019, according to SSR Health LLC pharmaceutical analysts. While list prices have risen on average nearly every quarter since 2017, net prices have declined during that time, according to data from SSR.
In recent years, pharmaceutical companies have increasingly cited the net price phenomenon, saying they don't actually benefit much from list-price increases and that their net prices are suffering because they are paying bigger rebates to pharmacy-benefit managers.
Credit: By Jared S. Hopkins

## DETAILS

| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Drugs; Pharmaceutical industry; Vaccines; Pharmacy; Cost control; Price increases |
| Business indexing term: | Subject: Pharmaceutical industry Cost control Price increases; Corporation: Pfizer Inc; Industry: 32541 : Pharmaceutical and Medicine Manufacturing |
| Location: | United States--US |
| Company / organization: | Name: Pfizer Inc; NAICS: 325412, 339113 |
| Classification: | 32541: Pharmaceutical and Medicine Manufacturing |
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## LINKS



# U.S. News: Blinken, Haines Disclosures Released

Andrews, Natalie; Mauldin, William . Andrews, Natalie; Mauldin, William.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

WASHINGTON -- President-elect Joe Biden's pick for secretary of state took a high-dollar foray into international consulting and venture capital during the Trump administration, a career move that followed long years in public service in the White House, State Department and halls of Congress, according to financial disclosures released

Thursday.
Tony Blinken, seen as likely to be confirmed as chief diplomat in January, is co-founder and managing partner at a consulting firm that includes other former officials from the Obama administration's national security team. The firm, WestExec Advisors LLC, paid him $1.2 million, not including an expected payment of between $250,000 and $500,000 for 2020, according to the disclosures, filed through the U.S. Office of Government Ethics.
Avril Haines, Mr. Biden's selection for director of national intelligence, has an extensive resume that includes consulting work with national security data analysis company Palantir Technologies Inc. and WestExec Advisors, and as a fellow at the nonpartisan public policy research organization Brookings Institution. Ms. Haines has resigned from those posts and says she will recuse herself from all business with them for one year. The bulk of her income comes from her position as a research scholar and lecturer at Columbia University, where she was paid a salary of $440,121 over two years, according to a person familiar with her experience.
The disclosures demonstrate what has long been a pattern in Washington: Senior officials from one political party find private work in their areas of expertise during an administration led by a president from the other party, in this case President Trump's Republican Party. Companies and investors have eagerly sought strategic advice from veteran Washington lawyers and consultants as they navigated political and policy changes in the Trump administration, and former officials with international experience were useful in grappling with tariffs and new attitudes toward international deals, U.S. allies and China.
Mr. Blinken and Ms. Haines will face questions about their work in hearings expected in early 2021. The Senate is expected to announce the schedules for confirmation hearings for Mr. Blinken, Ms. Haines and others soon after the Georgia Senate runoffs, which will determine partisan control of the Senate, according to a person familiar with the planning. Typically, hearings for key posts occur ahead of the inauguration to have key national security posts ready for a final confirmation on Jan. 20, the day of the ceremony.
In 2017, the Senate confirmed Jim Mattis as secretary of defense and John Kelly as head of the Department of Homeland Security on the same day President Trump was sworn in.
Credit: By Natalie Andrews and William Mauldin

## DETAILS

| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Presidents; Hearings & confirmations; Advisors; National security |
| Business indexing term: | Industry: 92111 : Executive Offices |
| Location: | United States--US |
| People: | Trump, Donald J |
| Company / organization: | Name: Senate; NAICS: 921120 |
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## LINKS



# World News: U.S., Iraq Warn Iran Not to Attack

Coles, Isabel; Adnan, Ghassan . Coles, Isabel; Adnan, Ghassan.



## FULL TEXT

BAGHDAD -- U.S. and Iraqi authorities warned Iran and Iranian-backed militias that any attacks on American diplomats or military forces here would be met with swift retaliation as the anniversary of a U.S. drone strike that killed one of Tehran's top military leaders approaches.

"No one should underestimate our ability to defend our forces or to act decisively in response to any attack," the top U.S. military commander for the Middle East, Gen. Frank McKenzie, said Wednesday.

Calls from Iranian-backed militia groups for violence against Americans have increased in the run-up to Jan. 3, the day last year that Iranian Maj. Gen. Qassem Soleimani and an Iraqi paramilitary commander with him were killed as they left Baghdad airport.
On Thursday, a pro-Iranian Iraqi news group on the messaging service Telegram published a picture of the U.S. Embassy captioned: "Remember always I can see what you are doing."
The U.S. strike that killed Gen. Soleimani, and an Iranian counterstrike against U.S. forces with ballistic missiles, raised fears of open warfare in the Middle East. Tensions gradually eased, but Washington and Tehran remain at odds over Iran's nuclear program and its support for foreign militias.
Last month -- days after a barrage of rockets slammed into Baghdad's Green Zone, home to foreign diplomatic missions -- Prime Minister Mustafa al-Kadhimi dispatched a delegation to Tehran asking the government there to help curb attacks, according to Iraqi lawmaker Amer al-Fayez.
The delegation also delivered the message that Washington would hold Iran responsible for any attack, according to an Iraqi government official. On Wednesday, the U.S. dispatched two B-52 bombers on a flight over the Middle East in a show of force directed at "anyone who intends to do harm to Americans or American interests," said the U.S. Central Command.
Iranian Foreign Minister Javad Zarif responded on Twitter, saying, "Iran doesn't seek war but will OPENLY & DIRECTLY defend its people, security & vital interests."
Iranian-backed militias have organized a series of events to mark last year's drone strike. In recent days, new billboards have gone up along the airport road, rebranding it "The Martyr Al Mohandes street," after the militia commander who was killed alongside Gen. Soleimani.
On Sunday, a demonstration is planned in central Baghdad to demand that U.S. troops leave the country.
A year ago, militia members and supporters breached the outer perimeter of the U.S. Embassy after a vigil to protest the killing of more than two dozen fighters in a U.S. airstrike. That strike followed the killing of a U.S. contractor in a rocket attack on a base hosting coalition troops in northern Iraq.
Security forces have beefed up their presence in Baghdad in recent days, particularly in and around the Green Zone, according to Iraqi security officials.
During the past year, the U.S. has reduced its footprint in Iraq, abandoning smaller isolated outposts and cutting troop numbers to about 3,000.
Credit: By Isabel Coles and Ghassan Adnan

## DETAILS


| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Militia groups; Military strategy; Armed forces; Diplomatic & consular services; Airports |
| Business indexing term: | Subject: Airports; Industry: 48811 : Airport Operations 92811 : National Security 92812 : International Affairs |
| Location: | Iran; Baghdad Iraq; Middle East; United States--US; Iraq |
| Classification: | 48811: Airport Operations; 92811: National Security; 92812: International Affairs |
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## LINKS

Document 67 of 75

# U.S. News: Work-Visa Entry Ban Is Lengthened

Hackman, Michelle . Hackman, Michelle.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

The White House extended a ban on immigrants coming to the U.S. on work-based visas and green cards through the end of March, setting up another immigration policy decision for the incoming Biden administration to grapple with. President Trump issued bans in April and in June in the name of protecting American workers from foreign competition, just as shutdowns due to the coronavirus pandemic were battering the economy. The ban, which had been set to expire Thursday, applies to immigrants coming to the U.S. on H-1B and several other employment-based visas, along with people coming on green cards to work or reunite with family.

It generally applies to green cards issued after April and some work-based visas issued after June, though there are exceptions, such as for the spouses of U.S. citizens.

The ban on work-based visas, in particular, was roundly criticized by Silicon Valley and others that said they depend on the visas to bring employees into industries ranging from tech and consulting to landscaping and seasonal resorts.

In October, the U.S. Chamber of Commerce, which represents a broad cross-section of these industries, won a partial injunction on the visa ban in court, allowing its member companies to resume bringing over foreign employees.

It isn't known how the ban extension will affect the court's order.

President-elect Joe Biden's transition team has declined to answer questions about how he would handle the ban. On one hand, Mr. Biden has said he would lift some immigration bans, including one covering immigrants from several Muslim-majority and African nations. But he has also placed an emphasis on controlling the Covid-19 pandemic, and his team has expressed reluctance to wind down other Trump policies quickly out of fear that doing so might not be safe.

Biden advisers, for example, said that they would reopen the southern border slowly to asylum seekers stranded in Mexico to allow for social-distancing measures at ports of entry. In March, the government shut the southern border to nonessential travel and enacted a policy of expelling any migrant crossing the border illegally or asking for asylum.

Credit: By Michelle Hackman

## DETAILS


| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Passports & visas; Coronaviruses; Pandemics; Identification documents; COVID-19; Immigration policy; Bans; Noncitizens; Immigration; Immigrants |
| Business indexing term: | Industry: 92812 : International Affairs |
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## LINKS

Document 68 of 75

# World News: North Korea Tells Europe It Wants to Improve Ties With U.S.

Martin, Timothy W . Martin, Timothy W.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

North Korea wants to have good ties with the U.S., a diplomat said in a December meeting with a European lawmaker, in one of Pyongyang's only exchanges with the West in recent months, according to people familiar with the matter.

The Kim Jong Un regime cut contact with much of the outside world in 2020. It sealed off its borders to battle Covid-19. Most foreign embassies in Pyongyang have closed. North Korea has rebuffed overtures from the U.S. and South Korea to rekindle peace talks.

But in the days before the November U.S. elections, North Korea reached out to a European Parliament committee, tasked with handling Korean Peninsula ties, for an online meeting, the people said. The head of the European Parliament delegation, Lukas Mandl, agreed to an informal videoconference conversation with North Korea's Berlin ambassador.

The exchange had been suggested by the North's officials from its Berlin embassy, which is the Kim regime's de facto hub for regional affairs.

In the meeting, the North Korean ambassador repeated a goal of forging a strong relationship with the U.S., as long as Washington's hostile policy to the Kim regime is dropped, the people said. The stance was received positively, one of the people said, as it didn't represent a darkening in Pyongyang's position as President-elect Joe Biden takes office.
North Korea and the European Parliament also expressed hope to send delegations each way as early as fall 2021, the people said.
In recent years, U.S. allies in Europe have served as one of the few go-betweens between Washington and Pyongyang, as the two countries have stalemated on nuclear talks. North Korea has no diplomatic presence in Washington.
Mr. Mandl, an Austrian who is the chairman of the European Parliament's delegation for relations with the Korean Peninsula, confirmed the exchange. North Korea's Berlin embassy didn't respond to an emailed request to comment.
North Korea has been consumed by domestic affairs that will take center stage at a rare Workers' Party Congress meeting this month.
Pyongyang watchers expect the North will exercise caution as it evaluates how an incoming Biden administration will approach denuclearization talks. North Korea has preferred a step-by-step process, as the U.S. removes some economic penalties. Washington has coveted a grander bargain in which the North agrees to specifics before sanctions are relaxed.
Mr. Biden has advocated for mixing pressure with what he calls "principled diplomacy." He has rejected President Trump's strategy of unconditional summits with Mr. Kim.
Credit: By Timothy W. Martin in Seoul and Laurence Norman in Brussels

## DETAILS


| | |
|---|---|
| Subject: | Parliaments; Diplomatic & consular services |
| Business indexing term: | Industry: 92812 : International Affairs |
| Location: | North Korea; United States--US; Europe; Korean Peninsula |
| Company / organization: | Name: European Parliament; NAICS: 921120 |
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## LINKS

Document 69 of 75

# U.S. News: Biden, Pelosi Aim to Unite Party --- The two Democratic leaders have a history of forging coalitions from disparate groups

Andrews, Natalie; Collins, Eliza . Andrews, Natalie; Collins, Eliza.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

WASHINGTON -- The relationship between President-elect Joe Biden and House Speaker Nancy Pelosi spans more than three decades. They now must draw on those ties to steer a divided Democratic coalition amid a pandemic and an economy recovering from a deep slump.

The president-elect and speaker have both reached the highest levels in U.S. party politics by forging coalitions among disparate members of their party, including moderates and progressives, according to their allies and advisers. The pair's history of legislating together has created what colleagues describe as mutual trust.

Mr. Biden and Mrs. Pelosi, who both hope to start by passing additional measures to address the pandemic, must unite party members who have bickered over issues such as expanding government health insurance, how much to spend to combat climate change and criminal-justice policy.

The pair also must work with Senate Democratic leader Chuck Schumer of New York to win over enough Republicans to clear that chamber's 60-vote threshold for most bills. Control of the Senate hinges on the outcome of two Jan. 5

runoff races in Georgia.
The last time a Democratic president came into office, the party had a comfortable House majority and briefly held a Senate supermajority. This time, with two House races not called, Democrats have only a few more seats than the 218 required for a House majority. Mr. Biden has tapped three House lawmakers to serve in his administration, which will temporarily shrink the majority further.
Mrs. Pelosi will need to hold most of her caucus together Sunday as she seeks approval from the full House for another term as speaker. She faced no opposition within her party to remain their leader in a November vote.
She said it would be easier to unite her members behind a common agenda with a Democrat in the White House -- when it will be more likely that legislation they pass will become law -- than under President Trump. "It's a very unifying thing," Mrs. Pelosi said in an interview, noting that roughly 100 House Democratic lawmakers have never served with a president of their party.
Mr. Biden, through a spokesman, declined to be interviewed. "The President-elect's respect and admiration for Speaker Pelosi dates back decades," said Biden spokesman TJ Ducklo. "Their strong friendship is rooted in a shared dedication to public service, and devotion to their families and their faith."
Mr. Biden, 78 years old, and Mrs. Pelosi, 80, have known each other since well before they took on two of the top jobs in American politics. Mrs. Pelosi recalls being invited to a party by Mr. Biden in Rehoboth Beach, Del., in the late 1980s, when she was a new member of Congress.
She knew the then-senator from Delaware through party politics, and at the gathering he introduced her to friends. The only problem: Many heard her first name and confused her for the professional golfer Nancy Lopez. "I didn't want to disappoint them; I just smiled," the speaker recalled, laughing.
Over the years, the two established a friendship in which they refer to each other by their first names, a rarity for Mrs. Pelosi. Both are Roman Catholics and cite their faith as a motivation for their service.
When Mr. Biden, then a senator, championed the Violence Against Women Act in 1994, Mrs. Pelosi helped whip votes in the House. Later, Mrs. Pelosi oversaw foreign spending on the House Appropriations Committee while Mr. Biden was chairman of the Senate Foreign Relations Committee, and the two traveled together to Europe in 1997 with then-President Bill Clinton.
In the Obama administration, Mr. Biden was frequently sent by the White House to talk through deals with the speaker, including the auto industry bailout and the Affordable Care Act, said John Lawrence, Mrs. Pelosi's then-chief of staff.
"She felt that when she was talking to Biden, she was talking to a peer and someone who understood the congressional side of White House-congressional relations better than other people in the White House," he said.
Mrs. Pelosi at times has been critical of Mr. Biden, particularly around his dealings with sexual harassment.
During the 1991 confirmation process for Supreme Court Justice Clarence Thomas, Mrs. Pelosi and other female lawmakers urged Senate leadership, which included Mr. Biden -- then-chairman of the Judiciary Committee -- to re-examine Justice Thomas's nomination in light of sexual-harassment allegations made by Anita Hill.
In April 2019, Mrs. Pelosi said allegations made against Mr. Biden of inappropriate touching didn't disqualify him from running for president, but that he needed to be more careful.
Rohit Kumar, a former deputy chief of staff to Majority Leader Mitch McConnell (R., Ky.), said that both Democrats know how to negotiate bipartisan deals but that Mr. Biden may be more inclined to do so.
"Biden is more moderate than Pelosi," said Mr. Kumar, who is now a co-leader of PwC's national tax office. "He's willing to cut deals that she would not be willing to do."
Mr. Kumar said that during a 2012 meeting about a set of looming tax increases and spending cuts known as the "fiscal cliff," Mrs. Pelosi talked at length about her opposition to efforts to weaken the estate tax.
Forty-eight hours later, Mr. Kumar said, Mr. Biden agreed to set the estate-tax parameters at levels that raised less money than Democrats wanted, though he didn't accept Republicans' calls to repeal the tax. Since then, Democrats have unsuccessfully tried to raise estate-tax rates and lower the exemption.
One intraparty fight could break out over expanding access to health care, which Mrs. Pelosi says is one of her top

goals. Progressives want to extend Medicare to all Americans. Mr. Biden and Mrs. Pelosi instead have proposed creating a public option to compete against private insurers.

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Richard Rubin contributed to this article.

Credit: By Natalie Andrews and Eliza Collins

## DETAILS

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# Vaccine Rollout Falls Short

Hopkins, Jared S; Campo-Flores, Arian . Hopkins, Jared S; Campo-Flores, Arian.



## FULL TEXT

Three weeks into the most ambitious vaccination campaign in modern U.S. history, far fewer people than expected are being immunized against Covid-19 as the process moves slower than projected and has been beset by confusion and disorganization in many states.

As a result, the federal government came nowhere close to vaccinating 20 million people by the end of 2020, as it had promised.

Of the more than 12 million doses of vaccines from Moderna Inc. and from Pfizer Inc. and BioNTech SE that have been shipped, only 2.8 million have been administered, according to federal figures.

The reported shortfall is due in part to a lag in reporting data using new tools, government officials and health experts said. But as the federal government has left it to states to determine what to do with the vaccines it ships to them, and with some states pushing decision-making to local health departments and hospitals, the process has gone far from smoothly.

People in Florida are waiting in hourslong lines to get shots on a first-come, first-served basis. Some West Virginians got a Covid-19 treatment instead of vaccines. A medical practice in Texas had only two workers sign up to take the shots. While some states received fewer doses than they expected and some hospitals got their first ones this week, other health-care providers have more doses than they know what to do with and are scrambling to find enough syringes to use them.

"Hospitals aren't vaccinating everyone at the flip of a light switch," said Claire Hannan, executive director of the Association of Immunization Managers, which represents state immunization officials. "There may have been an expectation from Operation Warp Speed or others that we'd give everyone the vaccine overnight. . . . It was a logistics equation for them. If you've been in vaccines for a long time, you know that's the easy part. Getting it into actual arms is the hard part."

On Friday, Sen. Mitt Romney (R., Utah) criticized the vaccine rollout, saying in a statement that the lack of a comprehensive federal plan to be shared with states "is as incomprehensible as it is inexcusable."

Vaccines have mostly gone to health-care workers and residents of long-term care facilities. Essential workers like bus

drivers or grocery clerks, plus older adults, are expected to be next. The slow rate of vaccinations so far has raised questions about whether those groups will start getting shots this winter and the rest of Americans in the spring, as initially projected.
Moncef Slaoui, chief adviser for Operation Warp Speed, the government's coronavirus response program, and other federal officials said they hope the pace will increase. "We agree that that number is lower than what we hoped for," he said at a news briefing Wednesday. "We know that it should be better."
Public-health officials and states say uptake is lagging for several reasons, beginning with holidays that have kept staff of hospitals and nursing homes away from work. They also note they are facing high percentages of people, including some health workers, who are skeptical of taking the shots.
Hospitals and other sites are staggering appointments to avoid pulling too many workers from caring for patients amid a nationwide surge in cases, officials say. Administration of vaccines also takes more time than a typical flu shot, particularly since they are being done in a socially distant way and may be preceded by a Covid-19 test.
In addition, people who receive vaccines are being monitored for at least 15 minutes in case of allergic reactions. At least 11 reactions to Covid vaccines have been reported, according to the CDC. No serious safety concerns have been found.
The federal government is sending vaccines to states based on populations, and it has provided guidelines, but no rules, about how they should be distributed. State and local jurisdictions have been asking the federal government for more funding to support vaccine distribution than the $340 million disbursed so far. The stimulus package signed into law by President Trump contains an additional $8 billion.
Different state policies have led to confusion and shipment delays for hospitals, said Michael Wascovich, vice president of field pharmacy services for Premier Inc., a group-purchasing organization with members including 4,100 hospitals, 80% of which received doses.
"Every state is doing what they want to do," he said. "You could be in Philadelphia and it's completely different across the river if you're in Trenton or Camden."
Community Health Systems Inc., which operates 86 hospitals, is seeking state permission to redistribute doses across its Florida hospitals, while three hospitals in Indiana got no vaccine and workers must get shots elsewhere, complicating efforts to track company immunization rates. "It's not within our control," said Lynn Simon, the hospital system's chief medical officer.
Forty-two people in West Virginia were mistakenly given Regeneron Pharmaceuticals Inc.'s antibody treatment designed to fight Covid-19 in those already infected instead of Moderna's vaccine. None are at risk of being harmed, according to the West Virginia National Guard.
In Hidalgo County, Texas, a medical practice received 1,000 doses for health-care workers, but only two people responded, said Ivan Melendez, the public health authority for the county near the Mexican border.
"I think there was an overestimation of the numbers," Dr. Melendez said.
Now, some public-health officials are concerned the country may not be ready for the next phase of vaccination.
The U.S. health system and its stretched local health departments weren't prepared for the volume to vaccinate an entire country in a few months, according to Ms. Hannan, the director of the immunization association.
"The real challenge is around what happens when we get a larger supply and what happens when we have to vaccinate people that don't work in a hospital," she said.
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Melanie Evans contributed to this article.
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Wider Eligibility
Sows Confusion
Many states are following Centers for Disease Control and Prevention guidelines to first vaccinate front-line medical workers and people in long-term care facilities, but not all. Florida Gov. Ron DeSantis on Dec. 23 extended eligibility to people age 65 and older.

Because each county and hospital in the state implemented its own approach, many people didn't know whether to call, log on or show up in person to secure a spot.
Officials in Lee County, home to Fort Myers, learned last Saturday that the county would be one of eight in the state receiving doses the following day to inoculate people 65 and older, said Kevin Ruane, chairman of the county commission. With the local health department thinly staffed, they rushed to enlist paramedics and others. They weren't able to set up a reservation system, leading to hundreds of people lining up before dawn.
"It's a logistical nightmare," said Fort Myers Mayor Kevin Anderson.
Credit: By Jared S. Hopkins and Arian Campo-Flores

## DETAILS

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## LINKS

Document 71 of 75

# Lofty Year For Stocks Started as Nail-Biter

Banerji, Gunjan . Banerji, Gunjan.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

U.S. stocks landed at record-setting year-end levels after a wild 2020 that veered from a bear market to new highs achieved faster than ever before.

In a banner year for investments in everything from options to bitcoin, stocks stood out. The S&P 500 and Dow Jones Industrial Average climbed 16.3% and 7.2%, respectively, to end the year at records. The Nasdaq Composite gained 44%, its best year since 2009. The tech-heavy Nasdaq is now up 94% over the past two years, its best two-year performance since 1998-99.

Many individual stocks outpaced even those heady broad-market gains. More stocks gained at least 400% at their yearly peaks in 2020 than in any year since 2002, according to a Dow Jones Market Data analysis of FactSet data, which looked at companies with a market value of at least $100 million.

Worries about the rapidly spreading coronavirus in the first part of the year sent stocks, gold and bonds tumbling and triggered spasms in historically safe markets like money-market funds. The Federal Reserve's massive stimulus package and, later, news of a vaccine, stoked a simultaneous rally in various markets. Investors of all ages jumped in.

The pandemic "put the U.S. economy and markets on the biggest bust-to-boom roller coaster we've seen," said Jim Paulsen, chief investment strategist at the Leuthold Group. "It caused people to dump far more when it was collapsing -- has caused them to chase assets on the way up."

Here are five investment trends that boomed in 2020, defying many market watchers' expectations.

Momentum Trades

After stocks plunged into a bear market -- defined as a drop of at least 20% -- a new bull market emerged. Among the standouts were Tesla Inc., the electric car maker that soared more than 700% and made its way into the S&P 500, Overstock.com Inc., NIO Inc., Peloton Interactive Inc. and biotechnology firms.

The Russell 2000 small-cap stock index has roughly doubled from its March low.

Many retail and institutional investors turned to the momentum trade, or buying shares of companies that have risen sharply while dumping the relative losers. About $21 billion was recently sitting in exchange-traded funds tracking momentum, FactSet data show, the most in at least a decade.

"Higher stock prices show certain companies to be winners, attracting more people to do the same thing," said Tobias Hekster, co-chief investment officer at True Partner Capital. "When herds start to agree with certain talking points and that starts to be reflected in the valuation, it can become a self-fulfilling prophecy."

Of course, some investors call it a bubble. Among those is David Einhorn, who pointed to exuberance in the IPO market and soaring volumes in speculative bets like options in a third-quarter update for investors in his hedge fund Greenlight Capital.

"There are many anecdotes for toppy behavior. We will share one: We recently received a job application with the email subject, 'I am young, but good at investments' from a 13-year-old who purports to have quadrupled his money since February," Mr. Einhorn wrote in the update, which was viewed by The Wall Street Journal.

Options Boom

Investors aren't just looking to profit from the rising stock market. They are magnifying investments through options, contracts giving investors the right to buy or sell stocks later in time at specific prices. The market for stock options, which suffered years of flatlining volumes, roared to life as investors piled in. The sector, often thought to be the domain of sophisticated derivatives experts, became a playground for investors young and old, amateur and skilled.

Options volumes jumped to the highest level on record, according to Options Clearing Corp. data going back to 1973, with roughly 30 million contracts a day changing hands, up from around 19 million in 2019. Investors looked to bet on moves up and down in stocks and indexes, often cashing out of positions within hours or days to pocket profits.

Investors often turned to options last year to bet on the stock market's wild moves -- both up and down. The contracts allow investors to put down a relatively small sum to wager on the stock market's direction.

Of course, losses can add up if an investor's hunch is wrong, and riskier plays can burn an even bigger hole in an investor's portfolio.

SPACs

Few investments benefited as much as special-purpose acquisition companies, shell companies designed to raise money first and pinpoint businesses to acquire later.

More than 200 SPACs came to market in 2020, raising roughly $74 billion, more than quintuple the amount in 2019 and a record, according to S&P Global data as of Dec. 17.

"Investors are firmly in a growth mind-set and SPAC sponsors targeting purchases in growth industries have had success raising capital," Goldman Sachs Group Inc. analysts wrote to clients in December, saying that 2020 "will undoubtedly be known as the year of the SPAC."

The firm attributed increased activity to heavy trading from individual investors as well as low interest rates that boosted SPACs' allure.

Over the past decade, about half of acquisitions among SPACs were in the industrial, financial and energy sectors and just around one-third were in information technology and health care, according to Goldman. In 2020, almost 70% were in the tech, consumer discretionary and health-care sectors, aligning with the biggest stock winners.

Growth Companies

As stocks like Tesla and Apple hit highs and options volumes swelled, the divergence between companies promising high growth in the future and other corners of the market grew starker than ever. Shares of companies viewed as bargains in the market -- value stocks -- floundered, and the gap between the market's haves and have-nots has never been this wide.

The Russell 1000 growth index outperformed its value counterpart by the largest margin on record, according to Dow Jones Market Data. And while the broader market is flying high, traditional value groups like the S&P 500's energy sector declined by more than 35% and the financials group fell 4.1%.

Bitcoin

Perhaps nowhere was the zeal for risky investments as evident as it was in cryptocurrencies, where bitcoin prices surged to the first record in nearly three years, crossing the $20,000 mark.

The surge was driven by individual and institutional investors alike, many wading into the market for the first time. Bitcoin kept rising through December to close the year at $28,966.18.

Credit: By Gunjan Banerji

## DETAILS


| | |
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## LINKS

Document 72 of 75

# U.S. News -- The Numbers: Workout Resolutions Pay Off, if They Stick

Jo Craven McGinty . Jo Craven McGinty.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

Mark this date on your calendar: March 7.

That's when New Year's resolutions might stick for good, according to one study that estimates it takes an average of 66 days to develop a new habit.

But most people give up sooner than that, with 80% abandoning their pledges by mid-February, according to Gallup.

That's especially unfortunate since traditionally, the most common vow is to exercise more, a resolution that could improve health, reduce risk of chronic disease and save money.

Inadequate levels of physical activity are associated with $117 billion in annual health-care costs, according to the U.S. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, and contribute to one in 10 premature deaths.

To help avoid those consequences, the Department of Health and Human Services advises adults to move more and sit less.

According to its latest guidelines, published in 2018, any amount of moderate-to-vigorous physical activity is helpful. But for substantial benefits, adults are advised to get 150 to 300 minutes of moderate-intensity aerobic activity each week or 75 to 100 minutes of vigorous aerobic activity, plus twice-weekly muscle-strengthening exercises of moderate or greater intensity involving all major muscle groups.

Start now, and the benefits could begin accruing by Valentine's Day.

"In six weeks, you could notice a change in blood pressure independent of weight loss," said Libby Richards, an associate professor at the Purdue University School of Nursing. "You could tone up and have better blood-sugar control. You'll likely sleep better, and you may have a better mood."

But people usually give up before the benefits kick in, she said, or they don't get as much exercise as they claim.

"If you ask people if they're meeting the physical-activity guidelines, they're like, I sure am," Dr. Richards said. "But there is a difference when you ask them and when you actually measure them."

In 2018, the most recent year available, 53.3% of U.S. adults surveyed by the CDC said they met physical-activity guidelines based on the recommended minutes of moderate or vigorous exercise. When asked about getting two-plus days of muscle-strength training, only 23.2% said they met the guidelines.

"That's not great," Dr. Richards said. "It's less than a quarter, and you must keep in mind that it's self-reported data. The reality is that it's lower than that."
Researchers examined a nationally representative sample of 6,525 adults who wore accelerometers to track their movements and found that 44.8% met the physical-activity guidelines for aerobic activity, or 8.5 percentage points lower than the self-reported figure.
But when the researchers counted lifestyle activities like vacuuming, gardening and leisurely walks as contributions toward the goal of 150 minutes of exertion, 95% of participants met the guidelines.
The study, a collaboration of researchers at California State University, University of North Carolina, University of Missouri at Kansas City and Children's Mercy Hospital in Kansas City, Mo., was published in the peer-reviewed journal Frontiers in Public Health in 2019.
The researchers didn't assess the muscle-strengthening guidelines, and with aerobic activity, they found demographic differences: Men were consistently more active than women. People of normal weight tended to be more active than people who were overweight. Hispanics were more active than non-Hispanics. And activity decreased with age.
The National Cancer Institute estimates that with high levels of physical activity, the risk of bladder cancer decreases by 15%; breast cancer by 12% to 21%; colon cancer by 19%; endometrial cancer by 20%; esophageal cancer by 21%; kidney cancer by 12%; and stomach cancer by 19%. Researchers believe the reductions occur because exercise decreases inflammation, helps prevent obesity and improves immune-system functioning.
According to the Frontiers in Public Health study, activities at different levels of intensity also contribute to improved health.
"In the past, we ignored activity if it was not at a moderately intense level, like brisk walking, but light-intensity activity has a lot of health benefits," Dr. Richards said, particularly for people who are sedentary. "The more active and in shape you are, the more you have to do to see health gains. But people who are pretty inactive, they don't have to do much to start getting physical health benefits."
And that might make it a little easier to resolve to be more active in 2021.
"It's literally the closest thing we have to a fountain of youth," Dr. Richards said. "If you can keep it up, the health benefits are tremendous."
Credit: By Jo Craven McGinty

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## LINKS

Document 73 of 75

# U.S. News: U.S. Watch

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

ECONOMY

Unemployment

Claims Fall Slightly

New applications for unemployment assistance fell in the week ended Dec. 26, a sign of modest improvement during a holiday period clouded with uncertainty around impending changes to benefit payments.

Weekly initial claims for jobless benefits from regular state programs, a proxy for layoffs, declined by 19,000 to a seasonally adjusted 787,000, the Labor Department said Thursday.

That marked a second consecutive decline from the three-month high recorded earlier in December, when virus cases were surging and more jurisdictions were bringing back economic restrictions to control the spread of the coronavirus.

Last week's level remains higher than any recorded before 2020, although it is down sharply from a peak of nearly seven million in late March.
The four-week average of claims, which smooths volatile data, rose to the highest level since early October.
Weekly jobless claims figures can also be volatile during holiday periods because of challenges with seasonal adjustment.
"Holiday noise and uncertainty about extensions of benefits may have held down claims last week," Oxford Economics economist Nancy Vanden Houten said.
She said claims remain at historically high levels, and there is a risk they could rise in the coming weeks in response to the program extensions and supplemental payments.
Other data suggest the broader economic recovery may be slowing. Household spending declined 0.4% in November, marking its first retreat in seven months, and household income fell 1.1%, according to the Commerce Department. New- and existing-home sales declined in November from the previous month.
-- Kim Mackrael
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TRADE
France, Germany Hit
With Wine Tariffs
The Trump administration said it would target more French and German wine and spirits with 25% tariffs starting Jan. 12, in the latest escalation in a tit-for-tat tariff fight related to a longstanding dispute over commercial-jetliner subsidies.
Among the new levies, the U.S. will for the first time apply the 25% levies on wines from France and Germany that exceed 14% alcohol, which had previously been exempt, according to the Office of the U.S. Trade Representative.
The U.S. had seen a surge in these higher-alcohol wines, typically from Spain and France, after wines with 14% alcohol or less were hit with tariffs last year.
Washington imposed 25% tariffs on wine from France, Spain, Germany and the U.K. in October 2019 in retaliation for subsidies they made to the European aircraft manufacturer Airbus SE, arguing they hurt Boeing Co.
Other items that will be subject to new tariffs are premium cognacs that cost $38 per liter and higher, and some aircraft manufacturing parts, both from France and Germany. High-alcohol wine from Spain and the U.K. weren't added to the latest list.
The U.S. and the EU have been in a long-running dispute over what each claim are unfair government subsidies to commercial-aircraft manufacturers: Airbus in Europe and Boeing in the U.S.
The battle has played out recently in tit-for-tat tariffs on consumer products.
-- Yuka Hayashi
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PHILADELPHIA
Federal Buildings
Are Vandalized
Six people were arrested after a group vandalized several federal buildings in Philadelphia's Center City on New Year's Eve, police said.
Officers spotted about 50 people, all dressed in black, at about 8:30 p.m. Thursday at the historic U.S. Customs House, where windows were smashed, police said. Three arrests were made there and three suspects in that vandalism were arrested elsewhere later.
Vandals then hit the Federal Detention Center, where anti-police and anti-prison graffiti were scrawled, police said. A nearby sheriff's van was also defaced and several windows broken.
"During a search incident to the arrest, they recovered numerous Molotov cocktails and some other devices which haven't been identified," Philadelphia Police Chief Inspector Mike Cram said. Police were searching for more suspects.
-- Associated Press

## DETAILS

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LINKS

Document 74 of 75

# U.S. News: Across U.S., 2021 Ushers In Laws Prompted by Pandemic and Protests

Randazzo, Sara . Randazzo, Sara.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

The start of the new year brings more than just hope for the end of the pandemic. In states across the country, new laws and regulations will be going into effect, including some aimed at addressing worker safety, affordable health care and other issues that emerged last year from the coronavirus. Others target matters like racial inequality and policing that were thrust into the national spotlight in 2020.

Employment

-- In California, employers must notify workers of a possible workplace exposure to Covid-19 within one business day and report an outbreak within 48 hours to local public-health officials. In a major expansion of the state's family leave program, employers with at least five employees must now offer at least 12 weeks of unpaid, job-protected leave to take care of new children or sick family members.

-- Connecticut also is expanding its family leave program, which will be funded by a 0.5% tax on worker wages that begins in January.

-- New York requires all employers to offer sick leave. Companies with five or more employees or net income of more than $1 million must give paid time off, and smaller companies can offer unpaid leave.

-- The minimum wage increases in about half the states, including Maryland, Arkansas and Vermont. Florida joined a few other states and cities in aiming to get baseline pay to $15 an hour; the rate will rise to $10 an hour in September, with annual increases until 2026.

-- In California, app-based and delivery drivers won't be classified as employees and will be exempted from state laws governing minimum wage, paid sick leave and other labor protections after voters approved a ballot measure sponsored by Uber Technologies Inc., Lyft Inc. and other companies. Under the new law, the companies will offer some benefits to employees including mileage reimbursement and contributions toward health care.

Health and Medical Costs

-- Virginia and Georgia have new laws aimed at curbing surprise medical bills. Virginia's law protects insured patients from being billed by out-of-network providers for emergency care, or for surgeries and some other scheduled procedures performed at in-network hospitals.

-- Diabetics will have greater drug-pricing protections in seven more states. New Mexico created the lowest 30-day cap for insulin payments at $25. Virginia's new cap is $50.

-- Oklahoma will expand its Medicaid coverage starting in July.

Policing, Crime and Drugs

-- The killing of George Floyd in May after a Minnesota police officer pressed his knee to Mr. Floyd's neck for nearly nine minutes prompted several statehouses to put a ban on the chokehold maneuver used in his killing. California, Delaware, Iowa, New York, Oregon and Utah all passed some form of chokehold ban. Connecticut banned chokeholds as part of a broader law reforming policing in the state, which has some elements taking effect in

January, including requiring officers to wear a badge in a prominent place. Some antichokehold measures failed in other states.

-- Georgia makes it a hate crime to target someone because they are a police officer. The law, opposed by civil-rights groups, followed the passage of a broader hate-crimes law that increased the prison sentences in crimes motivated by a victim's race, religion, sexual orientation or other bias. Legislators passed that law after the killing of Ahmaud Arbery, a 25-year-old Black man who was fatally shot after being pursued by three white men while he was on a run.

-- More states continue to legalize recreational marijuana use through ballot measures or legislative changes, including Arizona, South Dakota, Montana and New Jersey.

Other Notable Laws

-- Several states are cracking down on cellphone use on the road. Virginia is making it illegal to hold a cellphone while driving, expanding on a prior law that banned such use in work zones, or reading or typing on devices while driving. California increased penalties for texting and driving. And Arizona is imposing fines for holding a phone while driving.

-- Publicly held corporations with headquarters in California will be required to have at least one member of boards of directors be part of a racial or ethnic minority group or LGBT by the end of 2021.

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Christine Mai-Duc, Zusha Elinson and Deanna Paul contributed to this article.

Credit: By Sara Randazzo

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Document 75 of 75

# EXCHANGE --- Business News: Car-Renting App Aims for Listing

Somerville, Heather . Somerville, Heather.

ProQuest document link

## FULL TEXT

When the pandemic hit, the chief executive of car-renting startup Turo Inc. thought back to how slowly he had responded to the dot-com bust. It didn't end well for his startup at the time.

This time, Andre Haddad decided to be more aggressive. At the end of March, Mr. Haddad laid off a third of his 330-person workforce. The next month, he cut spending on marketing to zero, where it would stay for the entire second quarter. He studied every expense to try to find savings and store up three years of cash.

Turo's financial turnaround suggests the moves are working. The peer-to-peer car-renting marketplace reported its first-ever profitable quarter in 2020, according to results shared with The Wall Street Journal, and Mr. Haddad forecasts achieving full-year profitability in 2022, before adjusting for interest and taxes.

Mr. Haddad plans to publicly list shares of Turo this year, buoyed by the company's success and following the strong performance of many tech initial public offerings in 2020. He is undecided whether he will pursue a traditional IPO and is open to alternatives, such as going public through a merger with a blank-check corporation.

Turo is a website where private car owners rent their vehicles by the day, week or month, including luxury rides like Lamborghinis. The car-renting marketplace joins Airbnb Inc. in a category of startups that looked precarious at the start of the pandemic but have since benefited from an unexpected shift in consumer behavior.

In Turo's case, people swapped air travel for local excursions, and needed cars. People took hiatuses from cities to work remotely, and rented a car for their new locale. Some customers with extra cash after months cooped up

indoors have rented sports cars or Teslas for joy rides. Turo keeps a variable cut of the rental revenue, depending on insurance costs, and charges a separate booking fee.
"The platform model is a lot more nimble and flexible," said Arun Sundararajan, a New York University professor and author of a book on the sharing economy. Because marketplaces like Turo don't own assets, as hotels or traditional car-rental companies do, they "are much less likely to go into financial distress," he said. Car-rental company Hertz Global Holdings Inc. filed for bankruptcy protection in May.
Turo said it expected to finish 2020 with $153 million in revenue, a record for the 10-year-old San Francisco-based company. It saw revenue for the second half of the year at $92.3 million, up 7% from the year-earlier period. The increase reflects slower growth than in recent years, when revenue climbed more than 60%, but any gain is notable amid the pandemic.
The company also said it cut its losses, before adjusting for interest and taxes, to $7.2 million in the second half of 2020 from $46.9 million a year earlier.
Mr. Haddad, 49 years old, was chief operating officer of European internet auction marketplace iBazar SA when the tech market collapsed in 2000. He said he was indecisive and hesitated in his response to the crisis, and sold iBazar at a steep discount to eBay Inc. in early 2001.
"We did not manage that crisis very well, so that experience stayed with me," Mr. Haddad said.
What was good for Turo also has been good for its main U.S. rival, private car-renting marketplace Getaround. By late summer, Getaround's revenue had more than doubled from before the pandemic, the company said.
Turo and Getaround are, so far, exceptions in a volatile industry. General Motors Co.'s car-sharing service Maven and Daimler AG and BMW's car-sharing venture Car2Go have closed in the past year, among other failures.
Madeline Brozen, who studies public policy and transportation at the University of California, Los Angeles, said the arrival of ride-hailing giants Lyft Inc. and Uber Technologies Inc. depressed the market of would-be car-sharing customers, and a trend toward more private vehicle ownership has challenged car-sharing businesses. Consumers flocked to used-car lots and auto makers reported record profits during the pandemic.
"We have not actually moved the needle in terms of reducing individual car ownership, and it is that which will drive these car-sharing models," Ms. Brozen said.
Turo also has had setbacks in battles with regulators and airports over fees and permitting. And consumer behavior will change again, post-pandemic. Once people resume air travel in bigger numbers, they may be more inclined to use traditional rental-car outlets at airports, where Turo has less of a presence.
Both Turo and Getaround have been assisted through the pandemic by taxpayer money. Turo received about a $6 million loan from the government's small business pandemic-aid program. Mr. Haddad said the money from the Paycheck Protection Program allowed him to hire back about half of the 110 people he laid off and reverse the roughly 25% pay cut he gave all employees, including himself.
Credit: By Heather Somerville

## DETAILS


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